

Business English

The full teaching manual for an 8-week Business English class (16 classes × 90 minutes, including a needs analysis, a midpoint performance check and a two-part final assessment): lesson stages and timing, board plans, concept-check questions, drilling, role-play management, feedback on register and tone, differentiation, and L1 and cross-cultural watch-outs.

4 modules · 12 lessons

16 classes · 90 min · 8 weeks

Teacher copy · not for students

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Module 1 — Professional Communication Foundations

Four classes that give learners a starting point and the three everyday tools of working life. The course opens with an orientation class, a workplace-needs survey and a short diagnostic (C1), framed as a map, not a verdict. Then three communication workshops: register, tone and first impressions, the "how" behind everything else in the course (C2); professional emails and messaging, the most-used skill at work (C3); and telephoning and virtual calls, where learners lose the safety net of body language and must clarify and confirm out loud (C4).

3 lessons + orientation

Lessons 1.1-1.3

Classes C1-C4

Weeks 1-2

90 min per class

Level B1+ (B1-C1 mixed)

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. C1 is the orientation, needs-analysis and diagnostic class; C2-C4 teach online lessons 1.1-1.3. These are **communication-skills workshops**, so every lesson class follows the same shape: **warmer** (review) → **lead-in** linked to learners' real needs → a **model** (dialogue, email, call) → **notice and clarify** the language (phrase banks, register, Meaning / Form / Pronunciation with concept-checking questions, CCQs) → **drill** key phrases (choral → individual; stress, intonation, polite tone) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (a role-play or simulation with A/B cards) → **feedback** on register, tone and clarity, with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes, and the numbers in the Time column are minutes. If you're running late, cut the controlled practice (set the rest for homework), never the role-play or the feedback: using the language under a little pressure, then hearing how it landed, is what learners can't get from the online course.
- Present from `slides/module-1-foundations.html`. Print `materials/module-1/classroom-materials.html` before C1. It holds the word-only phrase flashcards, the six **role cards**, the C1 **Find Someone Who** and speaking-sample interviewer card, the C2 **Welcome Reception** cards, the C3 **Supplier Reply** cards and **Register Dominoes**, the C4 **phone-call A/B cards**, **video-meeting cards** and observer checklist, and all the listening scripts.
- The needs survey and the diagnostic tasks are in `assessment/needs-analysis.html`; the course rubric, model answers and scoring sheets are in `assessment/assessment-key.html`. Both are written separately from this guide. Always follow the timings and instructions printed on those papers; the C1 plan below budgets about 15 minutes for the survey and 30 minutes for the writing sample.

- ◆ The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home and choose a US or UK voice. The classroom is where they **use** the language with a real listener and get feedback on how it sounded.
- ◆ **One rubric, all course.** Every speaking and writing task in this kit is observed with the same four criteria from [assessment/assessment-key.html](#), each scored 1–5: **Task & Purpose** (did it achieve the goal: all points covered, a clear action), **Register & Tone** (the right formality, politeness, diplomacy), **Language Range & Accuracy** (phrases, grammar, vocabulary) and **Organization & Delivery** (structure, signposting, fluency, pronunciation, interaction). In Module 1 you don't give scores in lesson classes; you use the criteria as your note-taking columns and teach learners to use them on each other through the observer checklist.
- ◆ **Feedback on register, tone and clarity.** In every freer task, walk around and note (1) lines that were **too blunt or too casual** for the listener ("I want the report," "hey, need those numbers"), (2) lines that were **over-formal or over-softened** ("I am writing to inform you that I would possibly maybe like..."), (3) **accuracy** slips that blur meaning ("discuss about," "I am agree," missing articles), and (4) **good language to praise and spread**. In the feedback stage, board 2–3 items from each column, never with names, and let learners fix them in pairs.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use American spelling and conventions, like the kit (*practice, apologize, finalize, Ms. Alvarez*, US-style phone numbers such as (312) 555-0147). Lesson 1.2 also shows the British letter pairing (*Dear Sir or Madam ... Yours faithfully*) next to American *Sincerely*. **Accept British forms whenever a learner uses them:** many learners will work with British, Irish, Indian, Australian or international colleagues. The one rule: be consistent inside one email.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Choose the register → write it clearly → say it clearly. C1 finds out what each learner actually needs English for at work and where they are now. C2 builds the idea that runs through the whole course: the same message can be **formal, neutral or friendly-professional**, and **tone** (softeners, positive framing, intonation) decides whether it sounds courteous or blunt. C3 applies register to writing: the seven-part email, matching greeting and sign-off, one purpose and a clear, dated ask. C4 applies it to the voice: call stages, message-taking and, above all, **clarifying and confirming** names, numbers and dates. Every class ends with something learners keep: goals and a starting profile (C1), an elevator pitch (C2), an email template (C3), a call "cheat sheet" (C4).

ADULTS WITH CAREERS: RESPECT, PRIVACY AND THE ROLE-CARD OPTION

Your learners are working adults. Some use English at work every day and want polish; some are looking for work; some are newcomers who were accountants, engineers, nurses or managers in another country and are rebuilding a professional career here, sometimes in a job below their experience. Treat every learner's experience as expertise ("You've managed a team of twelve: tell us how you ran meetings"), and treat foreign credentials with respect: never "back home," always "in your previous role" or "in your field."

Nobody has to disclose anything. Learners never have to say where they work, whether they are employed, how much they earn, their immigration status or why they are in the class. Every personal or work-history task has a **role-card option**: one of six fictional professionals with a job, a company and contact details (materials, set B). Put the cards on a side table in every class so anyone can take one without asking. Say it on day one and repeat it before each role-play: "Your real job, a role card, or a job you invent. All three are equally good."

All companies, people and products in this kit are fictional (Northwind Logistics, Brightline Foods, Kestrel Design, Harbor Point Supplies, Crestview Hotels). Keep role-play conflicts ordinary: deadlines, budgets, schedules, delivery delays. Don't use layoffs, discrimination or politics as practice material, even if a learner suggests it.

USING THE DIAGNOSTIC AND THE TWO PERFORMANCE CHECKS

The course has three measurement points: the **diagnostic** (C1: a reply email and a 3-minute speaking sample), the **Midpoint Performance Check** (C8: a timed email + chat-message rewrite and pair phone and meeting simulations) and the **Final Assessment** (C15–C16: writing, negotiation, presentations and mock interviews). All three use the same rubric, so learners can see real progress on the same four criteria. Present each as information, not judgment. The diagnostic is short and cold, and learners haven't yet met the course's phrase banks, so it usually **underestimates** them; say so. What matters is the pattern: is the learner's main gap **Register & Tone** (too blunt, too formal), **Language Range & Accuracy**, or **Organization & Delivery** (a buried request, no structure, hesitant delivery)? Return a short private note to each learner by C3, and let them record their scores in the workbook progress tracker.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print one copy of [assessment/needs-analysis.html](#) per learner (survey + diagnostic tasks) and, for you, the rubric and scoring sheet from [assessment/assessment-key.html](#).
- Print the **role cards** (set B) twice and put them on a side table from C1 onward. Print one **Find Someone Who** sheet per learner and the **speaking-sample interviewer card** (set C). Bring name cards, a phone timer and one folder per learner for the diagnostic.
- For C2: the **register pair** flashcards (set A1) and the **Welcome Reception** situation cards (set D, one set per group of 3).
- For C3: the **email-function** flashcards (set A2), the **Supplier Reply** cards (set E, one per pair) and **Register Dominoes** (set G, one set per group of 3–4) for the warmer or early finishers.

- For C4: the **call-stage** flashcards (set A3), the **phone-call A/B cards** (set F, one set per pair), the **video-meeting cards** (one set per group of 4) and one **observer checklist** per learner. Arrange chairs **back to back** for the phone role-play if the room allows.
- After C1, before C3: mark each writing sample and speaking sample against the rubric (a score of 1–5 on each criterion, total /20) and write a short **private note** per learner: one strength, one focus, both linked to a criterion name.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
–	C1 • wk 1	Orientation + needs analysis & diagnostic: welcome, the course map, how we work together, the workplace-needs survey , a diagnostic (a reply email + a 3-minute speaking sample: introduce yourself or your role card, then a short phone-message role-play) and personal goals	explain how the course works; identify the workplace situations they most need English for; complete the diagnostic calmly; write three specific, realistic communication goals
1.1	C2 • wk 1	Register, tone & first impressions: the register spectrum (formal · neutral · friendly-professional · too casual); markers of formality; three softeners and the over-softening trap; greetings, introductions and natural responses; the elevator pitch	choose a register for a listener and situation, turn a blunt line into a courteous one without over-softening, greet and introduce themselves and others, and deliver a 3–4 sentence self-introduction
1.2	C3 • wk 2	Professional emails & messaging: the seven-part email; greetings and sign-offs matched by register; functional phrase banks; specific subject lines and a clear, dated ask; chat, CC and Reply-All etiquette	write a formal external request and reply to one in role, with a specific subject line, one purpose, a clear dated ask and a consistent register; decide between chat and email, Reply and Reply All
1.3	C4 • wk 2	Telephoning & virtual calls: the six call stages; taking and leaving a five-part message; clarifying and confirming (spelling with words, numbers, dates, the read-back); video-call etiquette and tech-problem language	make and take a business call, take a complete message and read it back, spell names and confirm numbers and dates clearly, and open a video meeting that handles a mute or connection problem

C1 · ORIENTATION

Welcome, Needs Analysis & the Diagnostic

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain how this 16-class course is organized (four modules, the Midpoint Performance Check in C8, the Final Assessment in C15–C16, online homework)
- ◆ know how the class protects their privacy, including the **role-card option**, and agree two class agreements with the group
- ◆ identify, in the **workplace-needs survey**, the situations they most need English for and how confident they feel in each
- ◆ complete a short diagnostic (a reply email and a 3-minute speaking sample) knowing it is a starting map, not a verdict
- ◆ write three specific, realistic **communication goals** for the course

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook "Welcome" pages (course map, How we work together, About today, My goals, My progress tracker)
- ◆ Slides 1–3 · Find Someone Who sheets (set C) · speaking-sample interviewer card (set C) · role cards (set B) on a side table · name cards · phone timer · one folder per learner
- ◆ `assessment/needs-analysis.html` (one per learner: survey + diagnostic tasks) · rubric and scoring sheet from `assessment/assessment-key.html` (teacher)

BOARD PLAN

Left: today. 1 Welcome · 2 Our course · 3 My workplace needs (survey) · 4 Diagnostic: a reply email (writing) + 3 minutes with me (speaking) · 5 My goals. "The diagnostic is a map, not a verdict."

Center: the course. 16 classes · 8 weeks · 90 min. Module 1 Foundations (register · email · calls) → Module 2 Meetings & people → **C8 Performance Check** → Module 3 Presenting · negotiating · pitching → Module 4 Writing & career → **C15–C16 Final Assessment** + celebration. Homework = the online lessons (📶).

Right: one rubric. Task & Purpose · Register & Tone · Language Range & Accuracy · Organization & Delivery → 1–5 each → /20. "Your job, a role card, or one you invent: all equally good."

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Welcome and names	10	T-S → S-S	Greet each learner at the door with a handshake or a nod (let them choose) and a professional greeting: "Good evening, I'm _____. Welcome." Learners make a name card with the name they want to be called at work. Find Someone Who: work edition (materials, set C): learners mingle for 6 minutes and find a classmate for each line ("... writes emails in English at least once a week," "...has had a video call this month," "...has worked in more than one country"). Anyone may say "Pass" to any line, no reason needed. Close by asking two or three learners to introduce a classmate with one fact. Note names and one strength you hear.
The course and how we work	8	T-S → S-S	Slide 2. Walk through the course map (16 classes, four modules, C8 and C15–C16, online homework with ) and the one rubric (four criteria, 1–5 each). Workbook: How we work together . Read your four promises aloud (below). Show the role cards on the side table and say the role-card sentence. Groups of 3 propose one class agreement each ("Cameras and phones away during role-plays," "We correct the language, not the person"); agree two as a class and write them in the workbook.
Workplace-needs survey	15	S → S-S → T-S	Slide 3. Hand out assessment/needs-analysis.html . Learners complete the survey section alone, following the paper (situations they meet at work or expect to meet, how often, how confident they feel). ICQs first. Tell them: "If you're between jobs, answer for the job you want. Or use a role card." After about 10 minutes, pairs compare <i>only their top three situations</i> (not their jobs). Take a quick show of hands for each situation on the slide and tally it on the flipchart: this tally shapes your emphasis for the whole course.
How the diagnostic works	4	T-S	Two parts: a reply email (writing, on the paper) and a 3-minute speaking sample with you at a side table (introduce yourself or your role card, then a short phone-message role-play). Results come back as a private note by C3. Say the key sentence: "This is a map, not a verdict. It shows us where to start." ICQs (below).

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Diagnostic: writing sample (+ speaking samples)	30	S • T-S	Learners write the reply email as the paper instructs. While they write, call learners one at a time to the side table for the speaking sample (see "Running the speaking sample"). Give each learner you call their missed minutes at the end of the stage. Announce "five minutes left" once. Collect the papers into the folders.
Speaking samples (continued) + register warm-up	10	T-S • S-S	Keep calling learners to the side table. Everyone else does the workbook Warm-up: three ways to ask in pairs (rank three versions of one request from most to least formal and say which they'd send to a manager, a client and a close colleague). Don't correct it now: it previews C2.
My goals	8	S → S-S	Workbook: My goals . Model one goal on the board: "By C8, I want to be able to leave a clear phone message for a supplier without writing it first." Learners write three goals (situation + what they want to be able to do + by when) and rate their confidence 1-4 in six areas. Pairs may read <i>one</i> goal to each other, if they want to. "In C8 and C16 we'll look at these again."
Homework and close	5	T-S	Show the online course home page and lesson 1.1 on screen; point at a  button and the voice/speed control. Set the homework (below). Close with one professional line you'll teach next class: "Thank you all for your time today. I look forward to working with you."
Total	90		10 + 8 + 15 + 4 + 30 + 10 + 8 + 5

◆ A PROFESSIONAL, LOW-STRESS FIRST CLASS – WHAT TO SAY AND DO

- ◆ **Model the course in the way you run the room.** Greet at the door, use names, start on time, finish on time. Learners notice, and C2 will name these habits ("Be punctual; use names").
- ◆ **Your four promises** (read them aloud; they're printed in the workbook): 1. Your results are private: I'll never share or compare them. 2. I'll tell you honestly what's working and what to focus on. 3. You never have to share personal information: your job, your employer, your status or your salary. A role card is always fine. 4. Every mistake in this room is useful: we correct the language, never the person.
- ◆ **Respect experience.** Many learners had senior roles before. When someone says "I was a finance director," respond with interest ("Then you'll have a lot to teach us about meetings") and move on; don't probe why they're here.

- ◆ **If a learner becomes anxious** during the speaking sample, slow down, smile and say: "That's fine. Take your time; there's no hurry." If they freeze, offer the role card: "Would you like to be Daniel from Northwind Logistics instead?" Many learners find it easier to speak as someone else.

◆ RUNNING THE SPEAKING SAMPLE

- ◆ Use the tasks printed in [assessment/needs-analysis.html](#) and the **interviewer card** (materials, set C). Three minutes per learner: about one minute for the self-introduction (real or role card), then a short phone-message role-play in which you are the receptionist and the learner leaves a message, as the paper describes. Keep the phone timer where the learner can't see it.
- ◆ Sit at the side of the table, not opposite. Be warm but neutral: don't finish sentences or correct. Take notes on the four rubric criteria only after the learner leaves.
- ◆ **Class of up to about 8:** you'll reach everyone across the two stages. **Larger class:** reach as many as you can, then take the rest at the side table during C2's controlled-practice stage (never during the role-play). Alternatively, a learner can record the self-introduction and a phone message on their phone at home and bring it to C2.
- ◆ With the learner's permission, record the sample on your phone so you can mark it later and play a few seconds back in Module 4 as a "before" recording. Say that you'll delete recordings at the end of the course, and do.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE SURVEY AND THE DIAGNOSTIC

SAY: Survey: Do you have to write the name of your company? (No.) If you're not working at the moment, what can you do? (Answer for the job I want, or use a role card.) What do you compare with your partner? (Only my top three situations.) · Diagnostic: Is this a test with a grade? (No, a starting map.) Who sees your results? (Only me and the teacher.) What do you write? (A reply email.) If I call your name, what happens? (Three minutes of speaking at the side table.) Do you lose writing time? (No, I get the minutes back.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

SUPPORT

B1 learners may find the survey's vocabulary heavy. Read the situation list aloud and gloss quickly (*chair a meeting* = *lead it*; *negotiate* = *agree a deal*). In the writing sample, say privately: "If you can't finish, that's useful information. Write what you can." On My goals, give a frame on the board: "By ___, I want to be able to ___ in English when I ___." A learner can dictate their goals to you.

STRETCH

C1-level learners who finish early should **reread for tone**: "Would the reader feel respected? Is the request easy to find?" In My goals, ask them to make one goal about **register-shifting** (for example, "I want to sound less formal with my own team without sounding careless") or about **leading** (chairing, presenting). Ask them to notice one email this week that they think is *too* formal.

◆ WATCH-OUTS FOR THE FIRST CLASS

- ◆ **Status and disclosure.** "What do you do?" can be a painful question for someone between jobs or working below their qualifications. Never go round the room asking it. The icebreaker and the survey both allow a pass or a role card.
- ◆ **Names and titles.** Some learners expect to call you "Teacher," "Sir," "Madam" or "Mr./Ms. + first name." Tell them what you'd like to be called and practice it; C2 will explain first names versus titles in English-speaking workplaces as a tendency that varies by company.
- ◆ **The writing sample** will show you the patterns you'll meet all module: very formal or archaic formulas ("*Kindly do the needful*," "*I am writing to inform you that...*"), very direct requests translated from another language ("*I want you send me...*"), a missing subject line or sign-off. Don't correct them today; note them for C2 and C3.
- ◆ **Handshakes, eye contact and distance** vary across cultures and individuals. At the door, let learners lead: offer a hand only if they do, or simply smile and nod.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online course home: <https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/>. Read the first half of online lesson 1.1 ("Why Register & Tone Matter" and "The Professional Register Spectrum"): https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_01.html. Workbook: finish My goals. Notice the register of three work messages you receive (or see) this week: formal, neutral or friendly? Optional: two lines in the journal on how today felt.

◆ CHECK – AFTER CLASS

Mark each writing and speaking sample against the rubric in [assessment/assessment-key.html](#) (1–5 per criterion, /20 each). Write a private note per learner: **Writing /20 · Speaking /20 · one strength · one focus** (for example, "Strength: your request was clear and dated (Task & Purpose). Focus: the greeting and sign-off didn't match (Register & Tone)"). Keep a private class record of the most common patterns (too direct, too formal, no subject line, no read-back in the phone message) and the needs-survey tally. Warm-up answers: see C2 Check.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain **register** (the level of formality) and **tone** (the attitude words carry), and place a message on the spectrum: formal · neutral · friendly-professional · too casual
- ◆ recognize the markers that raise or lower register (full forms vs contractions, *request / ask, regarding / about, Dear... / Hi...*) and choose **neutral-professional** as the safe default
- ◆ turn a blunt line into a courteous one with the three softeners (a modal question, a hedging word, positive framing) and avoid **over-softening**
- ◆ greet people, introduce themselves and others, and respond naturally ("Likewise," "How do you do?" → "How do you do?")
- ◆ deliver a 3–4 sentence **elevator pitch** (name + role + what you do / value + a friendly hook), real or from a role card

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.1 (Key phrases, Language box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, My elevator pitch, Welcome Reception, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 4–8 · register-pair flashcards (set A1) · role cards (set B) · **Welcome Reception** situation cards (set D, one per group of 3) · observer checklist (set F)
- ◆ Listening scripts 1.1-A (two first meetings) and 1.1-B (polite or flat? intonation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the spectrum. FORMAL "I would be grateful if you could send me the report by Friday." → NEUTRAL (safe default) "Could you send me the report by Friday, please?" → FRIENDLY-PRO "Could you send the report over by Friday? Thanks!" → ✗ TOO CASUAL "send me the report by fri". Markers: *I would / I'd · do not / don't · request / ask · assistance / help · regarding / about.*

Center: tone. Three softeners: 1 modal question (*Could you...? Would it be possible to...?*) 2 hedge (*just, a little, when you get a chance*) 3 positive framing (*I can have it ready by Monday*). One is usually enough. ✗ "Could you possibly maybe send it sometime if that's OK?"

Right: first impressions. "Nice to meet you." → "Nice to meet you **too**." / "Likewise." · "How do you do?" → "How do you do?" (✗ I'm fine) · Pitch = name + role + what you do / value + hook. Use names · be concise · ask a question back.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: needs and goals	8	T-S → S-S	Show the anonymous needs-survey tally from C1 (top situations for the class). "These are the situations we'll practice most." Pairs reread their C1 goals and tell each other one work message they noticed this week and where it sat on the spectrum (real or invented). Then check the C1 Warm-up quickly on slide 4: which version would you send to a client? A manager? A close colleague?
Lead-in: same request, three impressions	5	T-S	Slide 4. Say "Send me the report" three ways: flat and blunt; "Could you send me the report, please?"; "I would be grateful if you could send me the report." Ask: "Same request. What's different? How would the reader feel?" Elicit the two terms: register (how formal) and tone (what attitude). "Today: how to control both."
The register spectrum	12	T-S → S	Slide 5. Build the spectrum on the board (left column). MFP and CCQs (below). Show the markers with the register-pair flashcards (set A1): stick the formal card up and elicit its neutral partner. Then Workbook Ex 1 (rank the register, three sets) and Ex 2 (sort eight phrases: F / N / FP) alone, check in pairs, check on the slide.
Tone: soften without over-softening	13	T-S → S-S	Slide 6. Blunt → courteous pairs from the lesson ("Send the figures now." → "Could you send the figures when you get a moment?"; "No." → "I'm afraid that won't be possible, but here's what I can do..."). The three softeners with CCQs. The over-softening trap. Read Script 1.1-B : learners hold up P (polite) or F (flat) for each line. Drill script rounds 1–2 (stress and intonation). Then Ex 3 (soften the tone, five lines) in pairs.
Greetings and introductions	12	T-S → S-S	Slide 7. Read Script 1.1-A (two first meetings) once: "Which meeting makes the better impression? Why?" Then again for Ex 4 (details and phrases). Clarify the responses: <i>Likewise, Nice to meet you too, How do you do?</i> → <i>How do you do?</i> Drill round 3.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			Ex 5 (match greeting and response) alone. Pairs read the model dialogue aloud, then swap roles.
My elevator pitch	8	S → S-S	Slide 8. The formula and the model ("Hi, I'm Ana Ruiz. I'm a marketing analyst at..."). Learners write their pitch in the workbook frame: real job, role card or an invented job . 4 minutes to write, then say it to a partner twice, looking up from the page the second time. Partner gives one "keep" and one "change."
Freer: the Welcome Reception	20	S-S (groups of 3)	Slide 8, ICQs first. Groups of 3 with a situation card (set D) and role cards: Host (welcomes a visitor, introduces a colleague, keeps the conversation going), Visitor (greet, gives their pitch, asks a question back), Colleague (responds, adds one fact, offers a next step). 5 minutes per round, then rotate roles; the third round is the observer's chance to use the checklist on the other two. Circulate and note language for feedback. See "Running the reception."
Feedback	7	T-S → S-S	Board 2-3 items per column, no names. Too blunt / casual: "I want to meet your boss," "Hey, what's your job?" Over-formal / over-soft: "It is a great honor to make your acquaintance," "Could you maybe possibly tell me...?" Accuracy: "I am engineer," "I work here since 2019," "Nice to see you" (first meeting). Praise: "Thanks for making the time," "I've heard great things about your team," using the other person's name. Pairs fix the errors.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 1.1 and a 🗣️ button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		8 + 5 + 12 + 13 + 12 + 8 + 20 + 7 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: register. The level of formality, chosen for the reader and the situation. It isn't "good" or "bad": the right register depends on who, how well you know them, and how sensitive the topic is.

SAY: "I would be grateful if you could send me the report." Is this rude? (No.) Is it wrong for a close colleague? (Not wrong, but a little cold or distant.) When is it the best choice? (First contact, a senior or external person, a sensitive topic.) · If you don't know which register to use, which is safest? (Neutral.) Is it easier to become more formal or less formal later? (Less formal: relax later.)

Meaning: tone. The attitude your words carry: warm, confident, apologetic, firm. The same register can have a good or a bad tone.

SAY: "You're wrong." Is it clear? (Yes.) Is it professional? (No, it sounds like an attack.) "I see it a little differently. Could we look at it again?" Does the speaker still disagree? (Yes.) What changed? (The tone, not the message.) · "Could you possibly maybe send it sometime if that's OK?" Polite? (Yes, too polite.) How does the speaker sound? (Unsure.) How many softeners do we usually need? (One.)

Meaning: positive framing. Lead with what you *can* do.

SAY: "I can't do it today." vs "I can have it ready by Monday." Which one gives the reader a plan? (The second.) Is the answer still "not today"? (Yes.)

Form. (Workbook Language box.)

Modal question	Could you + verb...? · Would you be able to + verb...? · Would it be possible to + verb...?	Could you send (not <i>to send</i>) · Would you mind sending ...? (+ -ing)
Formal request	I would be grateful if you could + verb · I'd appreciate it if you could + verb	✗ I would be grateful if you <i>can</i> ...
Hedge	just · a little · perhaps · when you get a chance · when you have a moment	one per sentence is enough
Declining positively	I'm afraid + (bad news), but + (alternative)	I'm afraid I can't make Tuesday, but I'm free Thursday.
Introducing	I'm + name, from + team / company · I work in + field · I'm responsible for + noun / -ing · I look after + noun	This is Priya, who leads our data team. · Can I introduce you to...? · I'd like you to meet...

Pronunciation. Polite requests rise and fall: the voice starts a little higher and moves on the stressed word: "Could you **SEND** me the re**PORT**?" A flat, low voice turns the same words into an order. Stress: **REG**ister · pro**FES**sional · **COUR**teous / 'kɜːtiəs / · im**PRE**sion · re**SPON**sible. Weak forms: Could you / kʊdʒə /, to meet you / tə miːtjə /. "Likewise" = **LIKE**wise.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Polite or flat?** (choral, then individual): T says "Could you send me the report?" with a warm rise-fall; S repeat. T says it flat; S say "Flat!" Then: "Would it be **POSS**ible to ar**RANGE** a quick **MEET**ing?" · "I'm

a**FRAID** that won't be **POSSible**, but here's what I **CAN** do." · "I see it a **LITtle DIF**ferently."

- 2 **Up the ladder:** T gives the too-casual line, S give the neutral version, then the formal one. T: "need the numbers" → S: "Could you send me the numbers, please?" → S: "I would be grateful if you could send me the numbers." T: "can't come" → "I'm afraid I can't make it." → "Unfortunately, I will not be able to attend." T: "help me with this?" → "Could you help me with this?" → "I would appreciate your assistance with this."
- 3 **Meet and respond** (pairs, fast): T: "Nice to meet you." → S: "Nice to meet you **TOO**." / "**LIKE**wise." T: "How do you do?" → S: "How do you do?" T: "Please, call me Sam." → S: "Thanks, Sam. And please call me ____." T: "Have you two met?" → S: "No, I don't think we have. I'm ____."
- 4 **Pitch chunks:** back-chain the model: "...looking forward to it." → "I'm really looking forward to it." → "...we'll be working together on the launch. I'm really looking forward to it." Learners then say their own first line three times, faster each time.

◆ RUNNING THE WELCOME RECEPTION

- ◆ **Groups of 3**, chairs in a small standing circle if possible (receptions happen standing up). Each learner holds their own pitch or a role card; each group gets one **situation card** (a supplier's first visit, a new team member's first day, a conference coffee break...).
- ◆ **Timing:** 5 minutes per round × 3 rounds + 5 minutes for observer feedback and the whole-class "best line." Ring a bell (or clap) at 4 minutes: "One more minute: find a polite way to end the conversation." Teach the exit line on the spot: "It was great to meet you. I'll let you get back to the others."
- ◆ **Observer checklist** (set F, round 3): one tick or note per criterion. **Task & Purpose:** did everyone introduce themselves and did the host introduce the colleague? **Register & Tone:** was the formality right for a first meeting; did they move to first names only when invited? **Language Range & Accuracy:** at least two lesson phrases; any errors that blurred meaning? **Organization & Delivery:** names used, a question back, a polite ending, eye contact and a warm voice?
- ◆ **Stretch roles:** give the Host card to a stronger learner in round 1 so the group hears a good model; give C1-level learners the constraint on their situation card ("The visitor is very senior: stay formal until they invite you to use their first name").

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE RECEPTION

SAY: *Do you have to use your real job? (No: real, a role card, or invented.) Who introduces the colleague? (The host.) What must the visitor do after their pitch? (Ask a question back.) How long is each round? (Five minutes.) What happens after round 2? (We change roles; one person observes.) What does the observer do? (Ticks the checklist, then gives one "keep" and one "change.")*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

SUPPORT

Give B1 learners a **partially completed pitch**:

"Hi, I'm _____. I'm a _____ at _____, where I _____. I understand we'll _____. I'm looking forward to it."

In Ex 3, they rewrite three lines, not five, using one frame ("Could you..., please?"). In the reception, they take the **Colleague** role first (shorter turns) and keep the phrase flashcards in their hand. Allow a quick look at the page before speaking.

STRETCH

C1-level learners do **register shifting**: rewrite each Ex 3 line in two registers (formal for a client, friendly-professional for a close colleague) and explain the difference. In the reception they take the Host role with a constraint card ("The visitor is senior and very formal"; "The visitor is late and a little stressed"). Ask them to use a **positive-framing** decline naturally in the conversation ("I'm afraid I can't stay for dinner, but I'd love to continue this over lunch tomorrow").

◆ L1 & CROSS-CULTURAL WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Direct translation**: "I want you send me the report," "Give me the number." In many languages an imperative or "I want" is neutral at work; in English it sounds like an order. The fix is structural: *Could you...? + please*. Note also the missing *to* ("want you **to** send"), common across many L1s.
- ◆ **Flat intonation sounds rude**. Speakers of languages with a narrower pitch range, or of tone languages, may use correct words with a flat voice. Drill the rise-fall on requests; it matters as much as the words.
- ◆ **"I am agree"** (Spanish, Portuguese, Italian, French, Arabic, Hindi and others) → *I agree*. **"I am engineer"** (many L1s without articles, including Russian, Polish, Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Persian) → *I'm an engineer*. **"I work here since 2019"** → *I've worked here since 2019*.
- ◆ **First names vs titles**. Some workplace cultures use titles and family names for a long time; many English-speaking workplaces move to first names quickly, but not with everyone and not always at the start. Teach the safe route: start with the title (*Ms. Grant*) and switch when invited ("Please, call me Karen"). Avoid *Mr./Ms. + first name* ("Mr. David").
- ◆ **Over-formal or old-fashioned phrases** learned from textbooks or letter templates: "It is an honor to make your acquaintance," "How do you do?" used as a real question. Present them as very formal, not wrong, and show the neutral choice.
- ◆ **Small talk and first impressions vary**. Some workplace cultures prefer a longer warm-up before business; others get to the point fast. Punctuality expectations, handshakes and eye contact also vary. Describe these as tendencies and teach the strategy: observe and mirror; when unsure, start a little more formal.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_01.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and say them back; do Exercises 1–2, the Quick Quiz and the task "Introduce Yourself & Fix

the Tone." Workbook 1.1: polish My elevator pitch until you can say it without reading; "My useful phrases" and the journal (one recent message or conversation that didn't land well, and how you'd say it now).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** Dear Ms. Alvarez, I would like to introduce myself... · Q2 **B** I'm afraid I can't make Tuesday, but I'm free Thursday if that helps. · Q3 (new) **A** Could you send me the figures when you have a moment? · Q4 (new) **B** "How do you do?" C1 Warm-up (three ways to ask): most → least formal = B (I would be grateful...) → C (Could you send me..., please?) → A (Could you send that over...?); client → B, manager → C (or B for a sensitive topic), close colleague → A or C. Script 1.1-A: Meeting 2 makes the better impression.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ build an email in the seven-part order: subject line → greeting → opening line → body → closing line → sign-off → name / signature
- ◆ match greeting and sign-off to one register (*Dear Ms. Alvarez ... Sincerely / Yours sincerely · Hi Sara ... Best regards / Best*) and know the British *sincerely / faithfully* rule
- ◆ choose phrases from six functional banks: opening, requests, attachments, following up, bad news, closing
- ◆ write a specific subject line and one clear ask with a deadline, near the top: **one email, one purpose**
- ◆ choose between chat and email, To and CC, Reply and Reply All
- ◆ write a formal external request from spoken instructions, and reply to one in role

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.2 (Key phrases, Language box, model email, Exercises 1–6, the email exchange, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 9–13 · email-function flashcards (set A2) · **Register Dominoes** (set G, one set per group of 3–4) · **Supplier Reply** cards (set E, one per pair) · role cards (set B)
- ◆ Listening script 1.2-A (the manager's voicemail) · learners' private diagnostic notes, in folders

BOARD PLAN

Left: the seven parts. 1 Subject (specific + action/deadline) · 2 Greeting · 3 Opening line (reason / reference) · 4 Body (one point + clear ask + deadline) · 5 Closing line (next step) · 6 Sign-off (matches 2) · 7 Name / signature. Subject: ✗ "Report" ✓ "Q3 report: feedback needed by Fri."

Center: frames. FORMAL Dear Ms. Alvarez, ... Sincerely, / Yours sincerely, · Dear Sir or Madam, ... Yours faithfully, (UK) / Sincerely, (US) · NEUTRAL Dear Sara, / Hi Sara, ... Kind regards, / Best regards, · FRIENDLY Hi Sara, ... Best, / Thanks, · ✗ Dear Sir ... Cheers!

Right: phrases + etiquette. I'm writing to... · Could you please...? · I would be grateful if you could... · Please find attached... · I'm just following up on... · Unfortunately, ... / I'm afraid... · Please let me know if you have any questions. **Chat** = quick, informal, now · **email** = detail, external, a record · **Reply All?** Does everyone need it?

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Register	8	S–S → S	Groups of 3–4 play Register Dominoes (set G) for 5 minutes: match each formal phrase to its neutral partner to complete the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Dominoes + results			circle. Then hand back the private diagnostic notes in folders; learners copy their scores into the progress tracker (no sharing). "Most of you have one focus in Register & Tone: today is where we fix it in writing."
Lead-in: which email do you open?	5	T-S	Slide 9. Show an imaginary inbox of five subject lines ("Hi," "Question," "Report," "Action needed: approve travel by 5 p.m. today," "Quick question re: invoice #4821"). "You have two minutes. Which do you open first? Which do you ignore?" Elicit why: specific, with an action or deadline.
Anatomy of an email	10	T-S → S	Slide 9. Build the seven parts on the board (left column). Learners label the model email in the workbook (the parts are unlabeled there) and answer the questions (purpose, ask and deadline, register). Then Ex 1 (order the email) alone, check in pairs. CCQs on "one email, one purpose."
Greetings and sign-offs	8	T-S	Slide 10. The register table, the matching rule and the British <i>sincerely</i> / <i>faithfully</i> pairing ("never two S's together: Sir goes with <i>faithfully</i> "), then the American simplification (<i>Sincerely</i> , for both; a period after <i>Ms.</i> , <i>Mr.</i>). CCQs (below). "Dear Sara," is neutral and warm, not stiff.
Phrase banks + drill	12	T-S → S	Slide 11. Six banks; hold up the email-function flashcards (set A2) and let learners call the function. Drill script rounds 1-2 (stress on the key words; even written phrases are learned faster aloud). Then Ex 2 (match eight phrases to their functions) alone.
Controlled: subject lines and the blunt email	12	S → S-S	Ex 3 (fix five subject lines) alone, 4 minutes; pairs vote on the best version of each. Then Ex 4 (rewrite the blunt email "Subject: stuff") in pairs, 6 minutes; one pair reads theirs aloud and the class checks it against the seven parts and the tone.
Chat, CC and Reply All	7	T-S → S-S	Slide 12. Quick rules: one message, not ten; chat vs email; To vs CC vs BCC; the Reply-All test; "nothing is truly private." Ex 5 (six situations: chat or email? Reply or Reply All? To or CC?) in pairs, check on the slide.
Freer: the email exchange	18	S → S-S	Slide 13, ICQs first. Round 1 (3 min) : read Script 1.2-A (the manager's voicemail) twice; learners take notes in Ex 6 . Round 2 (8 min) : each learner writes the formal external request in the workbook frame. Round 3 (7 min) : pairs swap workbooks. Each partner gets a Supplier Reply card (set E) and writes a short reply

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			in role as Mr. Okoro under the email. Then they read the reply to their own email: "Could he answer without asking you a question?" Collect two or three good emails for feedback.
Feedback	5	T-S → S-S	Board, no names. Register: "Dear Mr. Okoro ... Cheers," "Hi Daniel" to a first contact. Over-formal: "Kindly do the needful," "I am writing to inform you that I am writing..." Clarity: no deadline, the ask in the last line, a subject line like "Request." Accuracy: "discuss about," "informations," "Please find attached the quote" vs "Please find the quote attached" (both OK). Praise a strong subject line and a good positive-framing reply.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 1.2 and a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can..."
Total	90		8 + 5 + 10 + 8 + 12 + 12 + 7 + 18 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: one email, one purpose. Each email does one job. Several unrelated asks → several emails, or a short numbered list.

SAY: *An email asks for a quote, invites the reader to a party and complains about an invoice. How many purposes? (Three.) What usually happens? (The reader answers one and forgets the others.) What should you do? (Send separate emails, or number the asks.) · Where does the main ask go: the first paragraph or the last? (Near the top.) What must it include? (What I need and by when.)*

Meaning: matching the frame. The greeting and the sign-off set the register before the reader reads a word.

SAY: *"Dear Ms. Alvarez," ... "Cheers," Is that consistent? (No.) Which sign-off matches? (Sincerely, / Yours sincerely, or Kind regards, for a neutral-formal email.) · "Dear Sir or Madam": do you know the reader's name? (No.) In British style, which sign-off? (Yours faithfully.) In American style? (Sincerely.) · Is "Dear Sara," too formal for a colleague? (No, it's neutral and warm.) Is "Hey" OK for a first contact? (No, too casual.)*

Meaning: CC and Reply All.

SAY: *Your manager needs to know, but doesn't need to act. To or CC? (CC.) Thirty people got an email; you want to say "Thanks!" to the sender. Reply or Reply All? (Reply.) Is a chat message private? (No: it can be forwarded or screenshotted.)*

Form. (Workbook Language box.)

Opening	I'm writing to + verb (<i>confirm / ask about / let you know</i>) · Thank you for your email of + date · Further to our conversation, ...	✗ I'm writing <i>for</i> ask · ✗ I write to inform you
Request	Could you please + verb? · I would be grateful if you could + verb · Would it be possible to + verb? · I'd appreciate it if you could + verb by + deadline	deadline: <i>by Friday</i> (not <i>until Friday</i>)
Attachment	Please find attached + noun · Please find + noun + attached · I've attached + noun · I'm attaching + noun	✗ Please find attach · ✗ I attached you the file
Follow-up	I'm just following up on + noun · I wanted to check in regarding + noun · As a gentle reminder, ...	<i>follow up</i> (verb) · <i>a follow-up</i> (noun)
Bad news	Unfortunately, ... · I'm afraid there's been + noun · Please accept my apologies for + noun · I'm sorry for the late reply.	✗ Sorry for <i>reply late</i>
Closing	Please let me know if you have any questions. · I look forward to hearing from you. · Thanks in advance for your help.	look forward to + -ing / noun (✗ look forward to hear)

Pronunciation. Learners will also say these phrases in calls and meetings, and saying them aloud fixes the chunk. Stress: "I look **FOR**ward to **HEAR**ing from you." · "Please find at**TACH**ed the re**PORT**." · "I'm just **FOL**lowing **UP** on my email." Word stress: at**TACH**ment · con**VEN**ience · **SIG**nature · re**GARD**ing · a **FOL**low-up (noun) vs to *follow UP* (verb). Spoken email addresses: *ana dot ruiz at kestrel design dot com*.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Function flash** (choral, then individual): T holds up a function card; S say one phrase. "Opening!" → "I'm writing to confirm the delivery date." "Request!" → "Could you please send me the updated quote?" "Attachment!" → "Please find attached our specification." "Follow-up!" → "I'm just following up on my email from Monday." "Bad news!" → "Unfortunately, there's been a delay." "Closing!" → "I look forward to hearing from you."
- 2 Formal ↔ neutral:** T: "I would be grateful if you could confirm." → S: "Could you confirm, please?" T: "regarding" → S: "about." T: "I apologize for the delay." → S: "Sorry for the slow reply." T: "Yours sincerely" → S: "Kind regards."
- 3 Frame match** (fast pairs): A says a greeting, B says the matching sign-off. "Dear Sir or Madam" → "Yours faithfully / Sincerely." "Hi team" → "Thanks / Best." "Dear Mr. Okoro" → "Sincerely / Yours sincerely / Kind regards."

◆ RUNNING THE EMAIL EXCHANGE

- ◆ **Round 1: notes.** Read Script 1.2-A at natural speed, twice. Learners fill the note frame in Ex 6 (who to write to, what we need, quantity and item, deadline, what to attach, register). Check the key facts

quickly on the slide before anyone writes: **Mr. Daniel Okoro**, Harbor Point Supplies · updated quote for **40 standing desks** (model KD-20), delivery included · **by Friday the 14th** · attach the original specification · formal: first contact.

- ◆ **Round 2: write** (8 min) in the workbook frame. Give a 2-minute warning: "Check the subject line and the sign-off."
- ◆ **Round 3: reply in role** (7 min). Pairs swap workbooks. Hand each learner a **Supplier Reply** card (four versions: yes, on time · yes, but one detail is missing · a delay, with an alternative · a question before quoting). They write a short, formal reply as Mr. Okoro under their partner's email, then hand it back. Each writer reads the reply and checks: "Did my email give him everything he needed?"
- ◆ **Peer check with the rubric** (if time): the replier gives one tick per criterion: **Task & Purpose** (all facts + a clear dated ask), **Register & Tone** (formal, courteous, frame matched), **Language Range & Accuracy** (phrase-bank phrases, accurate), **Organization & Delivery** (seven parts, short paragraphs, specific subject line).

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE EMAIL EXCHANGE

***SAY:** Round 1: How many times will you hear the voicemail? (Twice.) Do you write the email while you listen? (No, notes first.) · Round 2: Formal or friendly? (Formal: first contact.) What must the subject line include? (What it's about + the deadline.) · Round 3: Whose workbook do you write in? (My partner's.) Who are you? (Mr. Okoro, the supplier.) What does your reply card tell you? (What to answer.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

SUPPORT

Give B1 learners the email frame with the **greeting, opening line and sign-off already written**; they add the subject line, the ask with the deadline, the attachment line and the closing line. In Ex 2 they match six phrases, not eight. Let them use the flashcards as a menu while writing. In round 3, give them the "yes, on time" Supplier Reply card (the shortest reply).

STRETCH

C1-level learners get the "delay, with an alternative" or "question before quoting" reply cards, which require bad-news and positive-framing language. Extension: rewrite their request as a **neutral internal update** to their team ("Office desks: quote requested, decision next week") and as a **one-message chat** to their manager: three registers, same facts. Ask them to explain one choice they made in each.

◆ L1 & CROSS-CULTURAL WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Archaic or regional formulas:** "Kindly do the needful," "Please revert at the earliest," "Thanks and regards," "I am writing to inform you that..." at the start of every email. Some are normal in certain regional varieties of English (*revert* = reply is common in parts of South Asia) but may confuse

international readers. Offer the widely understood version: *Could you please...? · Could you reply by...? · Kind regards*. Don't mock the originals: they were taught as correct.

- ◆ **Title + first name** ("Dear Mr. David," "Dear Ms. Sara") is common across many languages. English uses *title + family name* or *first name alone*. If you don't know the gender, use the full name: "Dear Sam Okafor."
- ◆ **"discuss about," "informations," "advices," "an equipment"**: *discuss* takes a direct object; *information, advice, equipment, feedback* are uncountable. Very common across L1s.
- ◆ **Tense in emails**: "I send you the file" (present simple for now) → "I'm sending / I've attached the file." "I am waiting your answer" → "I look forward to your reply" (and ✗ "look forward to hear").
- ◆ **Directness varies**. Some workplace cultures expect a long, warm opening before the request; others expect the ask in the first line. In most English-speaking workplaces, one short courtesy line and then the ask is safe. Describe it as a tendency, and tell learners to mirror the emails they receive.
- ◆ **British vs American conventions**: *Ms Alvarez / Ms. Alvarez*; *Yours faithfully* is rare in American email; dates (*12 September / September 12*; *03/04* can mean March 4 or April 3). Accept both; advise writing the month as a word in international email.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_02.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the task "Write Two Emails" (the neutral internal update is new: the formal request you already wrote in class). Workbook 1.2: "My useful phrases" (one favorite from each bank) and the journal (an email that got no reply or a confused one: which of the seven parts was missing?).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** Budget approval needed by Thu 5 p.m. · Q2 **A** Yours faithfully, (American style: Sincerely,) · Q3 (new) **C** Reply only to the sender. · Q4 (new) **B** I look forward to hearing from you. Script 1.2-A key facts: Mr. Daniel Okoro, Harbor Point Supplies · 40 standing desks, model KD-20, delivery included · by Friday the 14th · attach the original specification · formal register.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use the right phrase at each call stage: answering and identifying · stating the purpose · connecting and holding · when the person is unavailable · leaving a message · ending the call
- ◆ take and leave a **five-part message** (name, company, number, reason, callback / next step) and read it back
- ◆ clarify and confirm: ask someone to repeat, slow down or spell; spell with words ("B as in Bravo"); say numbers, dates and email addresses clearly; confirm the risky details
- ◆ signpost holds and pauses so the other person is never left in silence
- ◆ open a video meeting, handle "you're on mute" and a connection problem with natural language

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.3 (Key phrases, Language box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, the phone role-play message pads, the video-meeting opening, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 14–17 · call-stage flashcards (set A3) · **phone-call A/B cards** (set F, one set per pair) · **video-meeting cards** (set F, one set per group of 4) · observer checklists · role cards (set B)
- ◆ Listening scripts 1.3-A (the call that went wrong), 1.3-B (take the message) and 1.3-C (dictation: spelling and numbers)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the stages. 1 Answer + identify: "Good morning, Northwind Logistics, Ana speaking. How can I help?" 2 Purpose: "This is ___ from ___. I'm calling about..." 3 Hold: "Bear with me a moment." / "I'll put you through." 4 Unavailable: "I'm afraid she's in a meeting. Can I take a message?" 5 Message: "Could you ask her to call me back on...?" 6 End: "Thanks for your help. Have a good day."

Center: confirm the risky bits. Name · company · number · reason · callback. "Let me read that back to you..." · "Could you spell that, please?" · **B as in Bravo** · 15 = one-five · 50 = five-oh · 0 = "oh" / "zero" · 77 = "double seven" · the 14th = one-four · email: dot / at / dash / underscore.

Right: video. "Can everyone hear me OK?" · "You're on mute." · "Sorry, you go ahead." · "You're breaking up a little." · "I think we've lost you." · "Could you drop it in the chat?" · "Over to you, Priya." Join on time · mute when not speaking · use names.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: email repair	7	S-S	Board three weak email lines from last class's feedback (no names): a vague subject line, a mismatched frame ("Dear Mr. Okoro ... Cheers"), a blunt ask. Pairs repair them in 3 minutes. Then quick-fire: T says a greeting, the class gives the matching sign-off. Ask two learners to read one line of their online "neutral internal update" homework.
Lead-in: the call that went wrong	6	T-S → S-S	Read Script 1.3-A (a receptionist who doesn't identify the company, puts the caller on a silent hold, guesses a number and forgets to take a name). Pairs list four problems. Elicit and board them: they are today's lesson. "On a call, your voice and your words carry everything."
The call, stage by stage	12	T-S → S	Slide 14. The six stages with the call-stage flashcards (set A3): stick one phrase per stage on the board, elicit a second. CCQs on <i>put through</i> , <i>hold</i> , <i>take / leave a message</i> (below). Then Ex 1 (match eight phrases to stages) and Ex 2 (order the call) alone; check in pairs and on the slide.
Drill: stages and polite phone voice	6	T-S → S	Drill script rounds 1-2. Include the smile ("A smile is audible: try it"). Learners stand for the drill if the energy is low; phone English is spoken standing in many call centers for the same reason.
Clarifying and confirming	14	T-S → S → S-S	Slide 15. Asking to repeat, slow down, spell; the spelling alphabet (learners spell their own first name with words, or a role-card name); numbers (<i>double, oh / zero, fifteen vs fifty</i>), dates and email addresses. Drill round 3. Script 1.3-C (dictation: six items), check on the slide. Then Ex 3 : read Script 1.3-B once; learners take the message on the pad; read again for checking. Self-mark from the slide.
Controlled: fix the message	7	S → S-S	Ex 4 : the sticky note "Someone called about an order. Call them back." Learners list what's missing, write a usable version, then say the name and number aloud to a partner, phone-style, and the partner reads it back.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Freer 1: phone calls, back to back	16	S-S (pairs)	Slide 16, ICQs first. Pairs sit back to back (no lip-reading, like a real phone). Phone-call A/B cards (set F): Call 1 (5 min), then swap roles for Call 2 (5 min). The receiver takes the message on the workbook pad and reads it back; afterwards partners compare the pad with the caller's card: every detail right? Remaining 6 minutes: stronger pairs do Call 3; others repeat a call with the observer checklist. See "Running the phone calls."
Freer 2: open a video meeting	10	S-S (groups of 4)	Slide 17. Groups of 4 with video-meeting cards : one Chair (opens, checks audio, handles problems, sets one ground rule, hands over by name) and three participants, each with a secret "problem" card (on mute, breaking up, joining late, frozen, or a quiet colleague who wants to speak). 4 minutes, then a new chair. Chairs may sit facing the wall to make it "virtual."
Feedback + module wrap	7	T-S → S-S	Board, no names. Missing stages: "Hello?" with no company name, a silent hold, no read-back. Too direct: "Who are you?", "Speak slowly!" Accuracy: "I am Ana" on the phone (→ <i>This is Ana / Ana speaking</i>), "fifty" for fifteen, "Call me back to this number" (→ <i>on / at</i>). Praise: a read-back, a smile you could hear, "Bear with me." Then slide 18: the module recap (see Closing the Module).
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 1.3 and a 📶 button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can..." for 1.3 and look back at the 1.1 and 1.2 lists.
Total	90		7 + 6 + 12 + 6 + 14 + 7 + 16 + 10 + 7 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: phone verbs. *Put someone through* = connect their call to another person. *Hold (the line)* = wait on the phone. *Take a message* = the receiver writes it. *Leave a message* = the caller gives it. *Call back* = return the call.

SAY: "I'll put you through." *Who speaks next: the same person or a new person? (A new person.)* "Could you hold the line?" *Do you hang up? (No, you wait.)* "Can I take a message?" *Who's writing: the caller or*

the receiver? (The receiver.) And "Would you like to leave a message?" Who gives the message? (The caller.) "Could she call me back?" Who calls next? (She does.)

Meaning: confirming isn't weakness.

SAY: You think the client said "fifteen units," but you're not sure. Do you guess? (No.) Why not? (A wrong quantity costs money and time.) What do you say? ("Sorry, was that fifteen, one-five, or fifty, five-oh?") Do you read back the whole call? (No, just the risky bits: names, numbers, dates, quantities, prices.)

Meaning: signposting. On the phone, silence sounds like a problem.

SAY: You need 20 seconds to find a file. What do you say first? ("Bear with me a moment / Let me just check that for you.") And when you come back? ("Thanks for holding / Sorry to keep you.")

Form. (Workbook Language box.)

Identify yourself	This is Ana (from Northwind). · Ana speaking . · Northwind Logistics, Ana speaking.	✗ <i>I am Ana / Here is Ana on the phone</i>
Ask who	Who's calling, please? · Can I take your name, please? · May I ask what it's regarding?	✗ <i>Who are you? / What do you want?</i>
Unavailable	I'm afraid she's not at her desk / in a meeting / away until Monday .	positive framing: + Can I take a message?
Callback	Could you ask him to call me back on / at (312) 555-0147?	<i>on</i> (UK) / <i>at</i> (US) · ✗ to this number
Checking	Could you spell that, please? · Would you mind speaking a little more slowly? · So that's..., is that right? · Let me read that back to you.	Would you mind + - ing
Spelling	B as in Bravo (US) · B for Bravo (UK) · double R · T-O-R-R-E-S	any clear word works: <i>D as in David</i>

Pronunciation. Numbers in groups, with a small pause: *three-one-two · five-five-five · oh-one-four-seven*. Double for two identical digits (*double seven*); *oh* or *zero* for 0 (*zero* is safer in the US and on international calls). Teen / ty: thir**TEEN** vs **THIR**ty, fif**TEEN** vs **FIFT**y, and confirm with digits ("one-five"). Letters that are often confused: **B / P / D / V, M / N, F / S, E / I** (and **A / E / I** for speakers of many European languages), **G / J**. Smile on the first line; slow down a little; rise on questions: "Is **THIS** a good time to talk?"

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- Stage chain** (choral, then around the class, each learner says the next stage): "Good **MOR**ning, Northwind Logistics, Ana **SPEAK**ing. How can I **HELP**?" → "Hello, this is ___ from ___. I'm **CALL**ing

about the **IN**voice." → "BEAR with me a moment." → "I'm a**FRAID** she's in a **MEET**ing. Can I take a **MESS**age?" → "Could you ask her to call me **BACK**?" → "THANKS for your help. Have a good **DAY**."

- 2 **Rescue lines** (T says the problem, S say the phrase): T: "The line is bad." → S: "Sorry, the line's not great. Could you repeat the last part?" T: "Too fast!" → S: "Would you mind speaking a little more slowly?" T: "A difficult name." → S: "Could you spell that for me, please?" T: "You need a minute." → S: "Bear with me a moment." T: "You're back." → S: "Thanks for holding."
- 3 **Say it clearly:** T writes, S say: (312) 555-0147 → "three-one-two, five-five-five, oh-one-four-seven." 7700 → "seven-seven-oh-oh" / "double seven, double oh." 15 units → "fifteen, one-five." the 14th → "the fourteenth, one-four." j.kim@kestreldesign.com → "j dot kim at kestrel design dot com." Then pairs: A spells their first name with words, B writes it and reads it back.

◆ RUNNING THE PHONE CALLS

- ◆ **Back to back.** Chairs back to back removes lip-reading and gestures, which is exactly what makes phone calls hard. If the room doesn't allow it, learners hold a book up between their faces, or sit side by side looking straight ahead. Real phones are fine too: pairs can call each other from opposite corners of the room.
- ◆ **Cards.** Card A (caller) has the details to give, including one name to spell and one number or date to confirm. Card B (receiver) has what's happening in the office (the person is unavailable, a colleague can help, the person is back at 3 p.m.). The receiver writes on the **message pad** in the workbook. After each call, A checks B's pad against card A: any detail wrong is a signal to practice the read-back.
- ◆ **Timing:** 5 minutes per call (about 2 minutes to call, 1 to check the pad, 2 for the observer or partner feedback). Stronger pairs do Call 3 (an invoice query with two numbers that could be confused).
- ◆ **Observer checklist** (set F), for groups of 3 or the repeat call: **Task & Purpose:** were all five message parts captured and correct? **Register & Tone:** warm, polite phone voice; no "Who are you?" **Language Range & Accuracy:** stage phrases; *This is...*; accurate numbers. **Organization & Delivery:** stages in order, a signposted hold, a read-back, a clear ending.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE CALLS AND THE VIDEO MEETING

SAY: Phone: Can you look at your partner? (No, we sit back to back.) Can you show your card? (No.) Who writes the message? (The receiver, on the pad.) What must the receiver do before ending the call? (Read the details back.) What does the caller check afterwards? (The message pad against my card.) · Video: Who opens the meeting? (The chair.) Do you tell the group your problem card? (No, you act it.) What must the chair do? (Check audio, handle the problems, set a ground rule, hand over by name.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

SUPPORT

B1 learners start as the **caller** in Call 1 (the caller's lines are on the card). Give them a **call cheat sheet**: the workbook Language box folded so the six stages face up, one phrase per stage highlighted. In the dictation, read each item three times. In the video meeting, they take a participant role first ("You're on mute" is the easiest problem). Allow them to write their first two lines before the call.

STRETCH

C1-level learners take the **receiver** role with the "difficult caller" constraint (the caller speaks fast and gives the number only once; the receiver must control the pace politely). In the video meeting, they chair with two problems at once and must also **hand over** to a quiet participant by name ("Priya, did you want to come in on that?"). Extension: leave a 30-second **voicemail** on a partner's phone with all five parts, spoken without notes.

◆ L1 & CROSS-CULTURAL WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"I am Ana" / "Here is Ana"** (a direct translation in many European and other languages) → *This is Ana* or *Ana speaking*. **"Who are you?" / "Who is speaking?"** → *Who's calling, please?*
- ◆ **Teen / ty and number grouping**: speakers of Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Vietnamese, Arabic and others often need extra work on the stress contrast. Number grouping also varies: some learners read phone numbers in pairs or as whole numbers ("thirty-one, twenty..."). Teach the local grouping and the digit-by-digit confirmation.
- ◆ **Letter names**: learners whose first languages name vowels differently often confuse *A / E / I* when spelling aloud; *G / J* and *B / V* are common too. The spelling-with-words habit solves it.
- ◆ **Dates**: 03/04 is March 4 in the US and 3 April in much of the world. On calls and in emails, say and write the month as a word: "April third" / "the third of April." Time zones: name the zone ("3 p.m. Eastern").
- ◆ **Silence and turn-taking**: some speakers are comfortable with longer pauses; others overlap as a sign of engagement. On the phone and on video, both can cause confusion. Teach the signposts ("Bear with me," "Sorry, you go ahead") rather than one "correct" rhythm.
- ◆ **Camera norms** vary by company and by person. Some learners may prefer cameras off for privacy, bandwidth or family reasons. In class, never require a real home background: the video meeting is simulated.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_03.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and say them back; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the task "Role-Play a Call and a Video-Meeting Opening" (record both sides on your phone if you have no partner). Workbook 1.3: "My useful phrases" (one per stage) and the journal. Make one real call this week (or a practice call to a classmate) and use a read-back. Before C5, look at online lesson 2.1 (meetings) and note one phrase you'd like to use.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 C I'm afraid he's in a meeting right now. Can I take a message? · Q2 B "Sorry, could you repeat the last three digits? Let me read it back to check." · Q3 (new) A This is Ana from Northwind Logistics. · Q4 (new) C "Sorry, you're breaking up a little. Could you repeat that last part?" Script 1.3-B message: Joanna Wexford (W-E-X-F-O-R-D), Kestrel Design, (617) 555-0183, about the new brochure proofs: Marcus must approve them before printing; the print date has moved from Wednesday the 14th to Tuesday the 13th; the printer can make 15 sample copies (not 50) before then; please call back before 3 p.m. on Thursday.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C4: MODULE 1 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "choose it, write it, say it": **neutral-professional by default · one softener, not five · names, a question back, a warm voice** (register and tone) → **seven parts · one purpose · a specific subject line and a dated ask · a matched frame** (email) → **identify yourself · signpost the hold · take five parts and read them back · spell with words** (calls). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you: review it in the C5 warmer (Register Dominoes or a two-minute "fix the message").

Watch for in Module 2: the softeners and positive framing from C2 are the foundation of diplomatic disagreement and saying no (2.3); refer back to them by name ("That's a softener," "Lead with what you can do"). The video-call language from C4 carries straight into chairing and participating in meetings (2.1): "Over to you, Priya," "Sorry, you go ahead." The elevator pitch returns in networking (2.2). The subject-line and clear-ask habits return in every follow-up email after a meeting.

The Midpoint Performance Check (C8) directly uses Module 1: its written part is an email plus a chat-message **register rewrite**, and its speaking part includes a **phone call** marked with the course rubric. Tell learners in C4: "The email structure and the read-back you practiced today are exactly what C8 checks." Details are in [assessment/performance-check.html](#).

Module 2 — Meetings & Interpersonal Skills

Three workshops on the spoken, face-to-face side of working life, plus the course's Midpoint Performance Check. First, **meetings**: giving an opinion, agreeing and disagreeing politely, interrupting with a signal, and chairing from agenda to action points (who does what by when). Then **small talk and networking**: openers, open questions, "free information," safe topics, graceful exits and a follow-up message that turns a chat into a contact. Last, **diplomatic and assertive communication**: disagreeing, giving and receiving feedback, saying no and calming tension while staying firm on substance, soft on delivery. C8 checks Modules 1 and 2 with a timed writing paper (a client email and register rewrites) and pair speaking simulations (two calls and a meeting), scored Writing /20 and Speaking /20; the results come back privately in the C9 warmer.

3 lessons + Midpoint Check

Lessons 2.1-2.3

Classes C5-C8

Weeks 3-4

90 min per class

Level B1+ (B1-C1 mixed)

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One block = one 90-minute class. C5-C7 follow the communication-skills workshop shape used across this kit: **warmer** (review of the last class) → **lead-in** and needs link → **model** (a meeting extract, a networking chat, a feedback conversation) → **notice and clarify** the language (phrase banks, register, Meaning / Form / Pronunciation with concept-checking questions, CCQs) → **drill** (choral → individual: stress, intonation, polite tone) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (a role-play or simulation with cards) → **feedback** on register, tone and clarity, with delayed error correction → **homework**. C8 is the Midpoint Performance Check and has its own plan.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-2-meetings.html](#). Print [materials/module-2/classroom-materials.html](#) before C5. It holds the phrase flashcards and tone-matching pairs, the **meeting simulation cards** (C5), the **networking identity cards** (C6), the **hard-conversation A/B cards** (C7), the **Register Dominoes** game, the **C8 kit** (pair-order sheet, door sign, an extra quiet task for early finishers) and every **listening script you read aloud**.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons (UK or US voice, adjustable speed), so learners can hear the model sentences again at home and shadow them.

- ◆ **Protect the freer practice.** The meeting simulation (C5), the networking mingle (C6) and the hard-conversation carousel (C7) are where learners find out what they can actually do under pressure. If you are running late, shorten your explanation or the controlled stage, never the role-play or its feedback.
- ◆ **Feedback is on register, tone and clarity first, accuracy second.** During role-plays, take notes (do not interrupt). Afterwards, board 4–6 lines you heard, without names: two good ones to copy, and two or three to fix ("I am agree with you" → *I agree*; "No, that is wrong" → *I see it a little differently...*). Learners fix them in pairs, then say the good version aloud with the right tone. Use the four criteria of the course rubric (**Task & Purpose, Register & Tone, Language Range & Accuracy, Organization & Delivery**) as your observation headings from the first day, so they are familiar by C8.
- ◆ **Role cards protect privacy.** Every personal or work-history task allows a **role card**: a fictional job and company. No learner has to name a real employer, say whether they are working, or talk about salary or immigration status. Say this at the start of every role-play: "Use your real job, a past job, or the card. It's your choice, and nobody will ask which."
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use American spelling and phrasing, like the kit (*summarize, finalize, practice; send the minutes around; How was your trip in?*). Accept British forms (*summarise, send the minutes round, queue*) whenever a learner uses them, and point out that learners will meet both in international workplaces.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Acknowledge first, then act. All three lessons rest on one habit that many learners do not use in English: show the other person you have heard them *before* you say your own thing. In C5 it is a signal before you interrupt ("Sorry to interrupt, but...") and agreement before you differ ("I see your point, but..."). In C6 it is reacting and asking a follow-up question before you add your own story ("Oh really? What was that like?"). In C7 it is acknowledging a view or a feeling before you push back, give feedback, say no or solve a problem ("I understand this is frustrating. Let's look at how we fix it."). Name the habit in C5, point at it every time it appears, and by C7 learners should recognize it themselves. It is also the single fastest way to raise a **Register & Tone** score in C8.

FACE, CONFIDENCE AND EXPERIENCE

Many learners in this class have more professional experience than their English shows: engineers, nurses, accountants and managers rebuilding a career in a new language, sometimes in jobs below their qualifications. Meetings and networking can hit hard, because being quiet in a meeting or awkward at a networking event can feel like losing professional identity. Treat that experience as a resource ("You've run meetings before, in another language; what did a good chair do?"), never as something to apologize for. Keep conflicts in role-plays ordinary (deadlines, budgets, schedules, delivery delays). Do not use layoffs, discrimination, harassment, politics or religion as role-play material, even as "difficult conversation" practice. If a learner brings a real, painful workplace situation into C7, thank them, keep it private, and offer a role card instead: "Let's practice the language on this card first; you can use it for your own situation later."

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print the **flashcards** (Set A, one set for the board): the function labels and phrase cards (C5), the question and exit cards (C6), and the **blunt ↔ diplomatic** tone pairs (C7).
- For C5: the **meeting simulation cards** (Set B: four scenarios, each with a chair card, two participant cards and an observer checklist). One scenario per group of four. Cut and clip each scenario together.
- For C6: the **networking identity cards** (Set C, one per learner) and a strip of **mini business cards** for each learner. The identities are invented, and each card shares one "common ground" point with two other cards, so the mingle always produces real connections. Bring a small bell or use a phone timer.
- For C7: the **hard-conversation A/B cards** (Set D, one set per group of three) and one set of **Register Dominoes** (Set E) per pair.
- For C8: the **Midpoint Performance Check** papers from [assessment/performance-check.html](#) (the Part A writing paper and the Reading & Ranking task for every learner, plus 2 spares; one set of speaking cards per pair; one speaking score sheet per learner; the run-sheet), the rubric and model answers in [assessment/assessment-key.html](#), and the **C8 kit** (Set F: pair-order sheet, door sign, extra quiet task). For C9: each learner's [performance-tracker.html](#) (given out in Class 1).
- Rehearse every read-aloud script (Set G) once. Scripts 2.1-A, 2.2-A and 2.3-B have more than one speaker: ask a colleague or a confident learner who has seen the script, change your voice and position, or record them on a phone in advance.
- Arrange the room for C5: tables for groups of four, facing each other like a real meeting. For C6, clear a space to stand and move ("the conference coffee area"). For C8, plan a **quiet corner or a second room** for the speaking simulations where you can still see the class.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
2.1	C5 · wk 3	Meetings: roles (chair, participants, minute-taker) and documents (agenda, minutes, action points); phrase banks for giving opinions, agreeing, disagreeing politely, asking for clarification, suggesting and checking understanding; interrupting with a signal , holding the floor and bringing others in; the chair's five stages (open → agenda → manage time and participation → decide → close)	take part in a short meeting (give an opinion, disagree politely, interrupt with a signal, ask for clarification), chair a meeting from a three-item agenda, and close it with clear action points (who / what / by when)
2.2	C6 · wk 3	Small talk and networking: openers from shared context; open questions ; the "rapport engine" (follow-up questions, active listening, common ground, free information); safe and risky topics, with cultural awareness; introducing yourself, joining a group, exchanging contacts, exiting gracefully ; the follow-up message (reminder + specific reference + light next step)	start, keep going and end a networking conversation with a stranger, choosing safe topics, and write a short, specific follow-up message within 48 hours
2.3	C7 · wk 4	Diplomatic and assertive communication: passive · assertive · aggressive; the softening toolkit (hedging, qualifiers, question forms, past / continuous for distance, positive framing, prefacing); disagreeing and pushing back; Situation → Behavior → Impact feedback; receiving feedback; saying no (alternative · trade-off · buy time); de-escalating conflict	disagree, give specific feedback, say no and respond to a complaint in a way that is firm on the substance and soft on the delivery, and receive feedback without getting defensive
MPC	C8 · wk 4	Midpoint Performance Check: Part A, 35-minute timed writing (a reply email to a client + three messages rewritten into the right register); Part B, pair speaking simulations (two short phone calls + a short meeting, about 7 minutes per pair), scored on the course rubric while the class does a quiet Reading & Ranking task · Writing /20 and Speaking /20	show what they can do after two modules under realistic conditions, then (in C9) read their two scores, understand one strength and one or two targets, and record them in the Performance Tracker

2.1 · C5

Meetings — Participating & Chairing

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ name the roles (**chair**, participants, minute-taker) and documents (**agenda**, **minutes**, **action points**) of a meeting and say what an action point needs (who, what, by when)
- ◆ give an opinion, agree, disagree politely (**acknowledge**, **then differ**), ask for clarification, make and respond to suggestions, and check understanding, using ready-made phrases
- ◆ **interrupt with a signal** ("Sorry to interrupt, but... · Can I just come in here?"), hold the floor, and bring a quieter person in
- ◆ chair a short meeting through the five stages: open → follow the agenda → manage time and participation → decide and assign action → close with a recap
- ◆ use the grammar of suggestions correctly (*Why don't we + verb · How about + -ing · I'd suggest (that) we + verb*) and avoid *discuss about* and *I am agree*

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.1 (key words, phrase bank, language box, model agenda, Exercises 1–5, meeting planner, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 3–8 · Flashcards: function labels and phrase cards (Set A) · **Meeting simulation cards** (Set B: one scenario per group of four) · a timer
- ◆ Listening script **2.1-A** (Kestrel Design: the weekly project sync)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the meeting. Roles: **chair** · participants · minute-taker. Documents: **agenda** (before) → **minutes** (during / after) → **action points** = WHO does WHAT by WHEN. ✗ "We should look at the budget." ✓ "Priya — circulate the budget — by Fri."

Center: participate. opinion (*In my view... · I'd suggest we...*) · agree (*I'm with you on that*) · disagree = **acknowledge** → **differ** (*I see your point, but... · Have we considered...?*) · clarify (*Could you expand on that?*) · interrupt = **signal first** (*Sorry to interrupt, but... · Can I just come in here?*) · hold (*If I could just finish...*) · bring in (*What do you think, Sara?*)

Right: chair. 1 Open (*Shall we get started? The purpose of today's meeting is...*) → 2 Agenda (*First on the agenda... · Let's move on to...*) → 3 Time (*Let's park that · take it offline*) → 4 Decide (*So, to summarize... Are we all agreed?*) → 5 Close (*To recap the action points...*). Grammar: Why don't we **ask** · How about **asking** · I'd suggest we **ask**. ✗ *discuss about* · ✗ *I am agree*.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: virtual-call rescue	7	S-S	Review C4 (telephoning and virtual calls). Read problems aloud, one at a time; pairs race to give a polite phrase: "Someone is talking but you can't hear them." (<i>You're on mute.</i>) · "The picture keeps freezing." (<i>Sorry, you're breaking up a little.</i>) · "You didn't catch a number." (<i>Could you repeat that last part?</i>) · "You want to confirm the date." (<i>So that's the 13th, not the 30th?</i>) · "Two people start talking at once." (<i>Sorry, you go ahead.</i>) Then: "The last one is today's topic. What happens when <i>you</i> need to speak and someone else is talking?"
Lead-in: my meetings	5	S → S-S	Slide 3. Learners rank five meeting challenges from hardest (1) to easiest (5): <i>getting a word in</i> · <i>disagreeing with someone senior</i> · <i>following fast speakers</i> · <i>understanding what was decided</i> · <i>chairing</i> . Pairs compare. Quick class poll (hands, no names). Say: "Think of a workplace you know, from any country, or a role card. You don't have to talk about your current job." Link: "Today we'll get the phrases for all five."
Model: the weekly sync (listen)	10	S → S-S	Slide 4 (the agenda). Workbook Ex 1. First listening (gist): read Script 2.1-A . "What's the meeting for? What did they decide about the launch date?" Pairs check. Second listening (detail): learners complete the action-point table and tick the phrases they hear. Check on the board. Ask: "Is 'we'll talk about photos' an action point?" (No: who? when?)
Clarify: roles, phrases, turn-taking	12	T-S → S	Slides 4–6. Elicit the three documents from the listening; board the who / what / when rule. Then the phrase banks by function, using the flashcards: stick the six function labels on the board (Opinion · Agree · Disagree · Clarify · Turn-taking · Chair) and let learners place the phrase cards. Focus on acknowledge → differ and signal before you interrupt . Meaning, form and pronunciation with the CCQs below. Learners then do Workbook Ex 2 (sort 12 phrases) alone and check in pairs.
Drill: polite tone	8	T-S → S	Slide 6. See the Drill script: stress and a friendly, rising "signal" intonation for interrupting; fall-rise on <i>point</i> in "I see your point , but..."; a clear fall on the chair's closing lines. Choral, then small groups, then individuals. Contrast a flat version with the polite version once so learners can hear how flat intonation sounds rude or bored.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Slide 7 (the chair's five stages). Workbook Ex 3 (suggestion grammar + find and fix), Ex 4 (put the chair's lines in order) and Ex 5 (make it polite). Early finishers write a second polite version of each Ex 5 line. Pairs compare; check Ex 3 and 4 quickly on the board; for Ex 5, ask two or three pairs to say their version with the right tone.
Freer prep: the meeting planner	6	S-S	Slide 8. Groups of four, one scenario each (Set B). Roles: chair , participant A , participant B , observer / minute-taker . Each learner reads only their own card. The chair writes the three-item agenda in the workbook meeting planner; participants choose three phrases they will use and underline their "hidden goal." ICQs first (below).
Freer: meeting simulation	12	S-S	The chair opens and runs the meeting (10 minutes on the timer). Each participant must give an opinion, disagree politely at least once, interrupt with a signal at least once, and ask one clarification question. The observer ticks the checklist on the observer card and notes the action points. Walk around and take notes for feedback (useful lines, errors, tone). Give a 2-minute warning: "Chairs, time to decide and close."
Action points + observer report	5	S-S	The group writes up the action points (who / what / by when) in the workbook. The observer reports back to the group using the checklist, in this order: one thing the chair did well · one polite interruption they heard · one moment that could be more diplomatic. Groups read their action points aloud to the class (one sentence each: "Tom will confirm the room by Thursday.").
Feedback and delayed error correction	10	T-S	Board 5-6 lines you heard, no names: two to copy (a good signal phrase, a clear action point) and three or four to fix (register, tone or grammar: "You are wrong." · "I am agree." · "We need to discuss about it." · "I suggest to wait."). Pairs fix; learners say the good versions with polite intonation. Then one question to the class for each rubric criterion: Task & Purpose (did your meeting end with action points?) · Register & Tone (did every disagreement start with acknowledgement?) · Language Range & Accuracy (which new phrase did you use?) · Organization & Delivery (did the chair signpost each item?).
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 2.1 on screen and point at a 🗣️ button and the UK/US voice switch. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			can..." box in the workbook and write one phrase in "My useful phrases" that they will use in a real (or imagined) meeting this week.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 10 + 12 + 8 + 10 + 6 + 12 + 5 + 10 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: action point. A task agreed in a meeting, with a person, a task and a deadline. Without all three, it is a hope, not an action point.

SAY: "We should look at the budget." *Is that an action point? (No.) What's missing? (Who and when.)* · "Priya will circulate the budget by Friday." *Who? (Priya.) What? (Circulate the budget.) When? (By Friday.)* · *Who usually recaps the action points at the end? (The chair.)*

Meaning: minutes and agenda.

SAY: "I'll send the minutes around this afternoon." *Is minutes about time here? (No: the written record of the meeting.)* · *When do people get the agenda: before or after the meeting? (Before.) The minutes? (After.)*

Meaning: park it · take it offline. Chair language for stopping a topic now without ignoring it.

SAY: "Let's park that and take it offline." *Are we discussing it now? (No.) Are we forgetting it? (No: later, outside this meeting, maybe with fewer people.) Does offline mean the internet is off? (No.) Who usually says it? (The chair.)*

Meaning: the interruption signal.

SAY: "Sorry to interrupt, but can I just come in here?" *Is the speaker really sorry? (Not really: it's a polite signal.) Do you say it before or after you talk over someone? (Before: instead of talking over them.) What does just do? (Makes the request smaller and softer.)* · "If I could just finish my point..." *Who says this: the person interrupting or the person being interrupted? (The person being interrupted: they are holding the floor.)*

Meaning: acknowledge, then differ.

SAY: "I see your point, but I'm not sure the copy will be ready." *Does the speaker agree? (No.) Why start with "I see your point"? (To show respect; it keeps the room warm.)* · "Have we considered pushing the date?" *Is it a real question? (Partly: it's a polite way to disagree and suggest.)*

Form.

Suggestions	verb form after each starter	Why don't we ask ...? · Shall we ask ...? · What if we ask / asked ...? · How about asking ...? · I'd suggest (that) we ask ... · I suggest asking ... (✗ I suggest to ask)
Agree / disagree	<i>agree</i> is a verb	I agree. · I don't agree. · Do you agree? (✗ I am agree · ✗ Are you agree?) · I'm not sure I agree. · I'm with you on that.
discuss	no preposition	discuss the budget (✗ discuss about) · but: a discussion about / talk about
Meeting verbs	collocations	have / hold a meeting (✗ make) · attend a meeting (✗ assist) · chair a meeting · take the minutes · circulate / send around the agenda
Action points	name + <i>will</i> + verb + <i>by</i> + time	Tom will call the client by tomorrow. · Can I confirm, you'll handle this by Friday?

Pronunciation. Interrupting phrases need a **friendly, rising** tone and a small pause after them: *Sorry to interRUPT, but...* ↗ · *Can I just come IN here?* ↗. Said flat and fast, they sound like an order. In "I see your **POINT**, but...", a **fall-rise** on *point* tells the listener that a "but" is coming. The chair's summaries **fall** clearly at the end (*So, to sumMARize...* ↘), which sounds decisive. Weak forms: *to* /tə/ in "Sorry to interrupt"; *can* /kən/ in "Can I just...".

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Signal and pause** (choral, then individual). T: "Sorry to interRUPT, but..." (pause, hand up) → S repeat. "Can I just come **IN** here?" · "If I could **ADD** something..." · "May I jump **IN**?" Then the **flat** version once ("CanIjustcomeinhere"): "Polite or rude?" (Rude.) Back to the polite version.
- 2 Acknowledge, then differ** (back-chaining). T: "...I'm not sure I a**GREE**." → "...**but** I'm not sure I agree." → "I see your **POINT**, but I'm not sure I agree." Then substitution: T: "the date" → S: "I see your point, but I'm not sure about the **DATE**." T: "the budget" · "the photos" · "Friday."
- 3 Chair chain** (around the room, one line each, keep it moving): "Thanks everyone for **COMing**." → "Shall we get **STARTed**?" → "First on the **Agenda** is..." → "Let's **MOVE** on to..." → "Let's **PARK** that." → "So, to **SUMmarize**..." → "Are we all a**GREED**?" → "To recap the **ACtion** points..." → "Thanks everyone, that was pro**DUCTive**." Twice round; the second time faster.

◆ MEETING SIMULATION – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of four:** chair, participant A, participant B, observer. With three in a group, drop the observer and the chair takes the notes; with five, add a second observer or a "participant C" who simply has to bring someone in and ask one clarification question. Put a confident speaker in the chair for the first run; the chair role is also a good **stretch** for C1 learners.

- ◆ **Scenarios** (Set B, all fictional): 1 Kestrel Design, the office move date · 2 Brightline Foods, the trade-show stand budget · 3 Northwind Logistics, the holiday delivery schedule · 4 Tidewater Packaging, the team training day. Each participant card has a position, a reason and a **hidden goal** (for example, "get one action point assigned to someone else"). The positions clash a little, so there is something to disagree about, but a compromise is always possible.
- ◆ **Timing:** 10 minutes on the timer, visible to the chair. Give a 2-minute warning. The meeting is "finished" only when the chair has recapped at least two action points.
- ◆ **Observer checklist** (on the observer card, using the rubric criteria): **Task & Purpose** ☐ agenda followed ☐ a decision made ☐ action points with who / what / when · **Register & Tone** ☐ disagreement acknowledged first ☐ interruptions signaled ☐ quieter person brought in · **Language Range & Accuracy** ☐ phrases from three or more functions ☐ suggestion grammar correct · **Organization & Delivery** ☐ chair signposted each item ☐ time managed ☐ clear close.
- ◆ **If time allows** (or in a longer class), swap roles and run a second scenario for 8 minutes, so a second learner chairs.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE MEETING SIMULATION

SAY: *Can you show your card to the others? (No: only your own.) · Chairs: what must happen before you finish? (Recap the action points.) · Participants: how many times must you interrupt? (At least once, with a signal.) How do you disagree? (Acknowledge first, then differ.) · Observers: do you speak in the meeting? (No: you tick the checklist and write the action points.) · How long? (Ten minutes.) · Is it your real company? (No: the card's.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

SUPPORT (B1)

Give B1 learners the **participant** or **observer** role first, not the chair. Before the simulation, they choose and write **one phrase for each of four functions** on a sticky note (opinion · disagree · interrupt · clarify) and keep it in front of them: reading from a note is fine. In Ex 5, do items 1–3 only, with the starter given ("Sorry to...", "I see your point, but..."). In the listening, let them tick phrases in Ex 1 on the first listening instead of the second, and give them the "who" column of the action-point table filled in.

STRETCH (C1)

C1 learners **chair**, with a constraint card: "You have only 8 minutes, and participant A tends to go off topic: park at least one tangent." Or play a participant who must **hold the floor** twice and **bring in** the quietest person by name. In Ex 5, they write two versions of each line: a **neutral** one for colleagues and a **more formal** one for a meeting with a senior client ("If I might come in on that point..."). Early finishers draft the minutes of their meeting in four lines.

◆ L1 AND CROSS-CULTURAL WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ ***I am agree / Are you agree?***: common among learners whose languages express agreement with "be" + an adjective or noun (Spanish *estoy de acuerdo*, French *je suis d'accord*, Portuguese *estou de acordo*, and others). In English, *agree* is a verb: *I agree · Do you agree?*
- ◆ ***discuss about, make a meeting, assist a meeting***: direct translations from many languages. *Discuss* takes a direct object; you *have / hold* a meeting; you *attend* it (in English, *assist* means "help").
- ◆ ***I suggest to... / How about to...***: very frequent. Drill the three patterns (base verb · -ing · that + we + base verb) until they are automatic.
- ◆ **Interrupting norms differ**. Some workplace cultures see interrupting as a sign of engagement; others expect people to wait to be invited, especially junior staff speaking to senior staff. Neither is "right." Present the signal phrases as a **bridge**: learners who find interrupting uncomfortable can use a signal, and learners who interrupt freely can soften it. For chairs: silence does not always mean agreement, so invite quieter people by name.
- ◆ **First names vs titles**. Many English-speaking workplaces use first names in meetings, even with managers. Some learners find this disrespectful at first. Tell them it is normal and not rude, but also that it is always fine to follow the other person's lead.
- ◆ **Flat intonation** can sound rude or bored in English even when the words are polite; some learners' first languages use a narrower pitch range. The Drill script's "flat vs polite" contrast is worth doing more than once.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_04.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and say them back (try the US voice, then the UK voice); do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 2.1: finish Ex 5 if needed, complete the **meeting planner** for a meeting you really attend or one from a role card (agenda with three items + two action points), "My useful phrases" and the journal. Optional: in your next real or online meeting, use one signal phrase and notice whether the meeting ends with clear action points.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** "Sorry to interrupt, but can I just come in here?" · Q2 **B** "Priya — circulate the updated budget — by Friday" (who / what / when) · Q3 **B** "To recap the action points, ..." · Q4 **C** "I'd suggest we wait until Monday." Ex 1: purpose = check the Northwind website launch is on track · decision = launch on the 12th if the photos arrive by Wednesday · Tom: call the client about the photos, by tomorrow · Marco: finish the last two pages, by Thursday · Priya: circulate the updated budget, by Friday · phrases heard: 1, 2, 4, 5, 6, 8 (not 3, 7). Ex 4 order: b d f h e c a g. Full answers in the answer key.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ start a conversation with a stranger using **shared context** (the event, the situation, the surroundings) and turn closed questions into **open questions**
- ◆ keep a conversation going with the "rapport engine": follow-up questions, active-listening reactions, common ground and **free information**
- ◆ choose **safe topics** and recognize risky ones, knowing that "safe" varies across cultures and following the other person's lead
- ◆ introduce themselves in one or two sentences, join a group, exchange contacts and **exit gracefully**
- ◆ write a short follow-up message within 48 hours: reminder + specific reference + light next step

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.2 (key words, phrase bank, language box, model follow-up email, Exercises 1–5, networking toolkit, mingle notes, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 9–12 · Flashcards: openers, reactions and exit lines (Set A) · **Networking identity cards** + mini business cards (Set C) · a bell or phone timer
- ◆ Listening script **2.2-A** (the coffee line at the Regional Logistics Expo: two versions)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the arc. Open (shared context) → Sustain (questions + free info) → Connect (swap contacts) → Exit (warm) → Follow up (within 48 hrs).

Center: the rapport engine. ✗ Are you enjoying it? (→ "Yes.") ✓ **What** are you enjoying most? · **How / What / Which / Why** · Answer + free info + question back: "I'm in logistics — I actually moved over from teaching last year. How about you?" · Reactions: *Oh really?* · *That sounds interesting — tell me more.* · *Same here, actually!* · "Great turnout, isn't it? ↘" (falling = you expect agreement).

Right: topics and exits. Safe: work, the event, travel in, food, sport, hobbies, weekend. Risky with strangers: politics, religion, money / salary, health, age, relationships, gossip. "Safe" varies: **watch and follow their lead**. Exit: enjoyed it + light reason + stay in touch: *It's been great talking — I should go and say hello to a few others. Let's stay in touch.*

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: action-point relay	7	S-S → T-S	Review C5. In their C5 groups, learners reread their action points and then say them to a new partner from memory as a

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			chair would: "To recap the action points: Tom will... by..." The partner checks for who / what / when. Then quick-fire: T says a blunt meeting line ("Stop. I want to speak."), learners give the polite version. Link: "Meetings often start with five minutes of chat. What do people talk about before a meeting starts?"
Lead-in: is small talk a waste of time?	5	T-S → S-S	Slide 9 (the question only). Learners stand on a line: "Small talk at work is a waste of time" (agree ← → disagree). Two or three explain their position. Then pairs: "In workplaces you know, how much small talk happens before business? What topics are normal?" Stress tendencies, not nationalities: "In some workplaces... in others..." Link: in many workplaces, trust and even deals start in these five minutes.
Model: two conversations (listen)	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 2.2-A, version 1 (it stalls). "How long did it last? Why did it die?" (Closed questions, no free information.) Then version 2 (it flows): learners note the opener, two follow-up questions, each person's free information, the common ground, and the exit. Pairs compare; check on slide 9.
Clarify: the rapport engine	10	T-S	Slides 10–11. Open vs closed questions (CCQs below); "free information" as answer + extra + question back ; question tags that expect agreement; the safe / risky table with the culture note ("watch how your counterpart responds and follow their lead"). Put the opener, reaction and exit flashcards on the board in three groups.
Drill: interest and agreement	7	T-S → S	See the Drill script: wide, interested pitch on reactions (<i>Oh REALLY?</i>); falling tags for agreement (<i>Great TURNout, ISN'T it?</i> ♫); warm exits. Choral, then pairs: A says a fact about their day or a role-card fact, B reacts with a reaction + a follow-up question.
Controlled practice	12	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (open it up), Ex 3 (safe or risky, plus "it depends"), Ex 4 (rescue the dead-end reply) and Ex 5 (the graceful exit). Pairs compare. Check Ex 2 and 3 quickly; for Ex 4, pairs <i>perform</i> one rescued mini-dialogue each, with interest in their voices.
Build the toolkit	6	S	Workbook "My networking toolkit": one opener, three go-to safe topics, one self-introduction (name, role, a friendly hook: from the identity card or their own), one exit line. Hand out the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			identity cards now. Learners may use the card or their own professional identity (real or past job): say clearly that both are fine.
Freer: the networking mingle	15	S-S	Slide 12. The room is the coffee area of a business event. Everyone stands. Each learner has an identity card and mini business cards. The goal: talk to at least three people, find the common ground with at least two, exchange cards with anyone you want to follow up with, and exit gracefully each time. Ring the bell every 3-4 minutes : "Exit now, politely, and find someone new." Learners note each contact in the workbook (name · company · common ground · follow-up idea). ICQs first (below). You join in as a guest with your own card; it's the best way to hear and to model.
Follow-up message	8	S → S-S	Learners choose one contact from the mingle and write a follow-up email (60-90 words) using the model in the workbook: reminder + specific reference + light next step. They swap with that contact (or any partner), who writes a two-line reply. Monitor for register (neutral and warm, not stiff: ✗ "I am writing to inform you that I met you").
Feedback and delayed error correction	7	T-S	Board 5-6 lines from the mingle and the emails: good openers and reactions to copy; errors to fix ("What is your salary?" → change topic; "Nice to meet you" said to someone already met → <i>Nice to see you again</i> ; "I am working in logistics since three years" → <i>I've been working in logistics for three years</i> ; "Dear Mr. Hamid" → <i>Dear Mr. Karimi</i> or <i>Hi Hamid</i>). Ask: "Who found common ground? How? Which exit line felt most natural?"
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 2.2 and a 🔊 button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can..." and add their best new phrase to "My useful phrases."
Total	90		7 + 5 + 8 + 10 + 7 + 12 + 6 + 15 + 8 + 7 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: open question. A question that cannot be answered with just "yes" or "no."

SAY: "Are you enjoying the conference?" Can the answer be one word? (Yes: "Yes.") Is that good for a conversation? (No: it can stop.) · "What are you enjoying most so far?" One word? (No.) Which words

start open questions? (How, What, Which, Why.) · Is a closed opener always wrong? (No, if your next question is open.)

Meaning: How are you finding...?

SAY: "How are you finding the conference?" Are you asking where the conference is? (No.) What are you asking? (Their opinion so far.) Is it only for conferences? (No: the new job, the city, the software...)

Meaning: free information.

SAY: "I'm in logistics — I actually moved over from teaching last year, so it's all quite new." Is the information free of cost? (Yes, but that's not the meaning.) What is it? (Extra information you give without being asked.) Why give it? (It gives the other person a hook for their next question.) What's a good question back? ("Oh, why the change?") Must it be personal or private? (No: work, the event, your trip in, a hobby is enough.)

Meaning: exit lines.

SAY: "I won't keep you." Are you stopping them from leaving? (No: it's a polite way to end: "I'll let you go.") · "I should go and say hello to a few others." Is it rude? (No: it's normal at a networking event.) What should come next? (Something warm: "Let's stay in touch.")

Form.

Open questions	question word + auxiliary + subject	What did you think of the keynote? · How did you get into that? · Which session are you going to next? · What brings you here today?
Tags for agreement	positive statement + negative tag, falling tone	Great turnout, isn't it? ↘ · It's busy today, isn't it? ↘ · You're from the design team, aren't you? (↗ = a real question)
Free information	answer + extra + question back	"Not far: just an hour on the train, so not bad. Are you local? "
follow up	verb (two words) · noun / adjective (hyphen)	I'll follow up next week. · a follow-up email · Thanks for the follow-up .
Present perfect for experience	have + past participle (+ for / since)	Have you been to one of these before? · I've worked in purchasing for six years. (✗ I am working in purchasing since six years)

Pronunciation. Interest is carried by **pitch range**: Oh **REALLY?** ↗ and That sounds **INteresting** start high and move a lot; said flat, they sound sarcastic or bored. Tags that expect agreement **fall**: Great **TURNout**, **ISN'T**

it? ↘. Linking in fast openers: *Have you been to one of these before?* → /həvʲə 'bɪn tə 'wʌnən ði:z brɪ'fɔ:r/.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Reactions** (choral, exaggerate first, then natural). T: "Oh **REALLY?**" · "That sounds **INTEResting** — tell me **MORE.**" · "How did you get **INTo** that?" · "Same **HERE,** actually!" · "That must be **CHALlenging.**" Then T says a fact ("I just moved from finance to logistics."), individuals react with a reaction + a follow-up question.
- 2 **Falling tags.** T: "Great **TURNout, ISN'T** it? ↘" → S repeat. Substitution: "busy" → "It's **BUsy** today, **ISN'T** it?" · "long line" → "This line's quite **LONG, ISN'T** it?" · "good talk" → "That was a good **TALK, WASN'T** it?"
- 3 **Exit chain** (pairs, A exits, B responds warmly, then swap): A: "It's been great **TALKing** — I should go and say hello to a few **OTHERs.**" B: "Of **COURSE.** Great to meet you." A: "Let's stay in **TOUCH.**" B: "**DEFinitely.** Here's my **CARD.**"

◆ NETWORKING MINGLE – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Set the scene.** "This is the coffee break at the Riverside Business Breakfast. You don't know anyone." Put a few cups or a jug of water on a table as the "coffee area": it helps learners step into the role.
- ◆ **Identity cards** (Set C): twelve invented professionals with a name, role, company, a "free information" fact and a hobby or recent experience. Each card shares one point of **common ground** with two others (the same city trip, the same hobby, the same work challenge), so every learner can find it by asking. For more than twelve learners, print a second set: duplicates are fine. Learners can use their own professional identity instead, as long as they are comfortable.
- ◆ **Rounds:** ring the bell every 3–4 minutes. Each time, learners must **exit with an exit line** (not just walk away) and join someone new. In round 2, some must **join a pair** ("Mind if I join you?"), and the pair must include them.
- ◆ **Monitor with the rubric in mind:** **Task & Purpose** (common ground found, contacts exchanged) · **Register & Tone** (safe topics, warm reactions) · **Language Range & Accuracy** (open questions, tags) · **Organization & Delivery** (a clear open → sustain → exit shape, balance of talking and listening).
- ◆ **Quieter learners** can move in pairs for the first round ("a colleague from the same company"). Introverts often listen very well: praise good follow-up questions as loudly as confident talking.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE MINGLE

SAY: *How many people will you talk to? (At least three.) What are you looking for? (Common ground.) When the bell rings, do you just walk away? (No: use an exit line.) Can you ask about salary? (No: stay on safe topics.) Must you use your real job? (No: the card is fine.) What do you write after each conversation? (Name, company, common ground, follow-up idea.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

SUPPORT (B1)

B1 learners write their toolkit on a small card and may read it during the first round. Give them a **three-line frame** for free information: "I'm a ___ at ___. I actually ___. How about you?" In Ex 2, do items 1–4 with the question word given. In the follow-up email, use the model as a template and change only the details (who, where, what you talked about, next step). Pair them with a patient partner for round 1 of the mingle.

STRETCH (C1)

C1 learners get a **mission card**: "Introduce two people you have met to each other" ("Joanna, have you met Hamid? He's in route planning; you were just talking about delivery times.") or "Politely steer the conversation back from a risky topic your partner starts." In the email, they write two versions: one to a peer, one to a senior contact they met briefly, and compare the register. Early finishers draft a connection request for a professional networking site in 25 words or fewer.

◆ L1 AND CROSS-CULTURAL WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Topic norms vary.** In some workplace cultures, questions about family, marital status, age or even salary are friendly and normal; in many English-speaking workplaces they feel intrusive with a stranger. Present this as a **difference in codes**, not good vs bad manners. The safe strategy: start on the safe list, watch the other person's response, and follow their lead. Learners should also know how to **deflect** a question they don't want to answer: "Oh, that's a long story! How about you, what brings you here?"
- ◆ **Interview mode.** Some learners ask question after question to be polite, which can feel like an interrogation in English. Others answer in one word to be modest. Teach the rhythm: **answer + free info + question back**.
- ◆ **Formality.** Learners may use a formal written style in follow-up messages ("I am writing to inform you that it was a pleasure...", "Kindly revert"). A neutral, warm register is expected: "It was great to meet you at...". Titles with first names ("Mr. Hamid") are a common error; use *Mr. / Ms.* + **family name**, or the first name alone.
- ◆ **Present perfect with *for / since*:** "I am working here since 2019" is very common among learners whose languages use a present tense for this. Model *I've worked / I've been working here since 2019*.
- ◆ **"Nice to meet you" vs "Nice to see you (again)":** *meet* for the first time, *see* after that. At a networking event, learners who meet the same person twice often repeat "Nice to meet you."
- ◆ **Humor and self-deprecation** ("I'm probably the reason your deliveries are late!") are common in English small talk but can confuse. Point it out when it appears in Script 2.2-A: it's friendly, not a real confession.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_05.html. Shadow the five model sentences with 🗣️; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 2.2: finalize "My networking toolkit," complete the mingle notes, "My useful phrases" and the journal. Optional: use one opener and one follow-up

question in a real conversation this week (at work, a class, a community event), or send one genuine follow-up message you have been meaning to write.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** "What's been the most useful session for you so far?" · Q2 **B** the event and the venue · Q3 **B** answer + free information + question back · Q4 **A** within 24–48 hours. Ex 1 (version 2): opener "This line for coffee is quite something, isn't it?" · follow-up questions: "What did you think of it?", "How's that going?", "How did you get into route planning?", "What do you miss most?" · common ground: both changed careers; tracking deliveries · contacts: they swap business cards · exit: "I should go and say hello to a few people before the next session, but it was really good to meet you." Full answers in the answer key.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ tell **passive**, **aggressive** and **assertive** responses apart, and aim for assertive: honest *and* considerate, firm on substance, soft on delivery
- ◆ use the **softening toolkit** (hedging, qualifiers, question forms, past / continuous for distance, positive framing, prefacing) without over-softening
- ◆ disagree and push back with the pattern **acknowledge → different view → reason (→ proposal)**
- ◆ give feedback with **Situation → Behavior → Impact**, one honest positive and a question, and receive feedback without defending
- ◆ say no without burning bridges (an alternative, a visible trade-off, or buying time), and de-escalate a complaint: acknowledge the feeling → focus on the problem → common ground → way forward

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.3 (warm-up voicemail notes, key words, language box, phrase bank, Exercises 1–5, hard-conversation planner, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 13–16 · Flashcards: blunt ↔ diplomatic pairs (Set A) · **Hard-conversation A/B cards** (Set D, one set per group of three) · **Register Dominoes** (Set E, one set per pair)
- ◆ Listening scripts 2.2-B (the voicemail from Mei Lin, warmer), 2.3-A (feedback: weak vs strong), 2.3-B (the late-delivery complaint call)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the line. PASSIVE (you lose: "It's fine, whatever.") ← **ASSERTIVE** (honest + considerate: "I see it a little differently, and I'd like to explain why.") → AGGRESSIVE (they lose: "That's a bad idea."). **Firm on substance · soft on delivery.**

Center: the toolkit. hedge (*I think we might...*) · qualifier (*a slight concern · a little tight*) · question (*Would it be possible to...? · Have we considered...?*) · distance (*I was wondering if we could...*) · positive frame (*I can definitely... by Thursday*) · preface (*I take your point, but...*). One or two, not five!

Right: the hard moments. Feedback = Situation → Behavior → Impact + honest positive + question. Receive = listen · thank · ask (*Could you give me an example?*) · don't defend. Say no = alternative · trade-off · buy time. Conflict = acknowledge the feeling → problem, not person → common ground → way forward.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: a voicemail from a new contact	7	S → S-S	Review C6 (and C4's phone skills). Read Script 2.2-B twice: a voicemail from Mei Lin, who met "you" at a business breakfast. Learners complete the notes at the top of Workbook 2.3 (who, company, where you met, what you talked about, next step, number, when she's free). Pairs check, then role-play the call-back in 2 minutes: B is Mei, A returns the call, refers to something specific and agrees a next step. Link: "Relationships start easily. Today: how to keep them when you have to disagree or say no."
Lead-in: where on the line?	5	T-S	Slide 13. Situation: "Your manager asks: 'Can you take on the Harlow report by Friday?' You're already at capacity." Read three answers: A "Um, sure, no problem." (passive) · B "No. I've got too much already." (aggressive) · C "I'd like to help. To do it well by Friday, I'd need to move the client summary to next week. Which is the priority?" (assertive). Learners point to the left, middle or right of the line on the board. Elicit what C does: it says the truth, respects the manager and offers a way forward.
Model: feedback, weak vs strong (listen)	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 2.3-A : the weak version, then the strong version. "Which one would you prefer to receive? Why?" Second listening to the strong version: learners label Situation, Behavior and Impact, and find the honest positive, the question, the proposal and Daniel's "receiving" phrase. Check on slide 15.
Clarify: the softening toolkit	12	T-S → S	Slide 14. Take the six moves one by one with the CCQs below; learners find an example of each in the phrase bank. Stress the warning: softeners are seasoning, not the meal ("I was just perhaps wondering if it might possibly be a slight concern..."). Then the SBI structure and the receiving-feedback phrases (slide 15), and the three ways to say no (slide 16). Language box in the workbook.
Drill: firm and friendly	7	T-S → S	See the Drill script. Stress lands on the content words that carry the firm part (<i>I have a slight conCERN about the BUDget</i>), not on the softeners. Choral → individual. Then "tone swap": T says a line aggressively; learners say the assertive version.
Controlled practice	12	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (passive, aggressive or assertive?), Ex 3 (add a softener) and Ex 4 (rewrite the blunt messages, items 1-2 in class). Pairs then play Register Dominoes (Set E, 4 minutes):

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			match each blunt line to its diplomatic version to build a closed loop. Check Ex 2 quickly; hear two or three Ex 4 rewrites aloud.
Model 2: the complaint call (listen)	6	S → T-S	Workbook Ex 5. Read Script 2.3-B (two voices). Learners put the four de-escalation steps in order and write the phrase Sam used for each. Ask: "Did Sam blame the driver? Did he promise something he can't do? What exactly will he do, and by when?" Board the four steps as a frame for the next stage.
Freer: the hard-conversation carousel	17	S-S	Slide 16. Groups of three: A (says the difficult thing), B (reacts, following the card), C (observer). Three rounds of 5 minutes (1 minute to read and plan in the workbook planner, 3 minutes to talk, 1 minute for the observer's feedback), rotating roles, so everyone plays A once. Cards (Set D): disagree with a manager's plan · say no to a colleague · give SBI feedback · handle a customer complaint · push back on a deadline · receive feedback. ICQs first (below).
Feedback and delayed error correction	8	T-S	Board 5–6 lines from the carousel: two firm-and-friendly lines to copy, three or four to fix (too blunt: "You must send it today." → <i>Could you send it today? It's holding up the client report.</i> ; too soft: "Maybe, if it's possible, perhaps..." → one softener + the point; grammar: "I was wondering if we can..." → <i>could</i>). Ask each observer for one line they heard that was firm on substance, soft on delivery .
Module wrap-up and C8 preview	3	T-S	Slide 17. Explain C8 calmly: a 35-minute timed writing paper (a reply email to a client and three messages rewritten into the right register) and a speaking simulation in pairs at your table (two short phone calls and a short meeting, about 7 minutes) while the others do a quiet reading task. Show the four rubric criteria: two scores, Writing /20 and Speaking /20. "It's a check of what you can do now, not a pass or fail. You'll get your results privately in the next class." Learners should arrive on time; bring the workbook and a pen.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 2.3 and a  button. Set the homework (below), including the review for C8. Learners tick "I can..." for 2.3.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 8 + 12 + 7 + 12 + 6 + 17 + 8 + 3 + 5

Meaning: assertive.

SAY: *Is assertive the same as aggressive? (No.) Does an assertive person say what they need? (Yes.) Do they respect the other person? (Yes.) · "Fine, I'll just do it myself." Did the speaker say what they really need? (No: passive.) · "You always leave this to the last minute." Is that about the work or the person? (The person: aggressive.)*

Meaning: distance with past forms.

SAY: *"I was wondering if we could revisit the deadline." Is the speaker talking about the past? (No: now.) Why the past form? (It sounds more tentative and polite.) Is it weaker than "I want to revisit the deadline"? (Softer, but the request is the same.)*

Meaning: understatement.

SAY: *"I have a slight concern about the budget." Is the problem always small? (No: it may be big.) Why say "slight"? (It softens; it keeps the other person open.) Will everyone hear it the same way? (No: some listeners hear "slight" as small, others as a strong signal. If it's serious, add the reason.)*

Meaning: at capacity · take on board.

SAY: *"I'm at capacity right now." Is the speaker lazy? (No.) What does it mean? (No more time: fully busy.) · "Let me take that on board." Does it mean "I agree"? (Not necessarily: "I accept it and I'll think about it.")*

Meaning: Situation → Behavior → Impact.

SAY: *"You're careless." Behavior or person? (Person.) "In the section you owned, a few figures didn't match the summary table." Behavior or person? (Behavior: something we can see.) "...and the client noticed." Which part is that? (Impact.) Why is SBI hard to argue with? (It describes facts, not a judgment.)*

Form.

Hedging	I think / perhaps + modal	I think we might be underestimating the timeline. · It could be worth checking.
Question forms	Would it be possible to + verb? · Have we considered + -ing / noun?	Would it be possible to push it a week? · Have we considered using the other supplier?
Distance	I was wondering if + could · I was hoping (that) + could	I was wondering if we could meet on Monday. (X can sounds mixed)

Saying no	I'm afraid I can't + verb, but I can / could + verb	I'm afraid I can't lead it, but I could review the draft. · That won't be possible by Friday. Would next week work?
Pushing back	I'd push back (gently) on that, because + clause	I'd push back gently on that, because the testing protects the launch.

Pronunciation. The softeners are said **lightly and quickly**; the stress falls on the **content** that stays firm: / *think we might be under***EST**imating the **TIME**line. Rising, open intonation on the proposal invites agreement: *Would* **THAT** work for you? ↗. For de-escalation, a **slower pace and lower pitch** calm the other person: "I under**STAND** this is **FRU**strating."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Firm words, light softeners** (choral, then individual). T: "I have a slight con**CERN** about the **BUD**get." · "I see it a little **DIF**ferently." · "Would it be possible to push the **DEAD**line?" · "I'm afraid I can't take that **ON** this week." · "One thing that worked really well was the **LAY**out."
- 2 Tone swap** (T aggressive → S assertive, fast). T: "That won't work." → S: "I'm not sure that'll work, because..." · T: "No. Ask someone else." → S: "I'd love to help, but I'm at capacity. Could I help next week?" · T: "Your email was confusing." → S: "One suggestion: could we put the main question at the top?"
- 3 Receiving** (pairs). A gives a one-line piece of feedback from a list on slide 15; B answers with "Thanks for telling me. Could you give me an **EX**ample?" or "That's fair. Let me take that on **BOARD**." No defending allowed: if B starts "Yes, but...", A says "Buzz!" and B tries again.

◆ HARD-CONVERSATION CAROUSEL – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of three** (A, B, C), each with one set of Set D cards, face down. Each round, A takes the next card and reads the **A side**; B reads the **B side** (how to react: for example, "At first, don't accept. Accept if A offers a reasonable alternative."). C takes the observer role.
- ◆ **Round shape (5 minutes)**: 1 minute to plan (A writes the opening line in the workbook planner using a frame: acknowledge → view / SBI → reason → proposal) · 3 minutes to talk · 1 minute for C's feedback. Rotate roles. Groups of two: skip the observer and give feedback to each other with the checklist.
- ◆ **Observer checklist** (rubric criteria): **Task & Purpose** ☐ the real message was clear ☐ a way forward was agreed · **Register & Tone** ☐ acknowledged first ☐ one or two softeners, not too many ☐ no blame words (*always, never, you're...*) · **Language Range & Accuracy** ☐ toolkit phrases used correctly · **Organization & Delivery** ☐ calm pace ☐ the firm point was stressed, not swallowed.
- ◆ All situations are ordinary and fictional (deadlines, workloads, late reports, a delivery delay). Learners who want to prepare for a real conversation may adapt a card *privately* in the planner, but no one is asked to share a real situation.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE CAROUSEL

SAY: A: what do you say first? (Acknowledge: the view or the feeling.) Can you change the real message to avoid conflict? (No: stay firm on substance.) · B: do you agree at once? (No: follow your card.) · C: what do you use? (The checklist.) · How many rounds? (Three: everyone is A once.) · Is it a real situation from your job? (No: the card's.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

SUPPORT (B1)

Give B1 learners the **partially completed frames** in the workbook planner ("I understand _____. I see it a little differently, because _____. Would it be possible to _____?") and the easier cards first (say no to a colleague; receive feedback). In Ex 3, do items 1–4 with the first word given. In Ex 4, do messages 1 and 2 only in class. Remind them: one softener plus the point is enough; they don't need all six moves.

STRETCH (C1)

C1 learners take the harder cards (push back on a senior manager's plan; handle the complaint) with a **register-shift constraint**: say the same message twice, once to a very direct counterpart (shorter, plainer) and once to an indirect one (more acknowledgement, more questions). In Ex 4, add a fifth message of their own and a version for a chat message (short, still polite). As observers, they note the **exact words** that made a line firm or soft.

◆ L1 AND CROSS-CULTURAL WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Directness varies widely.** In some workplaces, disagreement and feedback are expected to be explicit; in others, a "small concern" or a silence is the strong message. Neither is more professional. Teach learners to **calibrate**: with a very direct counterpart, get to the point; with an indirect one, lead with more acknowledgement and listen for what is not said. Avoid national labels in class discussion; say "some workplaces" and "some people."
- ◆ **Over-direct translations:** "I want you send the report today," "You must correct this," "Do it by Friday." In many languages these are neutral; in English workplaces they can sound like orders. Model *Could you... · Would it be possible to... · I'd need it by...*
- ◆ **Over-formal or archaic formulas:** "Kindly do the needful," "Please revert back," "I am writing to inform you that..." in every message. Show the neutral modern version beside each one.
- ◆ **"Yes" that means no.** In some workplace cultures, "I'll try" or "It may be difficult" is a polite refusal; in others it is heard as a promise. Teach the clear-but-kind no: "I'm afraid I can't..., but I could..." and the time-buyer: "Let me check and get back to you this afternoon."
- ◆ **Feedback to seniors.** Some learners come from workplaces where giving feedback upward is not done. Keep the cards peer-to-peer or manager-to-team-member for feedback, and use "pushing back on a plan" (not "criticizing a person") for upward situations.
- ◆ **Over-apologizing** ("Sorry, sorry, I'm probably wrong...") undermines the message. One "sorry" for a real

inconvenience is enough; do not apologize for having a view.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_06.html. Shadow the five model sentences with 🗣️; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 2.3: finish Ex 4 (messages 3 and 4), "My useful phrases" and the journal. **Review for C8:** reread the "I can..." lists for Lessons 1.1–2.3 and the Module 1 email and telephoning phrase banks; look at the four rubric criteria on the Midpoint Check page of the workbook and rate yourself before the check.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 C "I see it a little differently — I'm worried about the support cost. Can we look at it together?" · Q2 B "The last two reports arrived after the deadline." · Q3 A "I'd love to help, but I'm at capacity this week. I could review the draft on Friday if that's useful?" · Q4 B acknowledge the feeling. Ex 2: 1 P · 2 As · 3 Ag · 4 P · 5 Ag · 6 As · 7 P · 8 As. Ex 5 order: acknowledge the feeling → problem, not person → common ground → way forward. Full answers in the answer key.

There is no new language today. Learners do the **Midpoint Performance Check** for Modules 1–2 ([assessment/performance-check.html](#)). **Part A** is a 35-minute timed writing paper done by everyone together: **Task 1**, a reply email to a client (Ms. Leila Varga at Brightline Foods, about a missing delivery) covering the three points in the manager's notes, about 120–170 words; **Task 2**, three messages rewritten into the right register for their reader and channel. **Part B** is a set of pair speaking simulations at your table, about 7 minutes per pair: **Call 1** (A calls B), **Call 2** (B calls A) and a short **meeting** that Card A chairs, while the rest of the class works silently on the **Reading & Ranking task** ("Choose the Venue"). Everything is scored on the **one course rubric** in [assessment/assessment-key.html](#): **Task & Purpose, Register & Tone, Language Range & Accuracy, Organization & Delivery**, 1–5 each. Each learner gets **two separate scores: Writing /20** (Task 1 and Task 2 together) and **Speaking /20** (both calls and the meeting together), never one combined number. You score speaking on the spot and mark the writing after class; learners record both scores in their [performance-tracker.html](#). Results go back privately in the **C9 warmer**. The purpose is **diagnostic**: it shows each learner (and you) what to work on in Modules 3–4, and it gives a middle point between the Class 1 diagnostic and the Final Assessment (C15–C16).

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ reply to a client's email covering every point in a set of notes, with a polite apology, a clear piece of bad news or good news, and a clear request, within the time limit
- ◆ rewrite short messages up and down the register spectrum for different readers and channels (manager chat, first email to a new client, colleague chat)
- ◆ handle two short phone calls (making a call, taking and leaving a message, spelling, numbers and read-back) and take part in or chair a short meeting that ends with action points
- ◆ (in C9) read their Writing and Speaking scores, understand one strength and one or two targets, and record them in the Performance Tracker

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ **Per learner** (from [assessment/performance-check.html](#), printed at 100%): the Part A writing paper and the Reading & Ranking task, plus 2 spares of each · one **speaking score sheet** per learner
- ◆ **Per pair**: one set of speaking cards (Call 1 A/B, Call 2 A/B, meeting Cards A and B; Card C for a trio), cut out, with the message pads · the **Part B run-sheet** and **observer prompt** (teacher only)
- ◆ For you: the rubric, the model answers and "what to listen for" notes in [assessment/assessment-key.html](#) (the model answers stay out of the room) · a phone timer · the **C8 kit** from the materials (Set F: pair-order sheet, "Speaking check in progress" sign, an extra quiet task for early finishers)
- ◆ Room: a table at one side of the room with **two chairs back to back** for the calls (so partners can't lip-read or see each other's cards), turned to face each other for the meeting. Slide 17 on screen during the

framing.

BOARD PLAN

Left: the four criteria (leave them up all class). Task & Purpose · Register & Tone · Language Range & Accuracy · Organization & Delivery: 1–5 each. Two scores: **Writing /20 · Speaking /20**.

Center: the running order. Part A starts __:__ · "start Task 2" at __:__ (25 min) · ends __:__ (35 min). Part B pairs: 1 ____ & ____ · 2 ____ & ____ · 3 ... (about 7 min each).

Right: while you wait. Reading & Ranking: Choose the Venue · silent, on your own · not scored · stop when I call you, continue when you come back. Phones off. No dictionaries in Part A.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer and framing	4	T-S · S-S	Pairs: "Say one polite way to interrupt, and one way to decline a request." Then frame the class with the words in assessment/performance-check.html ("Today is a check-up, not a final exam... You'll get two scores, one for writing and one for speaking...") and slide 17. Put the four criteria and the running order on the board and leave them there.
Part A: timed writing	35	S	Individual and silent. Start and finish times on the board; suggest about 25 minutes for Task 1 and 10 for Task 2. ICQs first: "Who are you writing to in Task 1?" (Ms. Varga, a client.) "How many points from the notes must you include?" (All three.) "In Task 2, do you correct the grammar only?" (No: change the register for the reader.) At 25 minutes: "You should be starting Task 2." Answer questions about instructions, never about language. Collect at 35 minutes; check that every paper has a name.
Reset and instructions	4	T-S	Hand out the Reading & Ranking task to everyone. Explain Part B: pairs come to your table when called; everyone else works silently on the reading task and returns to it after their turn. Announce the pairs (from your pair-order sheet). ICQs: "When you're not at my table,

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			can you talk?" (No: it's silent work.) "How many venues do you rank?" (Four.) Call pair 1.
Part B: pair speaking simulations	45	S-S (at T's table) · S	About 7 minutes per pair , following the run-sheet: Call 1 (A calls, B is the receptionist; 30 seconds to read; about 2 min) → Call 2 (swap roles with the Call 2 cards; about 2 min) → meeting (chairs face each other; 45 seconds to read; "A, you're the chair. You have three minutes"; "One minute left" at 2:00). As soon as the pair leaves, take 30 seconds to write both learners' scores, then call the next pair. Six pairs fit comfortably. See "Running the speaking simulations" below.
Close	2	T-S	Collect the reading tasks (not scored; useful for a later register warmer). Thank the class for a long, focused session. Homework: online Lesson 3.1 and a journal entry: "Which part of today felt easiest, and which felt hardest? Why?" Do not discuss scores today.
Total	90		4 + 35 + 4 + 45 + 2

FITTING EVERYONE INTO THE SPEAKING BLOCK

Six pairs (twelve learners) fit comfortably in 45 minutes; seven is possible if every pair keeps to time. With an **odd number**, make one group of three: in Call 1, C takes Card B (receptionist) while B waits; Call 2 runs as normal; everyone joins the meeting with **Card C** added. Allow about 9 minutes, with 4 for the meeting. With **more than seven pairs**, finish the remaining pairs in the C9 warmer (and move the results return to C10 for those learners), or ask a colleague to run a second table after you have both scored one pair together. Never take time from Part A: a rushed written task is not a fair measure. Whatever you do, note it on the score sheet and use the same timing for the Final Assessment, so the results can be compared.

◆ RUNNING THE SPEAKING SIMULATIONS – HOW TO DO IT WELL

- ◆ **Pairing.** Pair learners of similar confidence rather than a very strong speaker with a very hesitant one, so nobody's score depends on a partner who dominates. Give **Card A** (the chair in the meeting) to the learner who needs stretch on chairing, or who hasn't chaired in class yet. Write the pairs and roles on your pair-order sheet before class.

- ◆ **The calls.** Seat the pair back to back. "A, say 'Ring ring' when you're ready." Partners must not show each other their cards. The receptionist fills in the message pad on their card; check it after the call: it is part of the **Task & Purpose** evidence (all details correct, read-back done).
- ◆ **The meeting.** Turn the chairs to face each other. Three minutes on the timer, visible to the chair. Card A opens, goes through the agenda, makes sure everyone gives a view, reaches a decision on each item and closes with action points. In a pair, Card A also holds Card C's views and gives them as their own, so there is always something to disagree about.
- ◆ **Prompts.** If a learner freezes, give **one neutral prompt** ("What would you say to the receptionist now?") and note it on the sheet; don't rescue with the answer. Otherwise stay silent and keep your face neutral and friendly.
- ◆ **Scoring.** Score **each learner separately**, one whole number 1–5 per criterion, based on all the evidence from both calls and the meeting (use the task columns on the score sheet for quick notes during the talk). Score what you hear, not what you know the learner can do. Accent itself is not scored; clarity is. Use the observer prompt in the performance-check pack for the moves to listen for (opening + purpose, "I see your point, but...", "Sorry to interrupt, but...", action points with names and days).
- ◆ **Support and stretch** (from the run-sheet). A B1 learner may keep the phrase card from the Module 1 materials on the table: note "phrase card used" on the sheet. Tell a C1 learner before Call 1: "Offer the caller an alternative contact, and deal with one request you can't meet."
- ◆ **Consistency.** Before class, reread the rubric descriptors for 3 and 4 on each criterion: these are the hardest to separate. After the first two pairs, glance back at your sheets. Do not change earlier scores because a later pair was stronger or weaker.

◆ WHAT TO SAY (AND NOT SAY) ABOUT NERVES

SAY: *"Speaking with the teacher listening feels different. That's normal. Talk to your partner, not to me." · "If you don't know a word, say it another way, as you would at work." · "If you lose your place, pause, look at your card, and carry on." · "This is a check-up, not a final exam. Your results are private."*

Avoid: "This really counts," "Don't be nervous," or comparing learners ("The last pair was great"). Many learners have had job interviews, credential assessments or official exams in English that decided important things; a test can bring back those feelings. Thank every pair, and never show a score during or after the simulation. If a learner becomes distressed, stop, let them take a moment or step outside, and offer to do their simulation at the end or before C9.

◆ SUPERVISING THE QUIET TASK

- ◆ The Reading & Ranking task ("Choose the Venue": four replies from venues, a manager's brief with must-haves, a ranking, a short recommendation and two register rewrites) is **not scored**. It recycles the Module 1–2 register work, so it is useful practice, not filler.

- ◆ Learners stop when you call them and continue when they come back. Early finishers do the "Extra" question on the paper, then the **extra quiet task** in the materials (Set F: rank five replies to a customer) or review the "I can..." lists for Lessons 1.1–2.3.
- ◆ Glance at the room between pairs. If the class can hear the pair at your table, ask them to read with headphones on (no sound) or play quiet background music.

◆ MARKING PART A (AFTER CLASS)

- ◆ Use the rubric and the model answers (with checked word counts) in [assessment/assessment-key.html](#). Give **one Writing score per criterion** that reflects Task 1 and Task 2 together, as the score sheet shows. For Task 1, tick the three content points (apology + reason · Thursday + no charge · contact + confirm request).
- ◆ On each learner's score sheet, write **one strength with evidence** (a quotation from their work) and **one or two targets** for Modules 3–4, using the "From Scores to Targets" method in the assessment key: the target is a habit you can see ("Put the ask and the deadline in the first two lines of every email"), not "improve my emails."
- ◆ Fill in the **class record** (in the performance-check pack) and look down each column: a criterion that is low for most of the class is a teaching point for Modules 3–4, not an individual target. Also keep a private list of the **five most common errors** (no names) for C9 and later warmers.
- ◆ Time guide: about 6 minutes per script once you know the models. Re-check the first three scripts at the end for consistency.

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

ACCESS AND SUPPORT

Keep the tasks the same for everyone, so the results are a true measure. A learner who needs adapted conditions (extra writing time, a typed paper, enlarged print, a seat near you for the calls because of a hearing difficulty) keeps the same tasks; note the change on the paper and in the "Adapted?" box on the score sheet. A B1 learner may use the Module 1 phrase card in Part B (noted on the sheet). Never let a partner's level decide a score: if a stronger partner dominates the meeting, you may ask the quieter learner one short question at the end ("Do you agree with the plan?") and score their answer.

EARLY FINISHERS AND STRONGER LEARNERS

Learners who finish Part A early check against a short list on the board: **all three points in Task 1? · a clear ask (confirm Thursday morning)? · greeting and sign-off match? · word count about 120–170? · Task 2: right register for each reader, meaning kept?** They stay seated and do not start other work. In Part B, C1 learners get the stretch instruction from the run-sheet and, where possible, Card A (the chair), but they are scored on the same rubric as everyone else.

◆ WATCH-OUTS: HABITS FROM OTHER ASSESSMENT SYSTEMS

- ◆ **Memorized scripts.** Learners who prepare long memorized paragraphs sound fluent but don't respond to the partner, which lowers **Task & Purpose** and **Organization & Delivery**. Say in the framing: "Listen and respond to your partner; that's part of the score."
- ◆ **Longer and more formal is not better.** In Task 1, some learners write far more than 170 words in a very formal style ("I am writing to inform you that...", "Kindly..."). In Task 2 (c), the whole point is to move *down* the register spectrum for a colleague. Remind them: right for the reader, clear and complete.
- ◆ **Collaboration norms.** In some classrooms, helping a neighbor quietly during a test is tolerated. Explain the rule without judgment before Part A, and seat friends apart.
- ◆ **Asking the teacher for words.** You can explain instructions but not language. Note which instruction caused questions; it's useful when you brief the Final Assessment in C15.

◆ RETURNING THE RESULTS: THE C9 WARMER

The Module 3 guide begins C9 with this warmer; here is the full procedure. It takes about **10 minutes**. Before C9: mark Part A, complete every score sheet (Writing /20, Speaking /20, one strength with evidence, one or two targets) and fold it, or put it in an envelope with the learner's name on the outside. Follow the "Returning Results Kindly" principles in [assessment/assessment-key.html](#): private, evidence before numbers, two scores tell two stories, name what is fixable, respect experience.

- 1 **Frame it (1 min).** "Today you get your midpoint results: two scores, one for writing and one for speaking, and one or two targets. The numbers are useful, but the targets are what we'll work on. Your results are private: you don't have to show anyone."
- 2 **Return privately (2 min).** Hand back each learner's folded score sheet. Learners read it quietly. Circulate: stop briefly with anyone who looks surprised or upset ("Let's talk for two minutes at the break"), and never discuss a score in front of others.
- 3 **Record (3 min).** Learners copy both scores into section 2 of their **Performance Tracker** ([performance-tracker.html](#)), next to their Class 1 diagnostic scores, and copy their targets into section 4. Point out: "Compare yourself only with yourself. Writing and speaking often move at different speeds."
- 4 **Quiet pair task (4 min).** While you circulate, pairs do: "Rewrite one sentence from your email that you'd now write differently." Each learner shows their partner the **before** and **after** sentence (never the score) and says why. Take two or three good examples for the board, without names.

If some pairs did not finish Part B in C8, run them now (about 7 minutes each) while the rest of the class does steps 3–4, and return their results in C10. Offer a two-minute conversation at the break to anyone who wants one. Keep the score sheets (or copies) with your records: you will need them to compare with the Final Assessment. For the whole class, use the class record: if one criterion is low for most learners, build it into Module 3 warmers (for example, low **Register & Tone**: Register Dominoes and tone-swap drills; low **Organization & Delivery** in speaking: signposting, which Lesson 3.1 teaches directly).

◆ USING THE RESULTS DIAGNOSTICALLY

- ◆ **The criteria tell you what to teach.** Low **Task & Purpose**: more work on "purpose and ask in the first two lines" and "every call ends with a read-back; every meeting ends with who / what / when." Low **Register & Tone**: tone-swap drills and register rewrites in warmers. Low **Language Range & Accuracy**: short clinics on the five class errors. Low **Organization & Delivery**: signposting and chair language, which presentations in Module 3 use directly.
- ◆ **Writing vs speaking.** Tell each learner honestly which is stronger and where the fastest gain is, and point them to the matching online lessons (the example targets table in the assessment key lists one for each criterion).
- ◆ **Progress.** Compare with the Class 1 diagnostic in the tracker. A rise of one or two points on one criterion is real progress and worth naming, privately.
- ◆ **Privacy.** Never display scores, rank learners, or share one learner's result with another.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online Lesson 3.1 (Presentations — Structure & Delivery): https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_07.html, and a journal entry: "Which part of today felt easiest, and which felt hardest? Why?" Optional review: the key takeaways of online lessons 2.1 · 2.2 · 2.3. Bring the workbook and the Performance Tracker to C9.

◆ CHECK

The rubric descriptors, the Part A model answers with word counts, the notes on the speaking cards ("what to listen for"), the class scoring sheet for Class 8 and the "From Scores to Targets" method are in [assessment/assessment-key.html](#). The per-learner score sheets, the run-sheet, the speaking cards and the Reading & Ranking task are in [assessment/performance-check.html](#). The suggested ranking for the extra quiet task is under the task in the materials (Set F, teacher note).

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C7 AND C9: MODULE 2 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "acknowledge first, then act": **signal before you interrupt · acknowledge, then differ · close with who / what / when** (meetings) → **open questions · answer + free info + question back · exit warmly and follow up within 48 hours** (networking) → **firm on substance, soft on delivery · SBI · alternative, trade-off or buy time · acknowledge the feeling, then solve** (diplomacy). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists at the end of C7; anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. After C9, each learner's **midpoint goal** becomes their personal focus for weeks 5–8: check in briefly each week ("How's your goal going?").

Watch for in Module 3: presentations, negotiations and pitching reuse all of this. The chair's signposting in C5 becomes presentation signposting; the question-handling in presentations uses "acknowledge, then answer"; negotiation depends on rapport (C6) and on firm-but-soft pushing back and trade-offs (C7: "Happy to, if..."). Learners who struggled with the carousel will meet the same moves again with more support.

The Final Assessment (C15–C16) uses the same rubric; the Module 4 guide plans those classes. Keep each learner's midpoint score sheet (or a copy) so you can show them their progress on each criterion; learners track it themselves in the Performance Tracker.

Module 3 — Presenting, Negotiating & Persuading

Three speaking workshops, and the first class after the Midpoint Performance Check. C9 opens by handing back the score sheets and individual targets, then teaches presentations: the three-part shape, the five jobs of an opening, signposting, describing a chart so it means something, and staying calm in the Q&A. C10 turns to negotiation: positions vs interests, the five stages, rejecting without offense and the grammatical heart of bargaining, the conditional trade ("If you..., we'll..."), practiced in a points-based Deal Room simulation with private priorities. C11 brings it together in persuasion: the five-stage pitch, features into benefits, honest credibility language, and handling objections with LAARC, practiced in Pitch & Push-back, where every buyer hides a real concern behind the objection they say out loud.

3 lessons

Lessons 3.1–3.3

Classes C9–C11

Weeks 5–6

90 min per class

Level B1+ (B1–C1 mixed)

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class is a communication-skills workshop with the same shape: **warmer** (review) → **lead-in** linked to learners' working lives → **model** (a read-aloud script and a workbook text) → **notice and clarify** the language through **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** and concept-checking questions (CCQs) → a short **drill** (choral → individual; stress, pausing, polite intonation) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (a simulation with A/B cards) → **feedback** on register, tone and clarity with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-3-presenting-negotiating.html](#) (C9 = slides 2–8, C10 = slides 9–13, C11 = slides 14–18). Print [materials/module-3/classroom-materials.html](#) before C9. It holds the phrase flashcards, the **role profiles**, the **Presentation Carousel** brief and question cards, the **Deal Room** A/B negotiation cards with points tables, the **Pitch & Push-back** A/B cards, the observer checklists, the **Signpost Bingo** game and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**: 3.1 = [lesson_07.html](#), 3.2 = [lesson_08.html](#), 3.3 = [lesson_09.html](#). Each has  Listen buttons for the model sentences.

- ◆ **Protect the simulation.** Every class ends in a timed speaking simulation (the Presentation Carousel in C9, the Deal Room in C10, Pitch & Push-back in C11). Learners can read phrase lists at home; what they cannot do alone is use them live, under mild pressure, with a real listener who pushes back. If you're running late, cut controlled practice (set it for homework), never the simulation or the feedback that follows it.
- ◆ **Feedback on the four criteria, not on "good English."** This module uses the course's one analytic rubric (the full descriptors are in [assessment/assessment-key.html](#)): **Task & Purpose** (did the talk, deal or pitch achieve its goal: all points covered, a clear action), **Register & Tone** (appropriate formality, politeness, diplomacy), **Language Range & Accuracy** (phrases, grammar, vocabulary), **Organization & Delivery** (structure, signposting, fluency, pronunciation, interaction). During every simulation, take notes in these four columns. In feedback, board two items per column without names, and always one phrase to praise.
- ◆ **Observers use the same criteria.** In each simulation one learner observes with a checklist card (Set G) built on the four criteria. This does two jobs: it trains learners to hear what the rubric rewards, and it gives you a second pair of ears. Observers give **one strength and one "try next time,"** never a score.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use American spelling and dollars, like the kit (*organized, emphasizing, summarize, leveling off, program, licenses, offense, labeled, elevator pitch*; \$2m, \$4 a day). Never mark a correct British form wrong: in international business both are normal. What matters is being consistent within one document.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Inform → trade → persuade. In C9 learners **inform**: they give a clear, structured talk that an audience can follow without effort, because every turn is signposted. In C10 they **trade**: they discover what the other side really needs and swap concessions conditionally, so that both sides leave with enough to say yes. In C11 they **persuade**: they turn features into benefits, back them with honest evidence, ask for one clear action and stay calm under objections. The same four habits run through all three: **structure out loud** (signposts, stages, pitch steps), **focus on the listener** ("what's in it for them"), **stay polite under pressure** (soften, acknowledge, never a flat "no") and **finish with a clear action** (a call to action, a written summary, a next step). Each class produces something a listener responds to: a mini-presentation with Q&A, a recorded deal, a pitch that survives two objections.

CONFIDENCE, FACE AND SPEAKING IN FRONT OF OTHERS

This is the most exposed module of the course. Many of your learners are highly competent professionals who presented, negotiated and sold with ease in their first language, and now feel judged on their English instead of their expertise. Some are rebuilding a career after a move and may be working below their qualifications. Say these things explicitly in C9 and whenever someone stands up to speak:

- ◆ **"Presenters are made, not born."** (It's the online lesson's message too.) Nervous first-timers and polished speakers are the same person a few presentations apart.
- ◆ **Structure beats accent.** An audience forgives an accent and a grammar slip; it doesn't forgive getting lost. Signposting is the fastest route to sounding in control, and learners can plan it in advance.
- ◆ **Small groups first.** All three simulations run in groups of 2–3, not in front of the whole class. Nobody presents to the full room in this module unless they volunteer. The whole-class capstone comes in C16, after weeks of rehearsal.
- ◆ **Their expertise is an asset.** Invite learners with professional experience in sales, procurement, teaching or management to share one tip in English. Never ask what their job "used to be" or why they left it; let them volunteer it.
- ◆ **Nothing personal is required.** Every presentation, negotiation and pitch can use a **role profile** (Set B): a fictional person, job and company with ready-made figures. Learners may present their real work only if they want to, and should never share confidential information, salaries or a real employer's name. Say so in C9.

KEEP THE CONFLICTS ORDINARY

All negotiation and pitch scenarios in this kit are fictional and deliberately low-stakes: delivery prices, launch dates, a training venue, meeting-room booking, a lunch-box order. Don't replace them with salary negotiations, job cuts, disputes about discrimination or anything political: those are real stressors for some learners and poor practice material. If learners want to rehearse a real situation (for example, asking for more time on a project), they may do so in the homework task, privately, on their own terms.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ **Midpoint Performance Check results (C9 warmer).** Mark the C8 writing task and speaking simulations before C9 on the score sheets in [assessment/performance-check.html](#), using the four-criterion rubric and "From Scores to Targets" in [assessment/assessment-key.html](#): Writing /20, Speaking /20, one strength with evidence, and one or two targets per learner. Fold each learner's sheets with their name on the outside. Remind learners in C8 to bring their **Performance Tracker** ([performance-tracker.html](#)) and Module 2 workbook to C9.
- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (Set A): signposting function ↔ phrase pairs, flat ↔ diplomatic pairs, feature ↔ benefit

pairs. One set per group of 3–4 for the matching activities, plus one set for the board.

- ◆ Print the **role profiles** (Set B), 1–2 sets, and keep them on a side table for all three classes.
- ◆ For C9: **Presentation Carousel** brief cards and Q&A question cards (Set C), one question set per group of three, plus observer checklists (Set G). Bring a visible timer.
- ◆ For C10: the **Deal Room** A/B cards (Set D). Each scenario is a pair: **A** and **B** cards must go to different people and must not be shown. Print enough for one pair per two learners (three scenarios; repeat scenarios as needed) and the teacher's **deal record** (in Set D). Read the teacher's note on the "best deals" before class.
- ◆ For C11: the **Pitch & Push-back** cards (Set E), one A/B pair per two learners, plus observer checklists.
- ◆ **Signpost Bingo** (Set F) is the C10 warmer and an early-finisher game.
- ◆ Listening scripts (Set H) are yours to read aloud: 3.1-A an opening, 3.1-B a chart (with two deliberate mistakes), 3.2-A a negotiation extract, 3.3-A a pitch with an objection.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
—	C9 warmer	Midpoint Performance Check results: private score sheets (Writing /20, Speaking /20, a strength, 1–2 targets) copied into the Performance Tracker; one target linked to a Module 3 skill for the Final Assessment (C15–C16)	name their target and one concrete action for it, linked to a Module 3 skill
3.1	C9 • wk 5	Presentations: the three-part shape (tell them what you'll tell them → tell them → tell them what you told them); the five jobs of an opening + a hook; signposting by function (moving on, sequencing, referring back and forward, examples, emphasis, summarizing); describing visuals (introduce → direct attention → describe the trend → interpret); delivery; Q&A phrases (clarify, can't answer, park)	open a short presentation with all five jobs, signpost every transition, describe a chart and say what it means, and handle a question they can't answer honestly and briefly
3.2	C10 • wk 5	Negotiations: positions vs interests; the five stages (prepare → open → explore → propose and bargain → close); probing questions; proposing, accepting, rejecting without offense, counter-proposing; conditional bargaining (first conditional = real offer, second = testing the water; <i>provided that, as long as</i>); concessions that are small, conditional and labeled; deadlock; BATNA; closing and confirming in writing	find the interest behind a position, trade concessions with "If you..., we'll...", say no without closing the door, and close a deal with a spoken summary and a confirmation email

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
3.3	C11 · wk 6	Pitching and persuasion: trust + clear value + a clear ask; the five-stage pitch (hook/problem → solution → benefit → evidence → call to action); features vs benefits and the bridge "...which means that..."; value and credibility language; honest vs over-hyped claims; objections and LAARC (Listen, Acknowledge, Ask, Respond, Confirm); the elevator pitch	deliver a 60–90 second pitch that leads with the listener's problem and ends with one clear ask, and handle two objections by acknowledging and clarifying before responding

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ read their Midpoint Performance Check results criterion by criterion and link their **target** for the Final Assessment to a Module 3 skill
- ◆ open a presentation with the **five jobs** (greet · introduce yourself and the topic · state the purpose and the benefit · outline the structure · housekeeping on questions) and a one-sentence hook
- ◆ choose the right **signpost** for each move (moving on, sequencing, referring back or forward, giving an example, emphasizing, summarizing) and say it with clear stress and a pause
- ◆ describe a simple chart in four steps: **introduce** → **direct attention** → **describe the trend** → **say what it means**
- ◆ handle a question they can't answer: clarify, answer briefly or promise a follow-up, and park an off-topic question politely

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Each learner's folded speaking and writing score sheets ([assessment/performance-check.html](#) , marked with strengths and 1–2 targets) · learners' Performance Trackers ([performance-tracker.html](#)) · Module 2 workbooks ("After the check (C9)") · "From Scores to Targets" and "Returning Results Kindly" in [assessment/assessment-key.html](#)
- ◆ Workbook 3.1 (My Midpoint target in Module 3, Key phrases, Language box, Model opening, Exercises 1–5, Presentation planner, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 2–8 · Signposting flashcards (Set A1) · **Role profiles** (Set B) · **Presentation Carousel** brief cards + Q&A question cards (Set C) · observer checklists (Set G) · timer · Scripts 3.1-A (an opening) and 3.1-B (the chart, with two mistakes)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the shape. OPEN (tell them what you'll tell them) → BODY: point 1 → signpost → point 2 → signpost → point 3 → CLOSE (tell them what you told them: summary · call to action · thanks · questions). 2–3 points, not 7.

Center: the five jobs of an opening. ① Good morning, thank you for coming. ② I'm... from... ③ Today I'm going to talk about... By the end, you'll... ④ I've divided my talk into three parts: first... then... finally... ⑤ Please feel free to ask questions as we go. / I'll take questions at the end. + a **hook** (a question, a striking fact, a short story).

Right: signposts + visuals. Moving on: *This brings me to my NEXT point.* · Example: *For instance...* · Emphasis: *The KEY point here is...* · Recap: *So, to sum up...* · Visual: introduce (*This graph shows...*) →

direct (*If you look at...*) → describe (*rose sharply, peaked at*) → interpret (*What this tells us is...*). Q&A: *I don't have that figure to hand, but I'll follow up.*

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Performance Check back	12	T-S → S	Slide 2. See Returning the Midpoint Performance Check below. Frame it first (a map, not a verdict). Learners read their folded score sheets privately, copy Writing /20, Speaking /20 and their targets into the Performance Tracker (sections 2 and 4), do the quiet "before → after sentence" pair task, and link their target to a Module 3 skill in Workbook 3.1. Individual talks happen later, privately.
Lead-in: why do audiences switch off?	3	T-S → S-S	Slide 3. "Think of a presentation or meeting update where you stopped listening. Why?" Pairs, 1 minute; take four answers (too long, reading slides, no clear point, monotone). Elicit: most of these are about structure , not English. "The good news: structure is something you can plan."
Model: an opening	8	S → T-S	Slide 4, then slide 5. Learners look at the five jobs on slide 5 (hide the model half). Read Script 3.1-A (Priya's opening) once: learners tick each job as they hear it and note the hook. Check. Then learners read the workbook Model opening (Tomás) and do Ex 1 (label the lines a-f with the five jobs + hook) alone, 2 minutes. Check with the slide. CCQs on purpose vs topic.
Language: signposting	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 6 and the Language box. Six functions, three or four phrases each. Groups of three get the Signposting flashcards (Set A1) face down: match each function card to its phrase cards (3 min). Check with the slide. Then MFP: meaning (CCQs below), form (<i>This brings me to</i> ; <i>Let's move on to</i> + noun; <i>As I mentioned earlier</i> , not <i>As I mentioned before earlier</i>), pronunciation (stress and the pause after the signpost).
Drill	5	T-S → S	See Drill script: choral, then individual, stress on the key word and a pause after each signpost. Finish with the "function → phrase" rapid round.
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (put Amira's opening in order) and Ex 3 (choose the signpost) alone; check in pairs by reading the lines aloud with the signpost stressed. Support learners do Ex 3 items 1-4 only. Early finishers: Signpost Bingo grids (Set F) as a preview.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Describing visuals	8	T-S → S-S	Slide 7. The four steps. Read Script 3.1-B : learners look at the Northwind chart in Workbook Ex 4 and raise a hand at the two figure mistakes . Then Ex 4 (complete the description) alone, 3 minutes, and Ex 5 item 1 in pairs (turn a slide-reading line into speech). Ex 5 items 2–3 are homework. CCQs on the trend words.
Q&A phrases	4	T-S	Slide 8 (top). Four moves: invite · clarify / buy time · can't answer (follow up) · park. Quick-fire: you read a question card from Set C; learners answer chorally with the right frame ("That's a great question. Just to make sure I understand..."). Stress: <i>I'll FOLLOW up</i> .
Freer practice: Presentation Carousel	22	S → S-S	Slide 8. See Running the Presentation Carousel . Groups of three. Prep, 5 min : each learner chooses a brief card (Set C) or their role profile (Set B) or a real, non-confidential work topic, and fills the Presentation planner in the workbook: opening, two points, one visual sentence, close. ICQs. Three rounds × 5 min : presenter gives a 2-minute mini-presentation (opening + two signposted points + close); the questioner asks one question from the Q&A card; the observer fills the checklist and gives one strength and one "try next time." Rotate roles. You circulate with four-column notes.
Feedback	5	T-S	Board two anonymous items per criterion, e.g. Task & Purpose : no purpose / benefit stated; Register & Tone : "I will present you my topic"; Language : "the sales are rised," "discuss about"; Organization & Delivery : two points with no signpost between them, reading from the card. Learners fix them. Praise one great hook and one well-stressed signpost.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 3.1 and a 🗣️ button. Set the homework (below): the full 3–4 minute presentation, recorded on a phone. Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		12 + 3 + 8 + 10 + 5 + 8 + 8 + 4 + 22 + 5 + 5

◆ RETURNING THE MIDPOINT PERFORMANCE CHECK – HOW TO RUN IT (12 MIN)

This follows the procedure in the Module 2 guide ("Returning the results: the C9 warmer"), with two extra minutes to link each learner's target to Module 3. You need each learner's completed **speaking and writing score sheets** from [assessment/performance-check.html](#) (Writing /20, Speaking /20, one strength with evidence, one or two targets, set with "From Scores to Targets" in [assessment/assessment-](#)

key.html), folded, with the learner's name on the outside. Learners need their **Performance Tracker** (performance-tracker.html). Follow the "Returning Results Kindly" principles in the assessment key.

◆ **Frame it (1 min):**

***SAY:** "Today you get your midpoint results: two scores, one for writing and one for speaking, and one or two targets. These results are a map, not a verdict. In C8 you wrote under time pressure and spoke with someone listening and taking notes. That's hard in any language. The numbers don't measure your professional ability, and nobody else will see them. The targets are what we'll work on."*

- ◆ **Return privately (2 min):** hand back each learner's folded score sheets. Learners read quietly. Circulate; stop briefly with anyone who looks surprised or upset ("Let's talk for two minutes at the break"), and never discuss a score in front of others.
- ◆ **Record (3 min):** learners copy both scores into **section 2** of their Performance Tracker, next to their Class 1 diagnostic scores, and their targets into **section 4**. "Compare yourself only with yourself. Writing and speaking often move at different speeds." Remind them what a 3 means on a criterion: the job is done, with some problems.
- ◆ **Quiet pair task (3 min):** pairs do "Rewrite one sentence from your C8 email that you'd now write differently" (the "After the check (C9)" box in the Module 2 workbook). Each learner shows the before and after sentence, never the score. Board two or three good examples without names.
- ◆ **Link the target to Module 3 (2 min):** learners complete "My Midpoint target in Module 3" in Workbook 3.1: they choose the Module 3 skill that matches their target from the target menu, and one action they can check. ✗ "Better English." ✓ "Signpost every move in my C16 presentation and practice it aloud twice." ✓ "Soften every refusal: a reason + an alternative." Point out that Module 3 works directly on Organization & Delivery (signposting, negotiation stages, pitch structure) and Register & Tone (saying no diplomatically).
- ◆ **Close (1 min):** "In C14 we rehearse the capstone, and I'll ask you: what did you do about your target?" Keep the score sheets (or copies) with your records for the Final Assessment comparison. If some pairs did not finish Part B in C8, the Module 2 guide explains how to run them now and return their results in C10.
- ◆ **Individual talks:** anyone whose result upset them, or whose score is far below their professional level, gets a few minutes with you at the break or during the Carousel prep, never in front of others. Be specific and kind: "Your Task & Purpose was a 5: your email did everything it needed to do. Your Language score is a 3 because of articles and past tense, and those are very fixable." Learners who scored low in speaking because of nerves: tell them so, and point to the small-group format of this module. Use the class record privately: if one criterion is low for most learners, lean on the matching Module 3 warmers and drills.

Meaning: topic vs purpose vs benefit. The topic is what the talk is about; the purpose is what the speaker wants to achieve; the benefit is what the audience gets.

SAY: "Today I'm going to talk about late invoices." Topic or purpose? (Topic.) "The purpose of my talk is to get your approval for a new reminder system." (Purpose.) "By the end, you'll know how to get paid two weeks faster." Who is that sentence for: the speaker or the audience? (The audience: it's the benefit.) · "Please feel free to ask questions as we go." When can I ask a question: now or at the end? (Now, during the talk.) "I'll take questions at the end." Can I interrupt? (Better not; wait until the end.)

Meaning: signposts by function. A signpost tells the audience where the speaker is going, like a road sign.

SAY: "This brings me to my next point." Is the speaker starting, moving forward or finishing? (Moving forward to a new point.) · "As I mentioned earlier..." Forward or back? (Back, to something already said.) "We'll come to that shortly." Now or later? (Later, soon.) · "In conclusion..." Can I say this in the middle of the talk? (No: only at the end.) · "The key point here is..." Is this an example or the most important idea? (The most important idea.) · "For instance..." Same meaning as? (For example.)

Meaning: describing and interpreting a visual.

SAY: "On-time deliveries rose sharply in Q3." Big change or small change? (Big.) Fast or slow? (Fast.) "They leveled off in Q4." Did they go up, down or stay about the same? (About the same.) · "They peaked at 93%." Was 93% the highest or the lowest point? (Highest.) · "This graph shows our deliveries." Is that describing or interpreting? (Describing: introducing.) "What this tells us is that the new routes are working." (Interpreting: the meaning for the audience.) Which one does the audience care about most? (The meaning.)

Meaning: Q&A.

SAY: "I don't have that figure to hand, but I'll follow up by tomorrow." Does the speaker know the answer now? (No.) Are they going to guess? (No.) What will they do? (Find it and send it later.) · "Can we take that offline?" Discuss it now, in front of everyone, or later, just the two of us? (Later, privately.) · Is it weak to say "I don't know"? (No, it's honest and professional, as long as you offer to follow up.)

Form.

Opening	Today I'm going to talk about + noun / - ing · The purpose of my talk is to + verb · By the end, you'll + verb	Today I'm going to talk about reducing waiting times. ✗ talk about to reduce
Outline	I've divided my talk into three parts: first... then / second... and finally...	✗ I divided (the structure is still true now: present perfect)
Moving on	Let's move on to + noun · This brings me to + noun · Now I'd like to turn to + noun	Let's move on to the cost . ✗ Let's move on to talk the cost

Trends	rose / fell / peaked / leveled off (past simple for finished periods) · rise – rose – risen	Sales rose sharply. ✗ ris ed · ✗ w ere risen
Interpreting	What this tells us is (that) + clause · The takeaway here is + clause / noun	What this tells us is that the new routes work.
Q&A	I don't have that figure to hand · I'll follow up by + time · Let me check and get back to you	I'll follow up by Friday. (✗ until Friday)

Pronunciation. A signpost is a **chunk** with one main stress and a **pause** after it: *This brings me to my **NEXT** point.* (pause) *The cost.* · *The **KEY** point here is...* (pause) · *So, to sum **UP**...* (pause). The pause is the audible paragraph break; nervous speakers skip it. Numbers: *thir**TEEN*** vs *THIR**Ty***, *fif**TEEN*** vs *FIF**Ty***: stress the ending on -teen and repeat important figures ("ninety-three, nine-three, percent"). Nouns vs verbs: *an **IN**crease* / *to **in**CREASE*. Q&A: a falling tone on *That's a great **QUEST**ion* sounds calm; a rising tone sounds unsure.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- Choral, then individual, with the pause:** T: "Good morning, everyone, and thank you all for **COM**ing." → Class repeats. "I've divided my talk into **THREE** parts." · "Let's **START** with the problem." · "This brings me to my **NEXT** point." · "The **KEY** point here is..." · "So, to sum **UP**..." Tap the table on each pause.
- Function → phrase (rapid round):** T: "Moving on!" → S1: "Let's move on to the cost." T: "Example!" → S2: "For instance, ..." T: "Back!" → S3: "As I mentioned earlier, ..." T: "Forward!" → S4: "We'll come to that shortly." T: "Emphasis!" → S5: "What I want to stress is..." T: "Recap!" → S6: "Let me recap the main points."
- Trend + meaning chain:** T: "Sales, Q1 to Q2, 100 to 150." → S1: "Sales rose sharply in Q2." → S2: "What this tells us is that the campaign worked." T: "Costs, flat all year." → S1: "Costs stayed flat." → S2: "The takeaway here is that our savings held."
- Can't-answer frame:** T (as audience): "What was the figure for 2023?" → S: "I don't have that figure to hand, but I'll follow up by tomorrow." T: "What about the IT budget?" → S: "That's a bit outside today's scope. Can we take that offline?"

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE PRESENTATION CAROUSEL

SAY: *How many people in your group? (Three.) How long do you present? (Two minutes.) What must your opening include? (The five jobs, or at least greeting, topic and purpose, outline and questions.) How many signposts, at least? (One between each point, and one to close.) Do you read from your planner? (No: look at the audience; keywords only.) What does the questioner do? (Asks one question from the card.) What does the observer do? (Ticks the checklist, then says one strength and one "try next time.") Does the observer give a score? (No.) Can you use a role profile instead of your real job? (Yes.)*

◆ RUNNING THE PRESENTATION CAROUSEL (ROLE-PLAY MANAGEMENT)

- ◆ **Grouping:** threes, mixed levels, and never three learners from the same workplace or first language if you can avoid it. With a group of four, add a second questioner; with a pair, the questioner also observes.
- ◆ **Timing:** 5 min prep (planner) · then three rounds of 5 minutes: 2 min presenting · 1 min Q&A · 1 min observer feedback · 1 min to rotate. Call the time loudly. A presenter who runs over is stopped at 2:15 with "Close now, please": closing on time is part of the skill.
- ◆ **Roles:** **Presenter** (stands if they're comfortable; sitting is fine) · **Questioner** (draws a card from the Q&A pack, Set C: 8 questions, including one the presenter can't answer and one that is off-topic) · **Observer** (checklist card, Set G).
- ◆ **Observer checklist (the four criteria):** **Task & Purpose:** was the purpose clear? was there a clear call to action or conclusion? · **Register & Tone:** polite, confident, audience-focused ("you" language)? · **Language Range & Accuracy:** at least three different signposts? trend words used correctly? · **Organization & Delivery:** opening with the five jobs? a signpost at every turn? eye contact, pauses, not reading? a calm, short answer to the question?
- ◆ **What you do:** stand near each group for one full round. Note in four columns. Don't interrupt a presenter, even for a serious error. If a group finishes early, they repeat with a new question card or stretch constraint (below).
- ◆ **Face-saving:** anyone who is very anxious can present sitting, to one person, using the planner as notes, or can be the observer twice and present last. Everyone presents at least once, in whatever format they can manage today.

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

SUPPORT (B1)

Give the **fill-in opening frame** in the Presentation planner: "Good ___, everyone. I'm ___ from ___. Today I'm going to talk about ___. By the end, you'll ___. I've divided my talk into two parts: first, ___; then, ___. Please ___." Allow two points instead of three and a 90-second talk. Let them use a role profile, which has the figures ready. Ex 3 items 1–4 only. In the Carousel, they present third, after hearing two models.

STRETCH (C1)

Constraints and register-shifting. (1) Present the same content twice: once to senior managers (formal, 90 seconds, numbers first), once to your own team (informal, 90 seconds, benefits first). (2) Include one referring-back and one referring-forward signpost and a rhetorical question. (3) As questioner, ask a hostile or off-topic question; as presenter, park it politely. (4) Take the **chair's** role: introduce the next speaker and manage the Q&A time ("We have time for one more question").

◆ L1 & CROSS-CULTURAL WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"I will present you...":** a translation of *présenter* / *presenter* / *präsentieren* + indirect object. Teach *I'd like to present to you...*, *I'll show you...*, or simply *Today I'm going to talk about...* Also ✗ *explain me* → ✓

explain to me, and ✗ *discuss about* → ✓ *discuss* + noun.

- ◆ **"In conclusion" too early:** learners from school traditions where every paragraph has a formal conclusion use *in conclusion* as "in summary of this point." In English it means "the talk is ending." Use *So, to sum up this part...* mid-talk.
- ◆ **Irregular past and articles in trends:** ✗ *rised, falled, the sales was growing up*; ✗ *There was sharp rise*. Drill *rose / fell / peaked* and the chunk *a sharp rise in*. *Sales* is plural: *sales were*.
- ◆ **Numbers:** many European and Latin American learners write *2,5 million* (decimal comma) and *1.000* (thousand point); in English it's *2.5 million, 1,000*. Some languages count in *milliards*, so *billion* can be misheard; and *-teen / -ty* confusion causes real errors in meetings. Check figures by asking "fifteen, one-five?"
- ◆ **Eye contact and self-promotion:** in some workplace cultures, steady eye contact with a senior person feels disrespectful, and presenting your own team's success can feel like boasting. Don't frame this as right or wrong. Explain the English-speaking workplace expectation (look around the room, state results plainly: "we cut waiting times by half") and let learners find a version that feels honest to them.
- ◆ **Questions during the talk:** some learners come from settings where interrupting a speaker, or questioning a senior colleague, is rude; others from settings where it's expected. That's exactly why the housekeeping line ("feel free to ask as we go" / "I'll take questions at the end") exists: it makes the rule explicit for everyone.
- ◆ **Flat intonation:** speakers of syllable-timed languages (Spanish, French, Tagalog, Turkish and others) may give every word the same weight. In presentations this sounds bored rather than rude. The signpost drill (one stress, one pause) is the fix.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_07.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and say them back; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and "Your Task": plan and **record** a 3–4 minute presentation on a phone (real topic or role profile) and complete the self-review checklist.

Workbook 3.1: Exercise 5 items 2–3, "My useful phrases" and the journal. Check that your targets are in section 4 of your Performance Tracker.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 A "That's the problem. This brings me to my solution..." (moves forward; *in conclusion* ends the talk, *as I mentioned earlier* refers back) · Q2 C "I don't have that figure to hand, but I'll follow up with you by tomorrow."
· Q3 (new) B introduce → describe → interpret ("As you can see, costs fell sharply in Q2. What this tells us is..."). Full answers for Ex 1–5 and a model 2-minute talk are in the answer key.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain the difference between a **position** (what someone says they want) and an **interest** (why they want it), and ask a question that uncovers the interest
- ◆ name the five stages of a negotiation and use phrases to open warmly, propose, accept, **reject without offense** (reason + route forward) and counter-propose
- ◆ bargain with **conditionals**: the first conditional for a real offer (*If you commit to two years, we'll...*), the second for testing the water (*If you were to double the order, would you...?*), and *provided that / as long as*
- ◆ make concessions that are small, conditional and **labeled**, and ask for something back every time
- ◆ close a deal by summarizing it aloud and confirming it in a short email

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 3.2 (Key words, Key phrases, Language box, Model dialogue, Exercises 1–5, Deal Room planner, confirmation email frame, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 9–13 · **Signpost Bingo** (Set F) for the warmer · Negotiation flashcards (Set A2) · **Deal Room** A/B cards with points tables + teacher's deal record (Set D) · observer checklists (Set G) · timer · Script 3.2-A (a negotiation extract)

BOARD PLAN

Left: position vs interest. POSITION = what they say ("We need 15% off.") · INTEREST = why ("My budget resets in January.") → ask: *What's driving that? · What's most important to you here? · If we could solve X, would that change things?* Stages: ① prepare (ideal · limit · BATNA) ② open ③ explore ④ propose & bargain ⑤ close.

Center: never give something for nothing. If you commit to two years, we'll waive the fee. (real offer) · If you were to double the order, **would** you...? (testing) · We'll include training **provided that / as long as** you order today. Concessions: small · slow · conditional · **labeled** ("That's a big step for us") · reciprocal · keep one in reserve.

Right: no → not yet. ✗ "No. Impossible." ✓ *I'm afraid that doesn't quite work for us, because... What we could offer instead is...* · Deadlock: *Let me take that back to my team. · If price is fixed, could we look at delivery or terms?* Close: *So, to confirm what we've agreed... I'll send the details by email this afternoon.*

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Signpost Bingo	6	T-S → S	Review C9 with Signpost Bingo (Set F): read the caller list (a function or situation); learners cross the phrase that fits; first full line calls "Bingo!" and must say each phrase with the right stress. Then ask two volunteers: "Did you record your presentation? One thing you'd change?"
Lead-in: two people, one room	5	T-S → S-S	Slide 9. Two colleagues both want the only big meeting room on Thursday at 10:00. One needs a screen for a client video call; the other needs space for eight people to work on a whiteboard. Pairs, 2 minutes: "Is there a solution where both get what they need?" (The client call moves to a small room with a screen; or the workshop moves to the afternoon.) Elicit: what they said (the room) is the position; why (a screen, space) is the interest. Board both words.
Model: listen for the trade	9	S → T-S	Read Script 3.2-A (a café owner and a coffee-machine supplier). First listen: "Did they reach a deal? What was the real problem: price or cash flow?" (Cash flow: a monthly payment plan solved it.) Then learners read the workbook Model dialogue (Kestrel Design and Maple & Stone) and, in pairs, find the interest question, the conditional trade, the labeled concession and the closing summary, and mark where each of the five stages begins. Check with slide 9.
Language: propose, reject, counter	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 10 and the Key phrases. Stage by stage: open · probe · propose · accept · reject · counter · close. Groups sort the Negotiation flashcards (Set A2): each flat or giveaway card is matched to its diplomatic version (3 min). Then focus on rejecting: reason + route forward . CCQs below. Signaling: "that would be difficult" usually means "not impossible."
Language: conditional bargaining	8	T-S	Slide 11 and the Language box. First vs second conditional: form, meaning (real offer vs testing), and <i>provided that / as long as</i> . The golden rule: never give something for nothing. CCQs. Then slide 12: concessions (small, slow, conditional, labeled, reciprocal, reserved) and deadlock phrases.
Drill	6	T-S → S	See Drill script: giveaway → trade transformation, choral then individual; polite fall-rise on <i>I'm afraid...</i> ; contractions <i>we'll / we'd</i> .

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice	12	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1 (label the move), Ex 2 (giveaways → trades) and Ex 3 (first or second conditional) alone, then compare in pairs by saying the answers to each other. Ex 4 (soften the no) and Ex 5 (position → interest question) as pair work if time; otherwise homework. Support learners: Ex 1 and Ex 2 items 1–2. Stretch learners: Ex 3, then write their own second-conditional "feeler" for each Deal Room issue.
Freer practice: the Deal Room	22	S → S-S	Slide 13. See Running the Deal Room . Pairs (or pairs + an observer). Each learner gets an A or B card (Set D) with private priorities and a points table. ICQs. Prep, 5 min: fill the Deal Room planner (ideal · limit · BATNA · one interest question · two conditional trades · one concession in reserve). Negotiate, 13 min: through all five stages. At 11 minutes, call "Two minutes: start closing." Close, 2 min: summarize aloud, fill the deal record on the card, both sign. Score, 2 min: each side adds up their points privately.
Feedback	7	T-S	Board the deals from each pair (the terms, not the names) and ask for the combined points. Reveal the teacher's note: the highest combined scores came from trading the issues each side cares about /less. "Who found out what the other side really needed? What question did you ask?" Then two anonymous items per criterion, e.g. Task & Purpose: no deal summarized, terms left vague; Register & Tone: "No. That's impossible." / "I want you give me discount"; Language: "If you will sign today..."; Organization & Delivery: jumped to numbers with no opening. Praise one labeled concession.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 3.2 and a  button. The key homework: write the confirmation email for today's deal (frame in the workbook, 80–120 words) and bring it to C11. Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		6 + 5 + 9 + 10 + 8 + 6 + 12 + 22 + 7 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: key terms.

SAY: "We need the price down by 15%." Position or interest? (Position: what they say they want.) "My budget resets in January." (Interest: why.) · A **concession**: do you get something or give something? (Give something up, to move the deal forward.) · Your **BATNA** is your plan if...? (...there is no deal: your best

alternative, for example another supplier.) If a deal is worse than your BATNA, do you accept it? (No.) · **Deadlock:** are the two sides moving or stuck? (Stuck.)

Meaning: first vs second conditional in bargaining.

SAY: "If you sign today, we'll take 5% off." Is this a real offer? (Yes.) Could the buyer say "Deal!" now? (Yes.) · "If you signed today, would you expect a discount?" Is the seller offering a discount? (Not yet: they're testing, finding out.) Which is softer? (The second.) When do you use it, early or late in the negotiation? (Early, to explore.) · "We'll include training provided that you order all five licenses." Do they get training if they order three? (No: provided that = only if.) Same meaning as? (As long as / only if.)

Meaning: rejecting and labeling.

SAY: "I'm afraid that doesn't quite work for us, because our margin is tight. What we could offer instead is..." Is this a yes or a no? (A no.) Is the conversation over? (No: there's an alternative.) · "That would be difficult." Does it usually mean impossible? (No: often "not impossible, if..."). What could you ask? ("What would make it easier?") · "That's a big concession for us." Why say this out loud? (So they value it, and so you can ask for something back.)

Form.

First conditional (real offer)	If + present simple , ... will / can + verb	If you pay within 14 days, we'll waive the setup fee. ✗ If you will pay...
Second conditional (testing)	If + past simple / were to + verb, ... would / could + verb	If we absorbed the shipping, would that change your position? · If you were to double the order...
Only if	... provided (that) / as long as + present simple	We can hold the price as long as delivery stays flexible.
Unless	= if... not	We can't go lower unless you increase the volume.
Soft rejection	I'm afraid + clause · That's a little more than we can do · I don't think we can go that far	+ because... + What we could offer instead is... / We can't do X, but we could do Y.
Close	So, to confirm what we've agreed... · I'll send (over) the details by + time	✗ I will send you until Friday → ✓ by Friday

Pronunciation. Contractions make offers sound natural and friendly: we'll /wi:l/, we'd /wi:d/, I'd. Stress the **trade**, not the grammar: If **YOU** can commit to **TWO** years, **WE** can offer **TEN** percent. Polite rejection has a **fall-rise** on the softener and a pause: I'm a**FRAID**... (pause) that doesn't quite work for us. A flat, fast "No, we

can't" sounds much ruder in English than learners intend. Labeling a concession: slow down and lower the pitch: *That really is... our LIMit.*

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Giveaway → trade:** T: "OK, we'll give you 10% off." → S: "If you commit to two years, we'll give you 10% off." T: "Fine, we'll deliver a week earlier." → S: "We can deliver a week earlier as long as you're flexible on quantity." T: "Sure, free training." → S: "We'll include training provided that you order today." Choral first, then individual; stress *YOU* and *WE*.
- 2 **Real → testing:** T: "If you order 500, we'll reduce the price." → S: "If you ordered 500, would you expect a lower price?" T: "If we pay the shipping, will you sign?" → S: "If we paid the shipping, would you sign?"
- 3 **Soften the no (fall-rise):** T: "No. Too expensive." → S: "I'm a**FRAID** that's a little more than we can do, because... What we could offer instead is..." T: "No. Impossible date." → S: "I don't think we can go that far on the date, but we could..."
- 4 **Open pairs, chain:** S1 asks for something ("Could you do a little better on the price?") → S2 trades ("I can move a little, but I'll need something in return. If you...") → S3 labels and closes ("That's a big step for us. So, to confirm...").

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE DEAL ROOM

SAY: Do you show your card to your partner? (No, never.) Do you know your partner's priorities? (No: you find out by asking questions.) Can you tell your partner your points? (No, but you can tell them what's important to you and why.) Should you accept a deal worth less than your walk-away score? (No.) Is the goal to beat your partner? (No: to get a good deal for you that they can also say yes to.) What do you do at the end? (Summarize aloud, write the deal on the record, both sign.) How long? (Five minutes to prepare, about fifteen to negotiate and close.)

◆ RUNNING THE DEAL ROOM (ROLE-PLAY MANAGEMENT)

- ◆ **Scenarios (Set D):** 1 • **The delivery contract** (Brightline Foods buys store deliveries from Northwind Logistics: price, contract length, payment terms, delivery window) • 2 • **The launch deadline** (two teams inside Maple & Stone Furniture: launch date, features, contractor budget, testing time) • 3 • **The training venue** (Silverleaf Clinics books Harbor Point Conference Center: price, dates, catering, deposit). Each scenario has four issues. On every card, two issues matter a lot to that side and two matter little, and the sides don't care about the same ones. That is what makes a win-win possible: the best deals come from each side giving way on what it cares about less.
- ◆ **Grouping:** pairs, matched roughly by level (a very strong learner against a B1 learner turns into a lecture). With an odd number, add an **observer** (checklist, Set G) or give a C1 learner the stretch card: two people on one side who must agree privately before each offer (call a "team break"). Scenario 1 is the most straightforward and suits B1 pairs; scenario 2 (internal, no money changing hands) suits confident pairs.

- ◆ **Timing:** 5 prep · 13 negotiate · 2 close and record · 2 score (22). Warn at 11 minutes. If a pair reaches deadlock, they must use one deadlock phrase and try once more before they walk away. Walking away (no deal) is an allowed result and worth zero points for both: discuss it in feedback without blame.
- ◆ **Observer checklist (the four criteria):** **Task & Purpose:** a clear deal on all four issues, or a clear decision to walk away? · **Register & Tone:** warm opening, no flat "no," goodwill at the end? · **Language Range & Accuracy:** at least two conditional trades? correct *If + present, will?* · **Organization & Delivery:** explored before proposing? summarized the deal? listened and responded to what the other side said?
- ◆ **Feedback with the numbers:** the teacher's note in Set D gives each scenario's typical "split the difference" deal and its "win-win" deal with combined points (for example, in scenario 1, splitting everything down the middle gives about 130 combined points; trading well gives about 170). Board the pairs' combined scores; ask the highest pair what they learned about the other side, and when. Don't rank individuals.
- ◆ **Face-saving:** some learners find hard bargaining uncomfortable, and some cultures treat haggling as normal and others as slightly rude. The points table depersonalizes it: "You're protecting your card, not arguing with your classmate."

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

SUPPORT (B1)

Use scenario 1. Give the **phrase strip** on the back of the card (one phrase per stage) and allow learners to write their two trades in full before they start. Accept *If you..., we can...* as the only structure; the second conditional is optional. In the Deal Room planner, the partially completed model shows the first trade. Pair them with a patient partner, not the strongest learner.

STRETCH (C1)

Tougher constraints. (1) The stretch line on the card: "You must get your director's approval for anything below X: call a short break and 'phone' your director (the observer) before you agree." (2) Use only second conditionals until minute 6, then switch to first conditionals to close. (3) Label every concession, and never make two concessions in a row without getting one back. (4) Afterwards, write the confirmation email in two registers: to the other side (formal) and to their own team on chat (informal).

◆ L1 & CROSS-CULTURAL WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"If you will...":** because the action is in the future, learners from many first languages put *will* after *if* (and after *when, as long as, provided that*). ✗ *If you will sign* → ✓ *If you sign*. Also over-polite ✗ *If you would sign, we would...* for a real, firm offer.
- ◆ **Over-direct requests:** ✗ *I want you give me discount / You must deliver on Monday* (translated directly) → ✓ *Could you do a little better on the price?* · *Would it be possible to deliver on Monday?* Missing articles: ✗ *give discount* → ✓ *a discount*. Also ✗ *I am agree* → ✓ *I agree / We can live with that*.

- ◆ **Directness in refusals:** some workplace cultures prefer a clear "no" and find hints confusing; others almost never say "no" and signal it with "that would be difficult" or silence. Teach learners to **notice** both: an indirect "that might be difficult" from their counterpart deserves the question "What would make it easier?"; and their own "no" should come with a reason and an alternative.
- ◆ **Haggling norms:** in some markets and workplaces bargaining is expected and friendly; in others, pushing on a quoted price can seem rude. Relationship-first vs deal-first: some counterparts expect small talk and trust before numbers. The online lesson's culture note says it well: observe, mirror the pace, and when unsure, ask.
- ◆ **Silence:** learners from some cultures are comfortable with long pauses; others rush to fill silence and give away a concession. Practice the "strategic pause": make an offer, then stop talking.
- ◆ **"Discuss about the price"** (Spanish *discutir sobre*, French *discuter de*): ✓ *discuss the price*. And *negotiate* + object, or *negotiate with* + person: ✗ *negotiate about the price with* is acceptable but heavy; ✓ *negotiate the price with the supplier*.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_08.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 3.2: the **confirmation email** for today's Deal Room (80–120 words, frame provided; bring it to C11), Exercises 4–5 if not done in class, "My useful phrases" and the journal. Optional: the online "Your Task" role-play with a friend or by voicing both sides.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 B "We could do another 5% if you commit to a two-year contract." (a conditional trade; A gives it away, C slams the door) · Q2 C summarize, confirm, and send the details by email · Q3 (new) B a hypothetical "feeler" to test what the other side would accept. Deal Room points and full answers for Ex 1–5 are in the answer key.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain the persuasion triangle (**trust + clear value + a clear ask**) and structure a pitch in five stages: hook/problem → solution → benefit → evidence → call to action
- ◆ turn a **feature** into a **benefit** with ...*which means that...* / ...*so that...*, and pass the "So what?" test
- ◆ use value and credibility language **honestly** (*around, in our pilot, on average*) and avoid over-hyped claims
- ◆ handle an objection with **LAARC**: listen, acknowledge, ask a clarifying question, respond (reframe, evidence or a trial), confirm
- ◆ deliver a 30-second **elevator pitch**: who · what · value · ask

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 3.3 (Key words, Key phrases, Language box, Model pitch, Exercises 1–5, Pitch planner, elevator pitch, self-check) · learners' confirmation emails from C10
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · Feature ↔ benefit flashcards (Set A3) · **Pitch & Push-back** A/B cards (Set E) · role profiles (Set B) · observer checklists (Set G) · timer · Script 3.3-A (a pitch and an objection)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the pitch. TRUST + VALUE + ASK. ① Hook / problem: *You know how...?* ② Solution: *We've built... / I'd like to introduce...* ③ Benefit: *So your team...* ④ Evidence: *In our pilot, ... cut... by around 30%.* ⑤ Call to action: *Could we run a two-week trial?* Lead with the problem, not the product.

Center: feature → benefit. FEATURE (what it is / has) + ...*which means that...* / ...*so that...* + BENEFIT (what it does for them). "It works offline" → *which means that* your drivers never lose data. Test: "So what?" until you reach time, money, stress or looking good.

Right: LAARC. Listen · Acknowledge (*That's a fair concern.*) · Ask (*Can I ask what's driving that? Is it the price or the timing?*) · Respond (value / differentiate / cost of waiting / a trial) · Confirm (*Does that address your concern?*). ✗ "You're wrong." ✗ "OK, 30% off." ✓ acknowledge first.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: emails + "trade it"	7	S–S → T–S	Learners swap their C10 confirmation emails with a partner from the other side of the deal. The partner checks three things: all four terms? a next step with a date? a warm close? (4 min). Then a 3-minute "trade it" chain round the class: T gives a giveaway ("Free

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			delivery!"), the next learner turns it into a conditional trade. Collect the emails (you'll return them in C12).
Lead-in: which one says yes?	4	T-S → S-S	Slide 14. Two short pitches for the same idea (on the slide): one starts "Let me tell you about our new software, it has twelve modules..."; the other starts "You know how we lose an hour every Monday building the report?" Pairs: which one would your manager listen to, and why? Elicit the persuasion triangle.
Model: the five stages	8	S → T-S	Slide 14 (bottom). Read Script 3.3-A once: learners number the five stages as they hear them, then note what the listener objected to and how the speaker answered. Then the workbook Model pitch (Amira): label the five stages (Ex 3 later uses a different pitch). Check.
Language: features → benefits	9	T-S → S-S	Slide 15. Feature vs benefit, the bridge phrase and the "So what?" test. Groups match the Feature ↔ benefit flashcards (Set A3), 3 min. Then value and credibility language from the Key phrases, and the honesty rule (Language box): <i>around, in our pilot, on average</i> vs "guaranteed," "everyone uses it." CCQs.
Drill	5	T-S → S	See Drill script: feature → "which means that" → benefit, choral then individual; confident falling intonation on the call to action; the acknowledging phrases with a warm tone.
Language: objections and LAARC	8	T-S → S-S	Slide 16. The four common objections and what's really behind each one; the five LAARC steps and the phrase bank. Quick demonstration: a strong learner says "It's too expensive"; you model LAARC slowly, pausing to name each step. CCQs.
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1 (feature or benefit?), Ex 2 (build the bridge) and Ex 4 (match the objection, then write the acknowledge + ask line) alone, then pairs read their Ex 4 lines aloud to each other. Ex 3 and Ex 5 are homework unless a pair finishes early.
Freer practice: Pitch & Push-back	24	S → S-S	Slide 17. See Running Pitch & Push-back . Pairs (or threes with an observer). Prep, 6 min : A reads the pitch card (Set E), or uses their role profile or their own idea, and fills the Pitch planner (five stages + two features turned into benefits). B reads the buyer card: a stated objection and a hidden real concern , and what would satisfy them. ICQs. Round 1, 7 min : A pitches (60–90 seconds); B raises the stated objection, then a second one; A uses LAARC to find the real concern; B only accepts a next step if the real concern

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			is addressed. Observer gives one strength, one "try next time." Swap cards, Round 2, 7 min. Debrief in pairs, 4 min: B reveals the hidden concern. Did A find it? With which question?
Elevator sprint	5	S-S	Slide 17 (bottom). "Speed networking": learners stand, find a new partner, and give a 30-second elevator pitch of the same idea (who · what · value · ask). Partner answers "I'd like to hear more" only if there was a clear ask. Change partners twice.
Feedback + module wrap-up	7	T-S	Board two anonymous items per criterion, e.g. Task & Purpose: no call to action ("...so, anyway, let me know"); Register & Tone: "You're wrong, it's cheap" / "This is the best product in the world"; Language: "It has offline mode which means that it has offline mode" (a feature, not a benefit); "I explain you"; Organization & Delivery: started with the product instead of the problem. Learners fix them. Praise one great clarifying question. Then slide 18: inform → trade → persuade. Learners tick all three "I can..." lists.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 3.3 and a 📶 button. Set the homework (below). Link forward: the pitch structure is the backbone of the C16 capstone presentation. Learners complete "Module 3 — looking back": which lesson helped most with their Midpoint target.
Total	90		7 + 4 + 8 + 9 + 5 + 8 + 8 + 24 + 5 + 7 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: feature vs benefit.

SAY: "The app works offline." Is that what the app is or what it does for me? (What it is / has: a feature.) "Your drivers can keep working with no signal." (A benefit: what it does for the customer.) Which one does the buyer care about? (The benefit.) · "It has a 10-hour battery." So what? ("You can work all day.") So what? ("You don't hunt for a charger in meetings.") When do you stop asking "So what?" (When you reach something the listener feels: time, money, stress, looking good to their boss.)

Meaning: call to action and honest urgency.

SAY: "...anyway, let me know what you think." Is that a clear ask? (No: the listener doesn't know what to do.) "Could we run a two-week trial with your team, starting Monday?" (Yes: one specific, low-risk next step.) · "We can only take two pilots this quarter." Is that OK to say if it's true? (Yes.) If it isn't true?

(No: false urgency destroys trust.) · "In our pilot, admin time fell by around 30%." Why "around"? (Honest: it's approximately correct, not invented precision.)

Meaning: objections.

SAY: "It's too expensive." Is this a rejection? (Not always: it can be a sign of interest; they're imagining buying.) · "That's a fair concern." Does the speaker agree the product is too expensive? (No: they agree the concern is reasonable.) Why say it first? (It keeps the conversation calm and gives you a moment to think.) · "Can I ask what's driving that?" Answer or question? (A question, to find the real issue.) · "I need to think about it." What's often behind this? (An unspoken concern.) What do you do? (Ask gently what's giving them pause.)

Form.

Bridge	feature + , which means (that) + clause · feature + , so (that) + subject + can / will	It integrates with your tools, which means that nobody has to learn a new system. · Reports run every Monday so that you start the week informed.
Value	This will save you + time / money · It cuts + noun + from X to Y · The key benefit for you is + noun / that...	It cuts the process from days to hours.
Credibility	Clients have seen + a / an + % + increase in · In our pilot, ... + past simple · On average, users report...	In our pilot, the team cut costs by around 20%.
Imagining	Imagine + (your team) + -ing / not having to + verb	Imagine your team no longer having to chase approvals.
Acknowledge + ask	That's a fair concern / I completely understand why you'd ask that · Can I ask what's driving that? · Just so I understand, is it X or Y?	Is it the price, or the timing? (choice question: rise on X, fall on Y)
Call to action	Could we + verb...? · Would you be open to + -ing...? · I'd love your go-ahead to + verb	Would you be open to trying it for two weeks?

Pronunciation. Stress the benefit words: *which means that YOU can work **ALL** day*. Choice questions rise then fall: *Is it the ↗PRICE, or the ↘TIMing?* The call to action ends **down** with confidence, not up with doubt: *Could we start with a two-week ↘TRIAL?* (a rise sounds like "...maybe?"). Acknowledging phrases need a warm, slower tone: *That's a **FAIR** concern*. Said fast and flat, it sounds dismissive.

- 1 **Feature → benefit (chain):** T: "It works offline." → S1: "...which means that your drivers can keep working with no signal." T: "Setup takes two minutes." → S2: "...so that you see results today." T: "It's cloud-based." → S3: "...which means that your team can work from anywhere." Choral, then individual; stress *YOU / YOUR*.
- 2 **So what? ladder:** T: "24/7 support." → S1: "So what?" → S2: "Someone answers at 2 a.m." → S1: "So what?" → S3: "You're never stuck, and your customers never wait."
- 3 **Acknowledge + ask (warm tone):** T: "It's too expensive." → S: "That's a fair concern. Can I ask, is it the total or the monthly cost?" T: "We already have a system." → S: "I completely understand. What do you like most about it?" T: "Now's not a good time." → S: "Of course. Can I ask what's making it difficult right now?"
- 4 **Confident ask (falling tone):** "Could we run a two-week ↘trial?" · "Would you be open to a short ↘demo on Thursday?" · "I'd love your go-ahead to pilot it with one ↘team." Individual: each learner says their own call to action.

◆ ICQS BEFORE PITCH & PUSH-BACK

SAY: *Pitchers: what do you start with, your product or the buyer's problem? (The problem.) How long is your pitch? (60–90 seconds.) What must the last sentence be? (One clear call to action.) When the buyer objects, do you answer immediately? (No: acknowledge and ask first.) · Buyers: do you show your card? (No.) Do you say your hidden concern at the start? (No: only if the pitcher asks a good question.) When do you agree to a next step? (Only when your real concern is addressed.) Should you be rude? (No: firm, realistic, polite.)*

◆ RUNNING PITCH & PUSH-BACK (ROLE-PLAY MANAGEMENT)

- ◆ **Cards (Set E):** four A/B pairs: 1 a shared meeting-room booking calendar (Northwind Logistics; stated objection "We already have a system"; hidden concern: training time for staff) · 2 ready-to-cook lunch boxes for a café chain (Brightline Foods; "It's too expensive"; hidden concern: unsold boxes going to waste) · 3 a website chat assistant (Kestrel Design; "It's not the right time"; hidden concern: no one on the team can set it up during the busy season) · 4 a training venue (Harbor Point Conference Center; "I need to think about it"; hidden concern: getting 60 staff there by public transportation). Each buyer card says what would satisfy them (a short training session, a smaller first order or sale-or-return, supplier-led setup after the busy season, directions and a site visit).
- ◆ **Grouping:** pairs; threes with an observer if numbers are odd. Change partners from C10. A learner using their own idea is pitched to a buyer who draws any buyer card and adapts it.
- ◆ **Timing:** 6 prep · 7 round 1 · 7 round 2 · 4 debrief (24). In each round: 90 seconds pitch · 4 minutes objections and LAARC · 1 minute observer feedback. Warn at 5 minutes in each round: "Buyers: decide on a next step."

- ◆ **Observer checklist (the four criteria):** **Task & Purpose:** one clear call to action? a next step agreed? · **Register & Tone:** confident but not pushy? acknowledged before responding? no over-hyped claims? · **Language Range & Accuracy:** at least two features turned into benefits? value or credibility phrases? · **Organization & Delivery:** problem first, all five stages, within 90 seconds? asked a clarifying question?
- ◆ **The debrief is the point.** Buyers reveal their hidden concern. Most pitchers will have answered the stated objection (price, timing) with arguments; the ones who asked "Can I ask what's driving that?" usually found the real issue. Make that the headline of your feedback.
- ◆ **Face-saving:** being the buyer is easier than pitching; let anxious learners buy first. A pitcher who freezes can restart once, from "You know how...?"

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

SUPPORT (B1)

Use the **partially completed** pitch in the Pitch planner (hook and solution given; the learner writes the benefit, evidence and ask). Pitch card 1 or 2. Allow a 45–60 second pitch and one objection instead of two. The phrase strip on the card has one line for each LAARC step. In Ex 1–2, items 1–4 only.

STRETCH (C1)

Harder buyers and register shifts. (1) Buyers raise a third objection, and one is a "fake" (a polite excuse); the pitcher must decide which is real. (2) Pitch the same idea twice: to a senior manager (formal, numbers first, 60 seconds) and to a peer over coffee (informal, story first). (3) Use no superlatives at all: persuade only with specific, hedged evidence. (4) Stretch learners can chair the elevator sprint and time everyone.

◆ L1 & CROSS-CULTURAL WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Hard sell vs soft sell:** in some business cultures a bold, direct "here's why you should buy" is expected; in others, it feels aggressive and trust is built slowly through modest claims and relationship. Describe both as tendencies and point to the lesson's advice: confident, honest, read the buyer. Neither extreme is the "English" way.
- ◆ **Modesty and self-promotion:** learners from workplace cultures that value modesty may understate their evidence ("maybe it helped a little"). Teach honest-but-confident: *In our pilot, processing time fell by around a third*. Learners who come from strongly promotional cultures may overclaim: ✗ *the best in the world, 100% guaranteed*. Both are fixed by the same rule: specific, hedged evidence.
- ◆ **Superlatives and "very":** ✗ *very unique, most best, more cheaper*. ✓ *unique · the best · cheaper*. Also ✗ *It permits to save time* (French *permettre de*, Spanish *permitir*) → ✓ *It lets you save time / It helps you save time*.
- ◆ **"Which means that" as a filler:** learners who learn the bridge well may repeat the feature after it ("It has offline mode, which means that it works offline"). Use the "So what?" test.

- ◆ **Arguing with objections:** in some professional cultures, correcting a client ("You're wrong, it's not expensive") is a sign of expertise. In most English-speaking business settings it sounds defensive. Acknowledge first, then give the evidence.
- ◆ **Explain me / suggest me:** ✗ *Let me explain you the benefits · Can I suggest you a trial?* → ✓ *Let me explain the benefits (to you) · Can I suggest a trial?*

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_09.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and say them back; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 3.3: Exercises 3 and 5, the 30-second elevator pitch (write it, then say it until it flows without the paper), "My useful phrases" and the journal. Optional: record your 60–90 second pitch and answer two objections aloud. Bring your recorded C9 presentation and this pitch to C14: they are the raw material for the capstone.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 B "So you can print all day without stopping to reload paper." (a benefit; A and C are features) · Q2 A "That's a fair concern. Can I ask what's driving that, the total or the monthly cost?" (acknowledge, then clarify) · Q3 (new) B "In our three-month pilot, the team cut admin time by around 30%." (specific, honest, hedged). Full answers for Ex 1–5 and a model pitch with LAARC are in the answer key.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C11: MODULE 3 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "inform, trade, persuade": **open with the five jobs · signpost every turn · chart = introduce → direct → describe → interpret (inform) → ask for the interest · "If you..., we'll..." · label it · confirm in writing (trade) → problem first · feature, which means that... · LAARC · one clear ask (persuade).** Learners tick the three "I can..." lists. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you.

Before C12, read the confirmation emails you collected. Don't correct every error: check the four terms, the next step and the tone, and write one line using the criteria ("Task & Purpose: all four terms and a clear date. Register & Tone: warm and professional. Next time: check *by* vs *until*"). These emails are a bridge to Module 4, which is about writing.

Watch for in Module 4: C12 (reports and proposals) uses the same persuasion logic in writing: a proposal is a pitch on paper (problem → solution → benefit → evidence → recommendation). Make the link out loud. C13 (CVs, cover letters and interviews) uses features → benefits for a person: "I led a team of five" → "which means I can...". C14 is the capstone rehearsal: learners plan and rehearse the C16 presentation or pitch using the C9 structure and the C11 pitch stages, and practice Q&A with LAARC.

Final Assessment (C15–C16): C15 includes **pair negotiation simulations** (use the Deal Room format; learners will get new A/B cards from [assessment/final-assessment.html](#)) and C16 includes **capstone presentations or pitches with Q&A**. Tell learners now that the Module 3 checklists and the four criteria are exactly what will be used, and ask them to check their Midpoint target (Performance Tracker, section 4) against both.

Module 4 — Business Writing & Career

The last five classes of the course. Three workshop classes, then the two-class Final Assessment. First, the documents that move decisions: reports and proposals, a standalone executive summary, a formal and objective document register, and recommendations that get approved. Then the documents and conversations that move a career: achievement-focused CV bullets, a targeted cover letter and job interviews with the STAR method, including how to talk about career gaps, career changes and qualifications from another country with confidence. Last, the review project: cross-cultural awareness, a rehearsal of the integrated client scenario, and the planning and first rehearsal of each learner's capstone presentation. C15 runs the timed writing and the negotiations; C16 runs the capstone pitches, the mock job interviews, a debrief, certificates and a celebration.

3 lessons + Final Assessment

Lessons 4.1–4.3

Classes C12–C16

Weeks 6–8

90 min per class

Level B1+ (B1–C1 mixed)

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One block = one 90-minute class. C12–C14 follow the course's workshop shape: **warmer** (review of the last class) → **lead-in** linked to learners' real needs → **model** (an executive summary, a CV extract, an interview answer, a client call) → **notice and clarify** the language (phrase banks, register, Meaning / Form / Pronunciation with concept-checking questions, CCQs) → **drill** (choral → individual; stress, intonation, polite tone) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (a role-play or simulation with A/B cards) → **feedback** on register, tone and clarity, with delayed error correction → **homework**. C15 and C16 are assessment classes with their own plans.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-4-writing-career.html](#). Print [materials/module-4/classroom-materials.html](#) before C12. It holds the word cards (document phrases, register pairs, action verbs, STAR, cross-cultural phrases), the **proposal brief cards** (A/B) for C12, the **interview kit** (candidate role cards, job adverts, interviewer cards, observer checklist) for C13 and C16, the **integrated scenario cards** for C14, the **capstone kit** (planner card, objection-style Q&A cards, peer feedback slips), the **C16 kit** (pitch running order, audience question slips, scored-interview slot schedule, performance profile cards), the **Toolkit Bingo** game and the listening scripts.

- ◆ The Final Assessment is a separate document: [assessment/final-assessment.html](#) (learner tasks) and [assessment/assessment-key.html](#) (the one shared rubric, model answers, negotiation role cards and scoring sheets). Read both before C15. **The task wording, word counts and timings printed there overrule any number in this guide.**
- ◆ The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home and copy the stress and intonation.
- ◆ **This is the course's writing module.** C12 and C15 ask learners to write under time pressure, and many working adults rarely write more than an email. Give real writing time in class (at least 10 minutes in C12, a full hour in C15) and keep the room quiet while people write. Protect the freer practice in every class: if you're running late, shorten the controlled practice (set the rest for homework), never the role-play or the writing.
- ◆ **Feedback in three columns.** During freer practice, take notes in three columns: **register & tone** (too direct, too casual, or too old-fashioned: *You must approve this · Kindly do the needful · Hey, need a yes today*), **language** (errors that cost clarity: *discuss about, I am agree, responsible of, an experience of five years, informations, It is recommended that the team is expand*) and **clarity & structure** (a buried recommendation, no clear ask, a STAR answer with no result, a pitch with no call to action). In the feedback stage, board 2–3 items from each column, without names, and always include one excellent phrase to spread.
- ◆ **One rubric, everywhere.** All observer checklists and score slips use the course's single analytic rubric (full version in [assessment/assessment-key.html](#)): **Task & Purpose, Register & Tone, Language Range & Accuracy** and **Organization & Delivery**, each scored 1–5, total /20. Learners have used it since C1 and at the C8 midpoint check; in this module they use it to give each other feedback, and you use it for the Final Assessment.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use American spelling, like the kit (*prioritize, organize, summarize, analyze, program, behavioral*), but keep the word CV. Note that in the US and Canada a job-application CV is usually called a résumé; the kit says CV to match the online lessons. Accept British forms whenever a learner uses them, and never mark an accent as "wrong."
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Write it so they can decide → present yourself so they can say yes → bring it all together. In C12 learners write for a busy reader: the answer first, the evidence behind it, and recommendations someone could act on on Monday. In C13 the same logic applies to their own career: prove results instead of listing duties, and answer interview questions with a structured story that ends in a result. In C14 they add the skill that ties the course together, adapting to other people's norms, rehearse the whole client scenario (email → meeting → pitch → negotiation → follow-up) and plan their capstone. C15–C16 turn that work into evidence: a timed writing task, a negotiation, a capstone presentation with Q&A and a short mock interview, all scored on the same four criteria learners have used since C1.

CAREER STORIES: THE LEARNER DECIDES WHAT TO SHARE

C13 and C16 ask learners to talk about work history, and your class may include job seekers, people between jobs, people working below their qualification level, and newcomers whose degrees and licenses are still being recognized. **Nobody has to disclose their salary, employment status, immigration status or a real employer.** Every CV and interview task offers **three equally good options**: your real history, a **candidate role card** (a fictional person with a fictional job and company), or a mix (your real skills in a fictional company). Say it every class: "You're practicing the English, not handing in your life story." Keep the tone respectful when a learner's history includes a **career gap**, a **career change** or a step to a **more junior role** in a new country: these are normal professional stories, and the language box gives positive, factual ways to tell them. Qualifications from another country are qualifications: never call them "not real" or "not valid"; talk about **recognition**, **credential evaluation** and **local licensing** as practical steps. Never collect, display or share a learner's real CV. If a learner offers to show you theirs, look at it privately. Interviewer cards contain **only job-related questions**: never salary, visa or immigration status, nationality, age, family, health or religion, and never **why someone left a job or a gap in employment** (the same rule as the Final Assessment interviewer card). A learner may *choose* to mention a gap or a career change; the C13 language box helps them do it positively. We don't role-play unfair or illegal interviews. For help with credential recognition or job searching, point learners to your program's career or employment services; don't give legal or immigration advice.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ Print the **word cards** (set A) for the board: the document phrases in five function colors, the email ↔ document register pairs, the action verbs, the STAR cards and the cross-cultural phrases. Cut them before C12. One set of register pairs per group of three for the C12 warmer if you want a matching race.
- ◆ For C12: the **proposal brief cards** (set B), one A/B pair per pair of learners (two different pairs of briefs, so neighbors don't have the same content). Scripts 4.1-A and 4.1-B. Optional: three colors of highlighter for the model executive summary.
- ◆ For C13: the **interview kit** (set C): six candidate role cards (several copies of each, on a side table where anyone can take one without asking), three job adverts, interviewer cards A and B, and one observer checklist per trio per round. Scripts 4.2-A and 4.2-B.
- ◆ For C14: the **Toolkit Bingo cards** (set G), the **integrated scenario cards** (set D, one set per trio), the **capstone planner card** and **peer feedback slips** (set E). Script 4.3-A and the model capstone pitch (Script 4.3-B).
- ◆ For C14: print the **Capstone Pitch Brief** and the **Mock Interview Preparation Sheet** from [assessment/final-assessment.html](#), one each per learner: they're handed out in C14.
- ◆ For C15–C16: the rest of the [assessment/final-assessment.html](#) pack (the C15 writing paper, one per learner; the negotiation cards for Scenarios 1 and 2, cut out; the negotiation run-sheet; the objection cards and the interviewer card; one score sheet per learner) and [assessment/assessment-key.html](#) (the rubric, model answers and "what to listen for"). Plus a phone timer and the **C16 kit** (set F: pitch running order, audience question slips, scored-interview slot schedule, performance profile cards). One **certificate** per learner

if your program provides them (the shared toolkit's template: `../../instructor-toolkit/certificate.html` from the kit folder): print and sign them before C16.

- ◆ **Plan the scored interviews now.** Each takes about 10 minutes (8 + 2 for notes). Only two fit inside C16, so book 10-minute slots before or after C14–C16 or on a video call within a week of C16, or recruit a **second interviewer** (co-teacher, trained volunteer, or a colleague who hires people) to interview in a quiet corner during the C16 pitches. If C14's rehearsal block runs smoothly, you can also hold three or four scored interviews there. Use the slot schedule in set F.
- ◆ Collect each learner's scores from **C1** (needs analysis and diagnostic, `assessment/needs-analysis.html`) and **C8** (`assessment/performance-check.html`) before C15. You'll need them for each learner's final score sheet (the progress row), and learners copy all three checkpoints into their **performance tracker** when results come back. (The tracker is `performance-tracker.html` in the kit folder: a Writing /20 and a Speaking /20 per checkpoint.)

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
4.1	C12 · wk 6	Reports and proposals: which is which; standard report and proposal structure; the executive summary (purpose + key findings + recommendations, written last, read first, standalone); formal, objective register (evidence verbs, the passive where it helps, hedging, clarity over jargon); document phrase banks; recommendations that get approved (specific, actionable, prioritized, cost/benefit-aware, tied to the findings); <i>It is recommended that... be...; should vs could</i>	write an 80–120-word executive summary from a set of findings, rewrite chatty or jargon-heavy sentences in document register, turn vague advice into approvable recommendations, and answer a decision-maker's questions about their proposal
4.2	C13 · wk 7	CVs, cover letters and interviews: CV structure; achievement bullets (action verb + what + measurable result); the professional summary; the four-part cover letter (opening · why you · why them · closing); common interview questions; STAR for behavioral questions; talking about gaps, career changes and foreign credentials positively; asking questions and closing	rewrite duties as quantified achievements, write a three-line professional summary, give a STAR answer in under two minutes, frame a career gap or an overseas qualification in one positive sentence, and ask two good questions at the end of an interview (their own history or a role card)
4.3	C14 · wk 7	Review project: whole-course toolkit self-assessment; cross-cultural dimensions	rate their own toolkit and choose two targets, adapt an opening to a

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
		(directness, formality, relationship vs task, time, disagreement, decision-making, high/low context) as tendencies, not stereotypes; golden rules; reading soft signals; the integrated client scenario (email → meeting → pitch → negotiation → follow-up); capstone planning and first rehearsal for C16	formal, relationship-first, consensus-driven team, recognize and respond to a soft "no," run the meeting, pitch and negotiation stages with a partner, and give a first full run of their capstone presentation
FA-A	C15 · wk 8	Final Assessment, part A: 60-minute timed writing (Task 1: an executive summary + recommendations for a Northwind proposal · Task 2: a cover letter <i>or</i> a formal email), then pair negotiations with private priorities (three 7-minute rounds, two pairs per round) and a written deal memo	write both texts to time using the document and letter structures from Modules 1 and 4, and negotiate a fair agreement with a partner using conditional offers and diplomatic language
FA-B	C16 · wk 8	Final Assessment, part B: capstone pitches (5 min + Q&A; individual, or in pairs for 9–14 learners), mock job interviews (peer practice in class, teacher-scored interviews in slots), debrief, certificates and celebration	deliver a structured 5-minute pitch with a clear call to action, handle audience questions, give a STAR answer in an interview, and leave with a personal action plan (results return privately within a week)

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ say whether a task needs a **report** (present findings) or a **proposal** (persuade toward an action), and choose the matching standard structure
- ◆ write a **standalone executive summary** of 80–120 words: purpose + key findings + main recommendations, with the answer up front
- ◆ rewrite email-style or jargon-heavy sentences in **formal, objective document register** (*The data indicates...*, *It was found that...*, *This suggests...*)
- ◆ turn a vague suggestion into a **specific, actionable, prioritized** recommendation tied to evidence, using *We recommend + -ing*, *It is recommended that... be...* and *should* (firm) vs *could* (option)
- ◆ present their summary to a "decision-maker," answer two questions and accept or negotiate a decision diplomatically

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.1 (Key phrases, Language box, model executive summary, Exercises 1–5, writing task, the decision-maker role-play, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 2–7 · word cards set A (document phrases in five colors; email ↔ document register pairs) · **proposal brief cards** set B (two A/B pairs) · optional highlighters
- ◆ Listening scripts 4.1-A (a findings briefing at Brightline Foods) and 4.1-B (a voicemail from a busy director)

BOARD PLAN

Left: which document? REPORT = what happened / what the evidence shows (past, present) · inform. PROPOSAL = what we should do and why (future) · persuade. Report: Title → Executive Summary → Introduction → Findings → Conclusions → Recommendations → Appendices. Proposal: Background → Objectives → Plan → Benefits → Costs / Timeline → Risks → Recommendation / call to action.

Center: the executive summary. Written LAST, read FIRST, stands ALONE. Purpose (This report examines...) + key findings (Late deliveries rose from 6% to 14%. Notably, ...) + recommendations (We recommend three actions: (1)... (2)... (3)...). ✗ This report will discuss... ✓ State the answer.

Right: register and recommendations. I think → The data indicates... · We found out → It was found that... · I'm pretty sure → This suggests... · You should hire → We recommend hiring... / It is recommended that the team be expanded. **S-A-P-C-T:** Specific · Actionable · Prioritized · Cost/benefit-aware · Tied to findings. *should* = firm · *could* = option.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: feature → benefit relay	8	S-S (teams)	Review C11 (3.3, pitching and handling objections). Board six features of a fictional product (<i>a route-planning app: updates every 5 minutes · works offline · one price for 10 users...</i>). Two teams race to turn each feature into a benefit with "... which means you...". Then the bridge: "A proposal is a pitch on paper. Today we write for someone who has ten minutes and a budget." Quick check of one C11 homework item (the 30-second elevator pitch): two volunteers say theirs; note one strong phrase.
Lead-in: the busy reader	6	T-S → S-S	Read Script 4.1-B (a director's voicemail: "I'll only read the summary..."). Ask: "What does Jordan want? What will he read? What does he need to see?" (purpose, numbers, what to approve, cost, by when). Slide 2: report vs proposal. Say the two triggers ("Give me the findings." / "Convince me to fund this.") and learners point left (report) or right (proposal) for four quick situations. Needs link: "Who writes reports or proposals at work? Who reads them?" Two or three answers only; role-card answers are fine.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Model: the executive summary	8	S → S-S → T-S	Slides 3–4. Workbook 4.1, model executive summary (Northwind Logistics). Learners mark P (purpose), F (findings) and R (recommendations), or highlight in three colors. Pairs answer the four model questions. Feedback: it states results, not a promise of results; the most striking finding is flagged with <i>Notably</i> ; the recommendations are numbered; the last sentence gives the expected result. CCQs (below): "written last, read first."
Language: register and recommendations (M/F/P)	10	T-S	Slide 5: email register → document register. Say an email sentence; learners call out the document version from the slide, then cover it and try again. Slide 6: the five marks of an approvable recommendation (S-A-P-C-T) and the vague → approvable table. Build <i>It is recommended that the team be expanded</i> on the board; CCQs on the subjunctive and on <i>should vs could</i> (below). Stick the colored document-phrase cards on the board under five headings: Purpose · Findings · Data · Conclusion · Recommend.
Drill: say it like a report	5	T-S → S	See Drill script. Choral phrase chain with stress, then the <i>-teen / -ty</i> number contrast, then an individual transformation drill (chatty → document register).
Listening: the findings briefing	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 4.1-A (Brightline Foods: a team lead briefs a manager on customer complaints). First listening: "Report or proposal? What's the main problem?" Second listening: learners complete the six number gaps. Pairs compare, then each writes one finding sentence with a phrase from the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			bank (<i>Notably, ... · The data reveals...</i>). Check the numbers on the board, especially <i>forty vs fourteen</i> .
Controlled practice	11	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (order the sections), Ex 3 (match the phrase to its function) and Ex 4 (rewrite for document register), alone, then check in pairs. Board-check Ex 4 carefully: accept any answer that is objective, clear and jargon-free. Ex 5 (vague → approvable + <i>should / could / subjunctive</i>) in pairs if time; otherwise homework.
Freer practice: the decision-maker	25	S → S-S (pairs) → T-S	Slide 7. Hand out the proposal brief cards (set B): A and B in each pair have different proposals. ICQs first. (1) Write (10 min): each learner writes an 80–120-word executive summary of their own proposal in the workbook frame. (2) Round 1 (6 min): A gives the summary to B. B reads it for 60 seconds only , then, using the "When you are the decision-maker" box on their own card, asks two questions and gives a decision: <i>approve · approve with changes · not yet</i> , with one reason. A answers and may negotiate. One minute of feedback from B with the checklist. (3) Round 2 (6 min): swap. (4) Board share (3 min): "Hands up if your proposal was approved... approved with changes? What changed?"
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction in three columns. Register & tone, for example: "You must approve this" → "We recommend approving..."; "I feel that..." → "The data suggests...". Language: "It is recommended that the software is buy" → "be bought"; "an increase of 14 percents." Clarity: a summary that ended before the recommendations; recommendations

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			with no owner or date. Learners fix the errors aloud. Praise one approvable recommendation you heard (read it out).
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 4.1 on screen; point at a 📶 button. Set the homework (below): the key task is a clean final version of the executive summary. Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		8 + 6 + 8 + 10 + 5 + 7 + 11 + 25 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect the decision-maker role-play and its writing time. Cut in this order: (1) the warmer stops at 5 minutes; (2) Ex 3 and Ex 5 become homework (keep Ex 4, the register rewrite); (3) the board share in the role-play becomes one question to the whole class. Every learner must write a summary and be the decision-maker once.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: report or proposal? The difference is emphasis: a report leads with what *is*; a proposal leads with what *should be*. A report may end with recommendations; a proposal must sell the benefits.

SAY: "Give me the findings from the customer survey." Report or proposal? (Report.) "Convince me to fund a second delivery van." (Proposal.) Can a report include recommendations? (Yes, often.) Which one must sell? (The proposal.) Which one looks mainly at the past and present? (The report.)

Meaning: the executive summary.

SAY: Do you write the executive summary first? (No: last.) Where does it go in the document? (First.) The director reads only this page. Can she make a decision? (She must be able to.) Can it say "This report will discuss the causes"? (No: state the causes.) Can it say "as discussed above"? (No: it must stand alone.) How long? (Short: a few sentences, about 5–10% of the document.)

Meaning: the subjunctive and *should* / *could*.

SAY: "It is recommended that the team be expanded." Has the team been expanded yet? (No.) Is this an order? (No: a formal recommendation.) Is it more or less formal than "We should hire more people"? (More formal.) Why "be" and not "is"? (After recommend / propose / suggest that..., formal American English uses the base form.) "We should prioritize the billing fix." Firm or optional? (Firm.) "We could also consider a weekend shift." (Optional: worth considering.)

Form.

Purpose	<i>The aim / purpose of this report is to + verb · This report examines / assesses... · This proposal sets out...</i>	This report examines the causes of late deliveries in the first quarter.
Findings	<i>The results show / indicate that... · It was found that... (passive) · Notably, ...</i>	It was found that 70% of late orders were on Monday and Tuesday routes.
Data	<i>As shown in Figure 1, ... (no article before Figure 1) · See Appendix A</i>	As shown in Figure 1, costs peaked in March.
Conclusion (hedged)	<i>This suggests that... · It appears that... · On balance, ...</i>	This suggests that the problem is seasonal.
Recommend	<i>We recommend + -ing · We recommend that + subject + base form · It is recommended that + subject + be + past participle</i>	We recommend leasing a second van. · It is recommended that the contract be renewed.
Priority	<i>As a priority, ... · In the short term, ...; in the longer term, ... · numbered list</i>	In the short term, we should fix the billing error; in the longer term, we could review pay bands.

Pronunciation. Findings live or die on **numbers**. Contrast the stress: four**TEEN** vs **FORT**y, fif**TEEN** vs **FIFT**y, and say *percent* with stress on the second syllable (per**CENT**), never "percents." Recommendations are spoken in chunks with the key word stressed: *We re**COMM**end | **HIR**ing two **AG**ents | by the **END** of Q3. Data is **DAY**-ta or **DAH**-ta: both are fine.*

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Phrase chain** (choral, then three individuals): "The **AIM** of this **RE**port is to..." → "The re**SULTS** in**DI**cate that..." → "**NOTE**ably, ..." → "This sug**GESTS** that..." → "We re**COMM**end that...". Learners finish each one with a word from the Brightline story ("...that complaints doubled").
- 2 -teen or -ty?** (T-S, then pairs): T says "fourteen percent" or "forty percent"; learners hold up one finger for -teen, two for -ty. Six items (14/40, 15/50, 16/60, 13/30, 18/80, 19/90). Then pairs do the same with each other.
- 3 Transform it** (individual, fast): T: "I think we lost customers because of the price." → S: "The data indicates that customer loss was driven by price." T: "We found out that most calls are about tracking." → "It was found that most calls concern tracking." T: "You should hire two more people." → "We recommend hiring two more agents." / "It is recommended that two agents be hired." T: "Firm: prioritize the billing fix." → "We should prioritize the billing fix." T: "Option: a weekend shift." → "We could also consider a weekend shift."

- ◆ **Grouping.** Pairs. Give half the pairs brief pair 1 (Northwind Logistics / Brightline Foods) and the other half brief pair 2 (Kestrel Design / Clearwater Health Supplies), so neighbors can't copy. Odd numbers: one trio in which the third learner is an **observer** with the checklist and becomes a second decision-maker in round 2.
- ◆ **The information gap.** Each card has two parts: **Your proposal** (the facts for your own summary) and **When you are the decision-maker** (your budget, priorities and two questions to ask your partner). The writer can't see the decision-maker's limits, so negotiation happens naturally (for example, the Northwind proposal costs more in its first year than the director can approve alone).
- ◆ **Writing (10 min).** 80–120 words, in the workbook frame, with a title. Walk round and check three things only: the purpose is in the first sentence, there is at least one number, and the recommendations are numbered. Don't correct grammar now.
- ◆ **Decision rounds (6 min each).** 1 minute of silent reading (the decision-maker must stop at 60 seconds: "That's all a director has"), 4 minutes of questions, answers and a decision, 1 minute of feedback. Decision language is on slide 7: *I'm happy to approve this on one condition... · Could you clarify...? · I'd need to see... before I can approve... · Let's start with phase one.*
- ◆ **Observer / partner checklist** (in the workbook and on the card): **Task & Purpose:** purpose, findings and recommendations are all there; the ask is clear. **Register & Tone:** objective, no chatty phrases, no jargon; the spoken answers stay polite under pressure. **Language Range & Accuracy:** document phrases from the bank; *recommend + -ing* or the subjunctive used correctly; numbers accurate. **Organization & Delivery:** purpose → findings → recommendations; recommendations numbered or prioritized; clear, calm answers.
- ◆ **You sit with a different pair each round and take three-column notes.** If a decision-maker says only "OK, approved," prompt: "Ask one of your questions first."

SAY: *ICQs: How many words in your summary? (80 to 120.) What comes first? (The purpose.) When you're the decision-maker, how long do you read? (60 seconds only.) Can you show your partner your budget? (No: ask questions and decide.) What are the three possible decisions? (Approve, approve with changes, not yet.) What must you give with your decision? (One reason.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

SUPPORT (B1)

Give B1 learners the **partially completed frame** in the workbook: *This proposal sets out...* · *Currently, ...* · *Notably, ...* · *We recommend (1)...* (2)... · *Together, these steps are expected to...*
They fill it from their brief card; 80 words is enough. Fewer items: Ex 3 items 1–6, Ex 4 items 1–4. As decision-makers, they read the two questions printed on their card and choose a decision from the three phrases on the slide.
Target: a summary with a purpose, two numbers and two numbered recommendations.

STRETCH (C1)

Strong writers tend to write too much. Set a strict **100-word ceiling** and ask them to include (1) one **hedged** finding (*This suggests...*), (2) one **risk with its mitigation** (*The main risk is...; to manage this, we will...*) and (3) a recommendation in the subjunctive. As decision-makers, they must push back with a **counter-condition** ("I can approve the software now if the van is phased into Q3"). Extra: rewrite one recommendation for two readers, a finance director (cost first) and the team (workload first).

◆ L1 & CROSS-CULTURAL WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Old-fashioned formulas** taught as "business English" in some school systems: *Kindly do the needful* · *Please find herewith* · *We humbly request* · *I am writing to inform you that...* at the start of every document. Formal documents today are **clear and modern**: *This report examines...* · *We recommend...*
- ◆ **Density as a sign of respect.** Some academic and civil-service traditions reward long sentences and heavy nouns (*the implementation of the optimization of...*). Say plainly: in most English-speaking workplaces, a short, clear document is the respectful one, because it saves the reader's time.
- ◆ **The recommendation at the end, or not at all.** In some workplace cultures, telling a senior reader what to do feels presumptuous, so learners bury the recommendation or hedge it away. Explain that "bottom line up front" is the expected, polite norm in many English-speaking organizations, and that *We recommend...* is professional, not rude.
- ◆ **Uncountable nouns and verb patterns:** *informations, researches, feedbacks, equipments, advices; discuss about, emphasize on, recommend to do* (✓ *recommend doing / recommend that we do*). *The data shows / show*: accept both.
- ◆ **Numbers:** decimal commas (14,5%) and thousands points (9.600 \$) from many European and Latin American systems. In US documents: 14.5%, \$9,600, currency symbol first. Stress -teen / -ty clearly when presenting.
- ◆ **Articles:** *the data, the results, the appendix*, but no article before a label: *as shown in Figure 1, see Appendix A*.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_10.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and copy the stress; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 4.1: write a clean

final version of your executive summary (your brief card, the Brightline notes from Ex 1, or a work topic with names and figures changed), finish Ex 5, "My useful phrases" and the journal. Keep the summary: learners can build on it for the C15 writing task and the C16 capstone.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** a short, standalone recap of purpose, key findings and recommendations, written last and placed first ·
Q2 **C** "We recommend hiring two agents by the end of Q3..." · Q3 (new) **B** "The data indicates that customer loss was driven mainly by price increases." · Q4 (new) **B** a proposal. Listening (Ex 1): 1 400 · 2 240 · 3 55 · 4 25 · 5 half (50%) · 6 12 cents (\$0.12).

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ rewrite duty statements (*Responsible for...*) as **achievement bullets**: action verb + what you did + a measurable result
- ◆ write a three-line **professional summary** (who you are + key strengths + what you offer) with no empty adjectives
- ◆ recognize the four parts of a targeted **cover letter** and use its standard phrases
- ◆ answer a behavioral question with **STAR** (Situation, Task, Action, Result) in under two minutes, with / in the Action and a concrete Result
- ◆ describe a **career gap**, a **career change** or a **qualification from another country** in one or two positive, factual sentences, and share only what they choose
- ◆ ask two thoughtful questions at the end of an interview and close politely

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.2 (Key phrases, Language box, model CV extract, Exercises 1–5, writing task, mock interview trios, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 8–12 · word cards set A (action verbs, STAR, interview phrases) · **interview kit** set C: six candidate role cards, three job adverts, interviewer cards A and B, observer checklists · a phone timer per trio
- ◆ Listening scripts 4.2-A (two answers to the same STAR question) and 4.2-B ("Tell me about yourself": a career changer with an overseas degree)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the CV. Contact → Professional summary (3 lines) → Experience (most recent first, 3–5 bullets each) → Education → Skills. **Bullet = action verb + what + result.** ✗ Responsible for sales. ✓ Grew regional sales 20% in 12 months. No number? Use scale (40+ a week), frequency, time saved, before → after (78% → 91%).

Center: cover letter + your path. Opening (role + where you saw it + a hook) → Why you (2–3 of their needs + evidence) → Why them (something real about the company) → Closing (call to action). Gap: *From 2021 to 2023, I took a career break for family reasons. During that time, I completed...* Credentials: *My degree has been assessed as equivalent to a U.S. bachelor's degree.* You choose what to share.

Right: the interview. Tell me about yourself = present → past → future (under 1 min). **S** In my last role, we were... · **T** I was responsible for... · **A** So I... (I, not we) · **R** As a result, ... End: What does success look like in the first six months? · What are the next steps? · Thank you for your time.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: approve it or not?	7	S-S (pairs) → T-S	Review C12. Board three vague recommendations (<i>We should fix the website.</i> · <i>Staff need training.</i> · <i>Costs are too high.</i>) with one fact under each. Pairs have 4 minutes to make each one approvable (S-A-P-C-T). Two pairs read theirs; the class says "approve" or "not yet" and why. Quick check of the C12 homework: two learners read the first sentence of their executive summary. Bridge: "Yesterday you proved a plan was worth the money. Today you prove you are."
Lead-in: which one gets the interview?	5	T-S	Slide 8, top: two CV bullets for the same job (<i>Responsible for customer complaints.</i> / <i>Resolved 40+ customer issues a week, lifting satisfaction from 78% to 91%.</i>). "Which person gets the interview? Why?" Mention CV (UK and many other countries) vs <i>résumé</i> (US, Canada). Introduce the candidate role cards on the side table: "For every CV and interview task today, you can use your real history, a role card, or a mix. Nobody needs to share a real employer, a salary or anything private."
Language: achievement bullets (M/F/P)	9	T-S → S	Slide 8. The formula and the action-verb groups (word cards on the board: Led · Delivered · Increased · Reduced · Streamlined · Built · Negotiated · Trained · Achieved). Build one weak → strong bullet together, eliciting the verb, the "what" and the number. CCQs (below). Learners then look at the model CV extract in Workbook 4.2 and find the one duty bullet; pairs rewrite it.
Model: summary and cover letter	7	T-S → S-S	Slide 9. Read the model professional summary; learners find <i>who</i> , <i>strengths</i> and <i>what they offer</i> . Then the four parts of the cover letter and the phrase bank. Workbook Ex 3 (match the sentence to the part) in pairs, 3 minutes. Quick check: "Which sentence would work for any company?" (None of the good ones: that's the test.)

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Listening: two answers, one question	7	T-S → S-S	Slide 10. Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 4.2-A : Rafael and Joy answer "Tell me about a time you had to meet a tight deadline." First listening: "Who would you hire? Why?" Second listening (Joy only): learners write the first words of each STAR part. Pairs compare; board the STAR frames and the tenses (Language box).
Your path: gaps, changes, credentials	5	T-S → S	Slide 11. Read Script 4.2-B (Nadia answers "Tell me about yourself": an engineer from overseas, a career break, now an operations assistant). Ask: "How does she talk about the gap? About her degree? Does she apologize?" (Short, factual, positive; then back to what she offers.) Show the three frames in the Language box. Learners choose one frame and complete it silently for themselves or for a role card. No sharing required; volunteers only.
Drill: sound confident	5	T-S → S	See Drill script. Choral "Tell me about yourself" in three chunks, STAR kick-off phrases with a steady, falling tone, then individual questions-to-ask with polite rising intonation.
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (duty → achievement, with the facts given) and Ex 4 (order the STAR answer), alone, then compare. Board-check Ex 4. Ex 5 (fix the weak line) in pairs if time; otherwise homework. Early finishers start the writing task: a professional summary + three bullets for themselves or a role card.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Freer practice: mock interview trios	25	S-S (trios) → T-S	Slide 12. Trios: candidate , interviewer (uses interviewer card A or B and a job advert), observer (times and fills the observer checklist). Two minutes to set up: candidates choose a job advert and decide real history or role card; interviewers read their card. Then three rounds of 7½ minutes, roles rotate: interview (6 min: <i>Tell me about yourself</i> → one STAR question → one more question → "Do you have any questions for us?" → close) + feedback (1½ min: the observer gives one strength and one next step, with a quote). Put a timer on the screen and call "Last question" at 5 minutes. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction in three columns. Register & tone: "My boss was terrible" → "It wasn't the right fit for my goals"; "I want this job because I need money" → "I'm drawn to this role because...". Language: "I have an experience of five years" → "five years' experience"; "I was responsible of" → "for"; "since three years." Clarity: a STAR answer with no result, "we" throughout. Ask two candidates: "Which answer felt strongest? What made it strong?"
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 4.2 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below): the key task is two STAR stories said aloud, which learners will need in C16. Learners tick the "I can..." box.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 9 + 7 + 7 + 5 + 5 + 10 + 25 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect the interview trios. Cut in this order: (1) Ex 3 (cover letter matching) becomes homework and the cover letter is shown on the slide only; (2) Ex 2 shrinks to items 1–3; (3) the trios run three rounds of 6½ minutes (interview 5 min: skip the extra question). Every learner must be the candidate once.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: duties vs achievements. A duty says what the job was; an achievement proves you were good at it.

SAY: "Responsible for sales in my region." Does it say if sales went up? (No.) Could anyone with that job title write it? (Yes.) "Grew regional sales 20% in 12 months." What's the verb? (Grew.) What's the result?

(20%.) You don't have an exact number. Can you invent one? (No: estimate honestly, or use scale, frequency, time saved, before → after.)

Meaning: STAR.

SAY: Which part is the longest? (Action.) In the Action, "I" or "we"? (I: what you did.) Can the Situation take a minute? (No: one or two sentences.) An answer with no Result: is it finished? (No: the interviewer wants to know what happened.) Can the Result be something you learned? (Yes, especially after a mistake, but add an outcome if you can.)

Meaning: your path.

SAY: An interviewer sees a two-year gap. Do you need to give private details? (No: one short, true sentence is enough.) Should you apologize? (No: state it, then say what you did or learned, then move on.) Your degree is from another country. Is it a real degree? (Yes.) What can you add to help the employer? (That it has been assessed, or that you're completing local licensing.) Should you change the dates on your CV to hide a gap? (No: never invent or hide facts.)

Form.

Achievement bullet	past simple action verb (no subject, no "I") + object + result (<i>by</i> + %, <i>from...to...</i> , <i>saving...</i>)	Reduced picking errors by 18% by introducing a two-step check.
S — Situation	past simple / past continuous / past perfect for background	Last spring, a client had moved its launch forward, and we were already short-staffed.
T — Task	<i>I was responsible for</i> + -ing / noun · <i>I had to</i> + verb	As the coordinator, I had to deliver forty displays in half the time.
A — Action	<i>So I</i> + past simple (a sequence) · <i>I decided to...</i> · <i>I asked... to...</i>	So I split the job into daily targets and asked the printer to run two shifts.
R — Result	<i>As a result, ...</i> · <i>This led to...</i> + present perfect for a lasting effect	As a result, we delivered a day early, and the client has since signed a two-year contract.
Gap / change	<i>From... to...</i> , <i>I took a career break to...</i> · <i>During that time, I completed...</i> · <i>I'm now looking to...</i>	From 2021 to 2023, I took a career break for family reasons. During that time, I completed a certificate in supply chain management.
Credentials	<i>I hold a...in... from...</i> · <i>It has been assessed as equivalent to...</i> · <i>I'm currently completing...</i>	I hold a degree in industrial engineering. It has been assessed as equivalent to a U.S. bachelor's degree.

Pronunciation. Confidence is mostly **pace and falling intonation**. "Tell me about yourself" is spoken in three chunks (present | past | future), each ending with a fall: *I'm an operations **CO**ordinator ↘ | with seven years in food distri**B**ution ↘ | and I'm looking to... ↘*. A rising end on every statement sounds unsure. Numbers in results carry the main stress: *by eigh**TEEN** percent*. Questions to the interviewer are polite with a gentle rise on yes/no questions (*Is there a chance to...? ↗*) and a fall on wh- questions (*What does success look like in the first six months? ↘*).

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Three chunks** (choral, then four individuals): T: "I'm a logistics **CO**ordinator ↘ |" → S. T: "with six years in **WARE**house operations ↘ |" → S. T: "and I'm looking to bring that experience to a **GROW**ing team ↘." → S. Then learners replace the details with their own or their role card's.
- 2 **STAR kick-offs** (choral, steady tone): "In my **LAST** role, we were..." · "I was res**PON**sible for..." · "So I decided to..." (stress on /) · "As a re**SULT**, ...". T says a letter (S, T, A, R); learners say the matching kick-off.
- 3 **Verb it** (individual, fast): T: "Responsible for training." → S: "Trained twelve new staff." T: "In charge of a budget." → "Managed a \$40,000 budget." T: "Did the reports." → "Streamlined monthly reporting." T: "Helped with complaints." → "Resolved..."
- 4 **Questions to ask** (choral, then individual): "What does success look like in this role in the first six months? ↘" · "How would you describe the team culture? ↘" · "What are the next steps in the process? ↘" · "Thank you for your time today ↘ — I really enjoyed our conversation ↘."

◆ MOCK INTERVIEW TRIOS – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Roles.** The **interviewer** reads only from the interviewer card: friendly, professional, no teaching. The **candidate** answers (real history, a role card, or a mix: say it again). The **observer** keeps time and fills the checklist. Give confident talkers the observer role first: it asks them to listen.
- ◆ **Materials.** Each trio gets the three job adverts, one interviewer card (A for rounds 1 and 3, B for round 2, so questions vary) and three observer checklists. Candidates choose the advert that best fits their history or role card.
- ◆ **One round (7½ min):** the interviewer opens ("Thank you for coming in. Please have a seat.") → *Tell me about yourself* (under 1 min) → one STAR question from the card → one more question from the card → "Do you have any questions for us?" → close ("Thank you, we'll be in touch.") → observer feedback: **one strength and one next step, both quoted** (1½ min).
- ◆ **Topics interviewers never raise.** Salary, visa or immigration status, nationality, age, family, health, religion, why someone left a job, or gaps in employment: the same list as the Final Assessment interviewer card. A candidate may *choose* to mention a gap, a career change or an overseas qualification (the "Your path" line on the role cards); the interviewer responds briefly and respectfully and moves on.

- ◆ **Observer checklist** (rubric criteria): **Task & Purpose**: answers the question asked; STAR has all four parts with a result; asks at least one question at the end. **Register & Tone**: positive about past employers; confident, not arrogant; polite close. **Language Range & Accuracy**: action verbs, past tenses in the story, interview phrases. **Organization & Delivery**: *Tell me about yourself* under a minute (present → past → future); clear STAR order; steady pace and eye contact.
- ◆ **You** sit in with a different trio each round and take three-column notes. Note one strength per learner now: you'll use them in C16.

SAY: ICQs: *How many roles? (Three: candidate, interviewer, observer.) Must you use your real work history? (No: a role card or a mix is fine.) How long is "Tell me about yourself"? (Under one minute.) In the Action, I or we? (I.) Can the interviewer ask about your family, your age or a gap in your CV? (No: only job-related questions. You can mention a gap if you want to.) What does the observer give? (One strength and one next step, with a quote.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

SUPPORT (B1)

B1 learners often know exactly what they achieved but can't find the verb. Give them the **action-verb cards** to keep on the desk and let them choose a role card with its bullets already half-written. For STAR, they use the **four-box frame** in the workbook (one line per box, kick-off phrase printed). Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–3, Ex 5 items 1–3. In the interview, they may keep their STAR notes on the table. Target: *Tell me about yourself* in three sentences, one STAR answer with a result, and one question at the end.

STRETCH (C1)

Strong learners should sound **specific without sounding rehearsed**. Ask them to (1) answer with a STAR story that includes a **setback** and what they learned; (2) tailor *Tell me about yourself* to two different adverts and notice what changes; (3) as interviewers, ask one **unscripted follow-up** ("What would you do differently?" "How did you measure that?").

◆ L1 & CROSS-CULTURAL WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Modesty norms**. In many workplace cultures, saying "I achieved..." feels like boasting, and learners say "we" throughout or give credit to the team. Explain that interviewers in many English-speaking countries need to hear **your** contribution; "I" in the Action is expected, and you can still thank the team in the Result.
- ◆ **CV conventions differ by country**: a photo, date of birth, marital status or nationality on the CV is normal in some markets and is left off in the US, Canada, the UK and others to reduce bias. Present it as "local norms," never as one right way. Learners decide what fits the market they're applying in.

- ◆ **"I have an experience of five years" and "since five years"** (Spanish, French, Italian, Portuguese, Arabic patterns): teach *five years' experience* · *I've worked there for five years*. **"Responsible of" / "in charge for"**: *responsible for, in charge of*.
- ◆ **Titles and first names.** Some learners will call the interviewer "Sir" or "Madam" throughout; others use a first name immediately. Teach the middle path: *Ms. / Mr. + surname* until invited, or the first name if the interviewer introduces themselves that way.
- ◆ **Handshakes and eye contact** vary by culture and by person. Don't require a handshake in the role-play; a greeting, a smile and "Nice to meet you" work everywhere. Steady eye contact is expected in many English-speaking interviews but is uncomfortable for some learners: suggest looking at the interviewer's face while listening and at the end of each answer.
- ◆ **Weakness answers.** Learners from systems where admitting a weakness is risky may say "I have no weakness" or "I'm a perfectionist." Show the pattern: a real, non-essential weakness + what you do about it.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_11.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 4.2: finish the writing task (a professional summary + three achievement bullets, for yourself or a role card), Ex 5, "My useful phrases" and the journal. **Write out two STAR stories and say each one aloud twice** (record it on your phone if you can). You'll use them in the C16 mock interview.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** "Led an 8-person sales team to exceed target by 18% in a year." · Q2 **A** the specific steps you personally took · Q3 (new) **B** "I'd achieved what I could there..." · Q4 (new) **B** explain it briefly and positively, and mention what you did or learned. Listening (Ex 1): Joy is stronger. S "Last spring, one of our biggest clients..." · T "As the project coordinator, I had to..." · A "So I split the job into daily targets..." · R "As a result, all forty displays arrived a day early..."

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ rate themselves 1–5 on the course's **twelve toolkit areas** and choose two to target
- ◆ describe the main **cross-cultural dimensions** (directness, formality and hierarchy, relationship vs task, time, disagreement, decision-making, high vs low context) as tendencies that vary by person and organization, not as national rules
- ◆ adapt an opening and a request for a **formal, relationship-first, consensus-driven** team, and recognize and respond to a **soft "no"**
- ◆ run the meeting, pitch and negotiation stages of the **integrated client scenario** with a partner, adapting register and tone
- ◆ plan a **5-minute capstone pitch** from the Capstone Pitch Brief (opening with a hook → problem → solution → benefits → evidence → close with a call to action), predict two objections, and give a first full rehearsal

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.3 (Key phrases, My toolkit, Language box, Exercises 1–5, capstone planner, scenario rehearsal, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 13–15 · **Toolkit Bingo** cards and caller list (set G) · **integrated scenario cards** (set D, one set per trio) · **capstone planner card** and **peer feedback slips** (set E) · word cards set A (cross-cultural phrases) · phone timers
- ◆ Listening scripts 4.3-A (a first call: misstep and repair) and 4.3-B (a short model pitch, about 3 minutes)
- ◆ From [assessment/final-assessment.html](#): the **Capstone Pitch Brief** and the **Mock Interview Preparation Sheet**, one each per learner (don't hand out the C15 writing paper)

BOARD PLAN

Left: norms vary (tendencies, not rules). Direct ↔ indirect · formal ↔ informal · relationship first ↔ task first · fixed time ↔ flexible time · open disagreement ↔ quiet signals · one decider ↔ consensus · low context (say it) ↔ high context (imply it). Golden rules: observe & mirror · start formal · no idioms · confirm in writing · different ≠ wrong · ask.

Center: the scenario. Kestrel Design → Harborview Retail. 1 Email (propose a kick-off) → 2 Meeting (welcome, small talk, light agenda) → 3 Pitch (feature → benefit → call to action) → 4 Negotiate (15%? → *If you can commit to two years, we could offer 10%.*) → 5 Follow-up (summary + next steps). Soft no: *That may be somewhat difficult.* → *I sense this may be difficult — shall we look at another option?*

Right: your capstone (C16). 5 min + Q&A (pairs: each speaks 2+ min). Opening + hook → problem (1 number) → solution → benefits (...which means that...) → evidence → close: call to action. Topic: your

own idea · the Review Project · Brief 1, 2 or 3. Q&A: *That's a good question. · If I understand correctly, you're asking... · I don't have that figure with me, but I'll send it by Friday.*

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Toolkit Bingo	8	T-S → S	Review the whole course (and C13) with Toolkit Bingo (materials set G). Read situations from the caller list ("A senior manager reads only the first line of your email."); learners find the phrase that fits on their card and cross it out. First to complete a line reads the phrases aloud and must say each one with the right tone. Play two games; stop at 7 minutes. One minute of homework talk: "Did you say your STAR stories aloud? Which one is strongest?"
Lead-in: my toolkit	6	S → S-S	Workbook 4.3, "My toolkit": learners rate the twelve areas 1–5 and circle two strongest and two weakest. Pairs compare their weakest two and say one situation at work (real or role card) where it matters. "Today we practice the one skill that runs through all twelve, and you plan how you'll show your best in C16."
Cross-cultural focus (M/F/P)	12	T-S → S-S	Slide 13: the seven dimensions. Stress tendencies : "Some workplace cultures prefer...; people vary inside every culture and every company." Pairs place themselves on two of the lines (volunteers only share). Slide 14 and Workbook Ex 1: read Script 4.3-A twice: version 1 (the misstep), learners note three problems; version 2 (the repair), learners note three fixes. Feedback and CCQs (below): the soft "no" and the golden rules.
Drill: adapting phrases	5	T-S → S	See Drill script. Choral cross-cultural phrases with a warm, unhurried tone, then an individual "soft signal → response" round.
Controlled practice	7	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (read the soft signal) and Ex 3 (fix the opener and the email) alone, then compare. Board-check two rewrites. Ex 4 (match the situation to the skill) and Ex 5 (order the follow-up email) become homework.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Scenario rehearsal: meeting → pitch → negotiation	16	S-S (trios) → T-S	Slide 15, top. Trios with the integrated scenario cards (set D): Kestrel lead (A), Harborview contact (B), observer . Three rounds of 5 minutes, roles rotate, one stage per round: round 1 open the kick-off meeting (welcome, small talk, light agenda); round 2 the pitch (a phased approach: feature → benefit → call to action); round 3 the negotiation (B asks for 15%; A makes a conditional offer). The observer gives one quoted strength in the last 30 seconds. One minute to set up. ICQs first.
Capstone planning	12	T-S → S	Hand out the Capstone Pitch Brief and the Mock Interview Preparation Sheet (assessment/final-assessment.html). Walk through the brief: 5 minutes + Q&A; topic = their own idea, the Review Project approach, or Brief 1–3; individual pitches for up to 8 learners, pair pitches for 9–14 (each partner speaks at least 2 minutes). Form pairs now if needed. Read Script 4.3-B (a short model pitch, about 3 minutes): learners tick the parts on the brief's checklist. Then they plan (7 min) in the brief or the workbook planner: topic, one number, benefits, evidence, a one-sentence call to action and two objections with answers. Circulate: every plan needs a call to action.
Rehearsal 1	14	S-S (pairs)	Pairs (pitch partners rehearse with another pair). Each learner (or pair) gives a first full run from notes (up to 5 min); the listener asks one objection from the Q&A cards, then fills a peer feedback slip (one strength, one tip, a score for Organization & Delivery) (2 min). Swap. Keywords only, no script. The interview preparation sheet is homework.
Feedback	5	T-S	Three columns from the scenario and the rehearsals. Register & tone: "Hi Laura!" → "Good morning, Ms. Quinn"; "We need a decision today" → "There's no need to decide today." Language: "discuss about the price," "I am agree with this condition." Clarity: pitches with no call to action; Q&A answers that never answered. Share one excellent opening line you heard.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Looking ahead & homework	5	T-S	Preview C15 and C16 (slides 16–17). "Next class: timed writing, about an hour, then a 7-minute negotiation with a partner from a role card. Bring a pen and arrive on time. C16: your 5-minute pitches, practice interviews and a celebration. Your scored interview is in a 10-minute slot: here's the schedule." Learners sign up for interview slots (set F). Set the homework (below). Learners tick the 4.3 "I can..." list.
Total	90		8 + 6 + 12 + 5 + 7 + 16 + 12 + 14 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect the capstone planning and Rehearsal 1: learners must leave C14 with a plan and one full run. Cut in this order: (1) Toolkit Bingo stops after one game; (2) the controlled practice becomes homework (do one Ex 2 item together); (3) the scenario rehearsal runs two rounds (meeting and negotiation), with the pitch set for homework. **Never cut Looking ahead:** learners must know exactly what happens in C15 and C16.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: tendencies, not stereotypes. Dimensions describe what a workplace or a team tends to prefer. Every culture has direct and indirect people, and company culture often matters as much as country.

SAY: "Some workplace cultures prefer indirect disagreement." Does that mean everyone from those places is indirect? (No: it's a tendency.) Your new partner is very formal. Are they cold? (Not necessarily: it's their norm.) What's the safest way to start with someone new? (More formal; you can relax later.) You're not sure what they prefer. What do you do? (Observe, mirror, and ask.) Different from my norm: is it wrong? (No: different ≠ wrong.)

Meaning: the soft "no."

SAY: "That may be somewhat difficult on our side." Is it a yes? (Probably not.) Is it certainly a no? (Not certainly: it signals a real problem.) What should Sam do? (Slow down, ask gently, offer another option or more time.) Should he push for a decision? (No.) If you're not sure what someone means, what's the golden rule? (Ask: "How would you prefer we handle this?")

Form.

Starting formal	Thank you for making the time. · It's a real pleasure to be working with you. · May I call you [first name]?	invite informality; don't assume it
------------------------	--	-------------------------------------

Checking	<i>Just to make sure I've understood, ... · How would you prefer we handle this? · Would it help if I put this in writing?</i>	check before you decide
Giving space	<i>There's no need to decide today. · Please take the time you need. · Whenever works for your team is fine with us.</i>	for consensus decision-making
Soft signals	<i>I sense this may be difficult — shall we look at another option? · Please be candid — would a different approach suit you better?</i>	respond to an indirect "no"
Conditional trade	<i>If you can + verb, (then) we could / can + verb</i>	If you can commit to a two-year agreement, we could offer a 10% reduction.
Q&A (capstone)	<i>That's a good question. · If I understand correctly, you're asking... · I don't have that figure with me, but I'll send it by...</i>	buy time, check, promise a follow-up

Pronunciation. Adapting phrases need a **warm, unhurried** voice: slow down, lengthen the stressed syllable and fall gently (*Please take the **TIME** you need* ♫). Checking questions rise slightly (*Would it help if I put this in **WRITing**?* ↗). In the conditional trade, stress the condition and the offer: *If you can commit to **TWO** years ↗ | we could offer **TEN** percent* ♫. The pause after the *if*-clause gives the other side time to think.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Warm and slow** (choral, then individuals): "Thank you for making the **TIME** ♫." · "There's no **NEED** to decide today ♫." · "Please take the **TIME** you need ♫." · "How would you pre**FER** we handle this? ♫" · "Would it help if I put this in **WRITing**? ↗"
- 2 **Soft signal → response** (individual, fast): T: "That may be somewhat difficult for us." → S: "I sense this may be difficult — shall we look at another option?" T: "We'll need to discuss it internally." → "Of course — please take the time you need." T: "Friday is a little tight." → "Would next Wednesday work better?" T: (silence after a price) → "I want to make sure this works for both sides. What are your thoughts?"
- 3 **Trade it** (pairs, then two volunteers): A: "We'd need the price reduced by 15%." B: "I understand budget is important. **IF** you can commit to **TWO** years, we could offer **TEN** percent." Swap with new conditions (a larger order, earlier payment, a longer timeline).

◆ SCENARIO REHEARSAL AND CAPSTONE REHEARSAL — HOW TO RUN THEM

- ◆ **Scenario trios.** Card A: the **Kestrel Design account lead** (the learner's own name, or Sam Ortiz as in Script 4.3-A; your aims and your limits: you can offer up to 10% for a two-year commitment, never 15%). Card B: **Ms. Laura Quinn, Harborview Retail** (your team prefers a formal style, relationship first, and decides by consensus; you have been asked to get 15% off; you can't agree anything today). Observer

card: what to listen for in each stage. The client company's style is part of **its company culture**: the cards never link it to a country.

- ◆ **Rounds (5 min each)**: 1 the kick-off meeting opening (A chairs; B responds; small talk about the week or the project, then a light agenda) → 2 the pitch (A pitches the phased approach from the card: one feature → benefit → a consensus-friendly call to action) → 3 the negotiation (B asks for 15%; A acknowledges, makes a conditional offer; B uses a soft signal and asks for time; A gives space and offers to confirm in writing). Rotate so everyone plays A once. Call each change for the whole room.
- ◆ **Observer checklist** (rubric criteria): **Task & Purpose**: the stage reaches its goal (an agreed agenda · a clear call to action · a conditional offer and next step). **Register & Tone**: title + surname until invited; warm, no pressure; the soft signal noticed. **Language Range & Accuracy**: adapting phrases, *if... could*, benefit language. **Organization & Delivery**: signposting, pace, pauses.
- ◆ **Capstone rehearsal in pairs**. Presenters stand if the room allows. Partners time 5 minutes and hold up a card at 4 minutes ("One minute"), as you will in C16. After the run, one question from the Q&A card pile, then the peer feedback slip. If a presenter reads a full script, let them finish, then ask them to try the first 30 seconds again from keywords only.
- ◆ **You circulate**: listen to every presenter for at least a minute and check their call to action. Note any learner who has no topic yet and talk to them before they leave.

SAY: ICQs (scenario): *How many rounds? (Three.) Who plays Kestrel in round 1? (A.) Can Harborview agree to the deal today? (No: they need to discuss it internally.) Can Kestrel offer 15%? (No: 10% at most, and only with a condition.) Does Ms. Quinn's style come from her country? (We don't know: it's her company's culture.)* · ICQs (rehearsal): *How long is your pitch? (Five minutes, then questions.) Script or keywords? (Keywords.) What does your partner write on the slip? (One strength, one next step, a score.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

SUPPORT (B1)

In the scenario, B1 learners take the **client** role first (fewer lines, reactive) and use the phrase strips printed on the card. For the capstone, offer the **fill-in planner** on the capstone card (six boxes with sentence starters: *Did you know that...? · At the moment, ... · We propose... · This means you... · It will cost... and take... · So I'm asking you to...*) and suggest a **pair pitch** with a stronger partner (each speaks at least 2 minutes) or one of the ready-made Briefs 1–3, so the content is given. Target: a clear opening, one number and a call to action.

STRETCH (C1)

C1 learners run the scenario with **added complications** from the card back (a second stakeholder who disagrees; a deadline moved forward) and must summarize and confirm in writing at the end of round 3 (a two-line spoken recap). For the capstone, ask them to (1) open with a hook that isn't a question, (2) address one **objection before the audience raises it**, and (3) prepare an answer to the hardest question they can imagine. As rehearsal partners, they ask a genuinely challenging question.

◆ L1 & CROSS-CULTURAL WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Stereotype talk.** When learners compare cultures, comments like "People from X are always late" appear quickly. Redirect without embarrassment: "Some workplaces there may have more flexible timing. What have you noticed in teams you've worked with?" Keep the focus on **behaviors and teams**, not nationalities. Never ask a learner to speak for their whole country.
- ◆ **Learners' own norms are strengths.** Many learners already work across two or more cultures. Invite them to share adapting strategies that worked for them (volunteers only): they often know more than the textbook.
- ◆ **Over-direct requests from L1 patterns:** "I want you send the contract," "You must decide today," "Give me discount." Soften with *Could you...? · Would it be possible to...? · We'd need....*
- ◆ **"I am agree" / "We are agree with this condition"** (Spanish, Portuguese, French, Arabic, Farsi and others): *I agree · We agree to this condition.* **"Discuss about":** *discuss the price.*
- ◆ **Idioms from the internet** (*touch base, circle back, low-hanging fruit, ballpark*): learners pick them up to sound fluent. Remind them of the golden rule: with international partners, plain English is clearer and more professional.
- ◆ **Presentation nerves** can be especially high for learners who've been judged on accent before. Say it plainly: "Clear beats perfect. Your accent is part of who you are; we score how clearly you communicate."

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_12.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Work through the integrated scenario's Step 1 and Step 5 emails in writing (good practice for C15). Workbook 4.3: Ex 4 and Ex 5, finish the capstone planner, **rehearse your pitch aloud at least twice** (time it: 5 minutes), and complete the Mock Interview Preparation Sheet (two STAR stories, a strength, two questions). Journal: your personal action plan. Bring your planner to C15 and C16.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** open warmly and formally, make some small talk, offer a written summary · Q2 **C** acknowledge the concern, then offer a conditional trade · Q3 (new) **B** probably "no," or a real problem: ask gently · Q4 (new) **B** start more formal, observe and mirror, and ask. Listening (Ex 1): problems: first name without an invitation · no rapport (straight to numbers) · pressure for a decision today · missed the soft "no." Fixes: title + surname and thanks · a relationship-first question · no pressure + a written summary + "What timeline would suit you?"

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ write, in 60 minutes, a **proposal section** (an executive summary of about 90–130 words + recommendations of about 130–180 words, from the Northwind packing-error data) and **either** a cover letter **or** a formal email (Task 2), using the structures and register from Modules 1 and 4
- ◆ negotiate with a partner from a private **role card**: explore interests, trade conditionally ("If you..., we'll..."), stay firm but polite, and summarize what was agreed
- ◆ confirm the deal in writing in a short **deal memo** (the confirming email, 3–5 bullet points)

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ `assessment/final-assessment.html` : the **writing paper** (one per learner) · the **negotiation cards** (Scenario 1: delivery contract renewal, Northwind / Brightline; Scenario 2: website redesign, Kestrel / Oakridge), cut out · the teacher's **negotiation run-sheet** · one **score sheet** per learner
- ◆ `assessment/assessment-key.html` : the rubric, the model answers and "what to listen for" (your copy)
- ◆ Pens, a visible timer, slide 16, a "Writing in progress" sign for the door

BOARD PLAN

Writing (60 min): start __:__ · end __:__ · Task 1 about 35 min (Executive Summary + Recommendations, formal, headings, numbers from the data) → Task 2 about 25 min (choose ONE: A cover letter · B formal email). Last 5 minutes: greeting, sign-off, figures.

Negotiations (3 rounds × 7 min): Round 1 ____ & ____ · ____ & ____ (Scenario 1) · Round 2 (Scenario 2) · Round 3 (Scenario 1). Friendly opening → ask about their interests → trade: nothing for nothing → summarize before time. Then write your deal memo on the back of your card.

C16: 5-minute pitches + Q&A · practice interviews · celebration 🎉 · Bring your pitch notes and your interview preparation sheet.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Settle & instructions	3	T-S	Slide 16. Running order and start / finish times on the board. Phones away. Hand out the writing paper face down. Frame it ("These are the tasks you'll really meet at work or in a job search... What matters most is that you finish each task"). Remind learners that any task can use a role card. ICQs (below).

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Timed writing	60	S	Individual and silent. Answer questions about instructions only . At 35 minutes: "You should be starting Task 2." At 55 minutes: "Five minutes: check your greeting, your sign-off and your figures." Collect everything at 60.
Negotiation preparation	5	S	Announce the pairs and rounds from the run-sheet (drawn at random, never by level). Hand out role cards: Scenario 1 to rounds 1 and 3, Scenario 2 to round 2, so neighbors never share a scenario. Each learner reads their card silently and fills in the planning lines (opening line · one question about their interests · two "If you..., we'll..." offers · what to keep for the close). ICQs (below).
Negotiations · 3 rounds	21	S-S	Two pairs per round, seated either side of you, 7 minutes per round. Say "One minute" at 6:00; the pair must summarize their deal before time. After their round, each learner writes the deal memo on the back of their card (Subject · greeting · "Just to confirm what we agreed:" · 3-4 bullets with every term and number · the next step · a warm close). Waiting pairs keep planning silently. Make notes on each learner's score sheet between rounds.
Collect & close	1	T-S	Collect the cards and deal memos. "Class 16 is pitches, practice interviews and the celebration. Bring your pitch notes and your interview preparation sheet. Check your interview slot."
Total	90		$3 + 60 + 5 + 21 + 1$

CLASS SIZE

Six pairs fit in three rounds. With **four pairs or fewer**, run two rounds of 9 minutes and use the spare time for a quick debrief. With **seven or eight pairs**, seat three pairs per round and rely more on the deal memos, or move the last round to the start of C16 and use pair pitches there. Odd numbers: one learner negotiates with you (play the other card neutrally, at the card's level). Follow [final-assessment.html](#) if anything there differs from this page.

◆ RUNNING THE NEGOTIATIONS

- ◆ **Before round 1**, say (from the run-sheet): "You have seven minutes. Start with a friendly opening, find out what matters to the other side, and trade: nothing for nothing. Before time is up, summarize what you've agreed. A deal isn't required. A clear, polite 'we can't agree today, so here's the next step' is a good result too."

- ◆ **Don't intervene.** If a pair reaches a deal in 3 minutes, say only: "Check every item on your card: have you agreed all of them?" If a pair drifts into a personal argument, pause them: "Let's go back to the terms on your cards." Keep the conflict commercial.
- ◆ **Card A** (seller / agency) protects a minimum and pushes for a long-term commitment: give it to a learner who needs stretch. For support, allow the Lesson 3.2 phrase card on the table and note it on the score sheet.
- ◆ **Scoring.** You score the language and the process, not the numbers: exploring interests, trading, firm-but-polite register, conditionals, a clear summary (and the deal memo). A learner who reaches a modest deal politely and clearly can score well; a learner who "wins" by refusing to trade or by being rude can't score high on Register & Tone. The shape of a good deal and "what to listen for" are in the run-sheet and the assessment key: don't tell learners in advance.
- ◆ **Two scores, not five.** The writing (Tasks 1 + 2) becomes one **Writing /20**; the negotiation, the C16 pitch and the interview together become one **Speaking /20**, on the four criteria. Make task notes now; decide the criterion scores after C16.

SAY: ICQs (writing): How many tasks? (Two.) In Task 2, do you write both options? (No: choose one.) About how long for Task 1? (About 35 minutes.) Can I ask what a word means? (No: only questions about the instructions.) · ICQs (negotiation): Can you show your partner your card? (No.) Can you give something away for free? (No: always trade.) What do you do at the end? (Summarize and confirm, then write the deal memo.)

◆ RUNNING A FAIR ASSESSMENT IN A COMMUNITY OR WORKPLACE CLASS

- ◆ **Conditions matter more than the room.** Quiet, spaced seats if possible, a visible clock, a sign on the door. A learner who arrives late starts late and finishes with everyone else; note it on their paper.
- ◆ **Accommodations.** If a learner has an agreed accommodation in your program (extra time, enlarged print, a computer for writing), give it here too and note it.
- ◆ **Distress.** If a learner becomes very upset, let them step out and decide whether to continue or finish at home as untimed practice; mark the paper "untimed." An assessment is never worth more than a person's wellbeing.
- ◆ **Role cards count the same.** Task 2 Option A can use the learner's own experience or the role-card profile printed on the paper; both are scored the same way.

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

SUPPORT (B1)

The tasks are the same for everyone; support comes before and after. Before: seat B1 learners where they can see the clock, and remind them to plan for 2–3 minutes before Task 1 (the purpose sentence and the two actions they'll recommend). In the negotiation, give them Card B and allow the Lesson 3.2 phrase card (noted on the sheet). Afterwards, feedback focuses on one criterion to grow, not a list of errors.

STRETCH (C1)

Strong writers who finish early should **check concision and register**, not add length: is the rejected option explained in one clear sentence? Does every recommendation have a cost and a benefit? In the negotiation, give them Card A: protecting a minimum while securing a two-year or support commitment is the harder role.

◆ HOMEWORK

No new online lesson. Rehearse your pitch aloud twice with a 5-minute timer (pair pitches: rehearse together once), and say your two STAR stories aloud once. Review online lesson 3.1 (presentations: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_07.html) and 4.2 (interviews: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_11.html), especially the 🗣️ model sentences. Bring your pitch notes (one card or one slide), your interview preparation sheet and your workbook to C16.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ deliver a structured **5-minute capstone pitch** (alone, or with a partner, speaking at least 2 minutes each) with signposting, benefits, evidence and a clear call to action
- ◆ handle an **objection** in Q&A (acknowledge → clarify → respond), and ask a presenter one real question
- ◆ take a **mock job interview**: *Tell me about yourself*, STAR answers with a result, a strength with an example, and questions for the interviewer (real history or a role card)
- ◆ name one moment from the course they're proud of and one phrase they'll keep using

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ `assessment/final-assessment.html` : the **objection cards** (you ask one per pitch), the **interviewer card** for scored interviews, the **learner interviewer card** (on the preparation sheet) for the practice round, the **score sheets** started in C15
- ◆ C16 kit (materials set F): **pitch running order**, **audience question slips** (two per learner), **scored-interview slot schedule**, **performance profile cards** (for when results come back) · a phone timer and a "1 minute" card · a screen if learners use one slide
- ◆ A **certificate** for each learner if your program provides them (`../.. /instructor-toolkit/certificate.html`) · optional: snacks and drinks brought by the class (check allergies, dietary rules and fasting)

BOARD PLAN

Pitches: running order ①–⑧ (or pairs A–G) · 5 min + Q&A (the teacher asks one, the audience asks one) · "1 minute" card at 4:00.

Audience: two question slips each · write one real question for the speaker · listen for the call to action.

Practice interviews: pairs · learner interviewer card · 8 minutes each way · feedback: the answer I remember best · was there a Result? · "I," not only "we." Then: one moment I'm proud of · one phrase I'll keep 🎉

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Welcome & running order	4	T-S	Slide 17. Running order on the board. Give every audience member two blank question slips. ICQs: "When you're in the audience, what do you write on the slip?" (One real question for the speaker.) "How long is each pitch?" (Five minutes.)
Capstone pitches	56	S → Ss • T-S	Up to 8 learners: individual pitches, 5 minutes + 2 minutes of Q&A (7 min each). 9–14 learners: pair pitches, a joint 5 minutes + 3 minutes of Q&A (8 min per pair); each partner speaks for at least 2 minutes and answers at least one question, and each is scored individually. Hold up "1 minute" at 4:00; stop kindly at 5:30. You ask the first question (choose the objection card that fits); the audience asks the second. Make score-sheet notes as they speak.
Mock interviews	18	S-S • T-S	Pairs run practice interviews with the learner interviewer card from the preparation sheet: 8 minutes each way, 2 minutes to swap, feedback from the checklist on the card. Meanwhile, you hold two scored interviews in a quiet corner with the interviewer card (about 8 minutes each). All other scored interviews happen in the 10-minute slots you scheduled (before or after class, or by video call within a week), or with a second interviewer during the pitch block.
Debrief, certificates & celebration	12	T-S • S-S	Pairs: "One moment from this course I'm proud of; one phrase I'll keep using." Then in a circle: present the certificates by name and give each learner one sentence about their biggest improvement (never a score). Say when results come back (privately, within a week) and that they'll copy them into their performance tracker. Final homework: the online lesson 4.3 review (https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/lesson_12.html) and the last tracker entry. Thank them.
Total	90		4 + 56 + 18 + 12

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect the pitches and the celebration. If pitches overrun, shorten the practice interviews to 6 minutes each way; the scored interviews happen in slots anyway. If a learner can't attend any interview slot, their Speaking /20 comes from the negotiation and the pitch: note "no interview" on the score sheet.

- ◆ **Topics** follow the Capstone Pitch Brief: an improvement at the learner's workplace (real or role card) or an idea for a company they'd like to join; the Review Project approach from C14; or Brief 1 (Northwind "Arrival alerts"), Brief 2 (Brightline "Crates, not cardboard") or Brief 3 (Kestrel "Focus Friday mornings"). Notes on one card or one slide only.
- ◆ **Objection cards.** Choose the card that fits the pitch. For support, use the *evidence* or *ownership* card (they invite a factual answer). For stretch, use *history* or *timing* and add one follow-up: "And if the pilot fails?" Listen for acknowledge → clarify → respond.
- ◆ **The audience question.** Take one question slip per pitch, preferring learners who haven't asked yet. If a question is unclear, rephrase it kindly.
- ◆ **The scored interview** (interviewer card, about 8 minutes, 6–8 questions: always 1, 2, 3 and 8). Stand to greet, offer a handshake only if it's culturally comfortable for the learner, and invite them to sit. Use one follow-up per STAR answer if the Result is missing ("And what was the result?"). **Never ask** about salary, visa or immigration status, nationality, age, family, religion, health, why they left a job, gaps in employment, or a real employer they haven't mentioned. If a learner raises one of these themselves, respond briefly and respectfully and move on.
- ◆ **Scoring.** One **Speaking** /20 per learner from the negotiation, the pitch and the interview together (one score per criterion, based on all the evidence; when it's evenly split, prefer the pitch). Accent itself is not scored. Complete the progress row (Class 1 · Class 8 · Final) on each score sheet before returning results.

SAY: *ICQs: How long is each pitch? (Five minutes, then questions.) In a pair pitch, how long must each of you speak? (At least two minutes.) What do you write on your slip? (One real question.) In the practice interview, how long is each turn? (Eight minutes.) Must you use your real work history? (No: a role card is fine.) When do you get your results? (Privately, within a week.)*

◆ RETURNING RESULTS (WITHIN A WEEK)

- ◆ Return each learner's **Writing** /20 and **Speaking** /20 privately (a short meeting, a sealed envelope or an individual email), with the four criterion scores, the progress row from C1 and C8, one strength with evidence and one next step. Add one sentence of the learner's own writing rewritten as a model.
- ◆ Hand out or email the **performance profile card** (set F) so learners can copy the scores into their **performance tracker** ([performance-tracker.html](#)) and complete the action plan on the workbook's Final Assessment page.
- ◆ Say it kindly: "This is a snapshot, not a verdict. Look at each criterion across the three checkpoints. Different tasks test different skills, so a lower score in one task shows where to practice next, not that you got worse. Compare yourself with you in week 1." Many learners grow fastest in **Organization & Delivery** and **Register & Tone**; **Language Range & Accuracy** grows more slowly. That's normal.

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

SUPPORT (B1)

Offer B1 learners a **pair pitch** with a supportive partner, or a ready-made Brief, and let them choose an early or a late slot (ask privately in C15). They may keep their one notes card in hand. In the scored interview, they may keep the preparation sheet on the table, and you ask 6 questions rather than 8. Choose the evidence or ownership objection card.

STRETCH (C1)

C1 learners who opt in on their preparation sheet get the stretch interview questions ("You have more experience than this role requires. Why this job?" · "Where do you see yourself in five years?") and a harder objection with a follow-up. Ask one to **chair** the Q&A for another presenter (introduce the speaker, take the question slip, thank them).

◆ WATCH - OUTS

- ◆ **No scores in C16.** The final assessment document asks you to name improvements, never scores, in class. Keep all results private.
- ◆ **Real job news.** Some learners may be waiting for a real interview result or may have just lost a job. Keep the practice interviews light and role-card-friendly, and never ask about real applications in front of the group.
- ◆ **Freezing in a pitch.** Say quietly, "Take a breath. What's your next point?" or ask an easy question to restart. Score what they did, not the pause.
- ◆ **Food at the celebration.** Check allergies, dietary rules and fasting periods before anyone brings food. A celebration can be just words, certificates and thanks.

◆ AFTER THE COURSE

Return results within a week. Point learners to the full online course for review (<https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/>), their workbook phrase lists, their performance tracker and their action plan. Learners who want to raise their general level of English can continue with the CEFR courses on the same site. If your program runs a follow-up session a month later, invite learners to bring one real email, meeting or interview story: it's the best motivation for the next group.

END OF C14: THE MODULE WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "write it so they can decide, present yourself so they can say yes, bring it all together": **the answer first** • **a standalone executive summary** • **S-A-P-C-T recommendations** (write it so they can decide) → **action verb + result** • **STAR with I and a result** • **your path in one positive sentence** • **two questions at the end** (present yourself) → **start formal** • **read the soft signal** • **trade conditionally** • **confirm in writing** (bring it all together). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you: use those notes when you write each learner's next step in C16.

What the Final Assessment tells you. It's the course's third set of evidence: a Writing /20 and a Speaking /20, set beside C1 and C8 on each learner's score sheet and performance tracker. The **trend on each criterion** is the finding, not a single total. Expect Organization & Delivery and Register & Tone to move most (structures and habits), and Language Range & Accuracy to move more slowly.

If you teach the course again: keep your three-column notes from C12–C14. The most frequent errors (*discuss about, I am agree, five years of experiences, responsible of*) and the most common clarity problems (the buried recommendation, the STAR answer with no result, the pitch with no call to action) make the best warmers for the next group.